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EFN 214: SOCIOLOGY OF EDUCATION

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LECTURE ONE

SOCIOLOGY: AN INTRODUCTION

Introduction

In the first chapter of this course, we would like to begin with discussing sociology briefly before we turn to sociology of Education. We will begin with the origins of sociology. We shall outline the reasons why sociological emerged. Next, we shall define sociology, name the branches of sociology, explain the sociology perspective, present some concepts and issues or concerns that typify sociology. It is essential to begin with this kind of introduction because Sociology of Education is a major branch of sociology. However, we shall not discuss the concepts and the issues in great details because they will be presented or analyzed in subsequent chapters of this unit.

Learning Objectives



At the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

1. Discuss the origins of sociology, from a historical perspective.
2. Explain why sociology emerged as a discipline
3. Define the term sociology, giving the original and the modern definitions.
4. List the branches which comprise sociology.
5. Give the concepts, issues or concerns that make up the subject matter of sociology.
6. Explain what is meant by the 'Sociological Perspective' and discuss its role in social concerns

Key words; Names and Concepts

➤ Sociology	- Auguste Comte'	- Social Phenomena
➤ Socius	- Karl Marx	- Sociological Perspective
➤ Logos	- Max Weber	- Society
➤ Social science	- Herbert Spencer	- Culture
➤ Cours de Philosophie	- Emile Durkheim	- Socialization
Positive		- Social Institution
➤ Positivism		- Social Interaction
➤ Paradigm		- Social Stratification
		- Social Groupings
		- Social Mobility
		- Social Relationships
		- Social position, Role, Status

Acronyms

ORIGIN OF SOCIOLOGY – A Brief History

The word SOCIOLOGY originated from two words namely:

- (i) **Socius** which is Latin, and meant sharing in a group or companionship.
- (ii) **Logos** which is Greek, meaning 'reasoning' or 'science'

When these words and their interpretations were combined three meanings emerged as follows:

- (a) Reasoning about companionship
- (b) Words about human group sharing
- (c) Science of group sharing

Although all of these interpretations referred to human beings, there was a problem. The problem is that,

- (i) They made little sense in terms of what they meant.

- (ii) Also, they would not have withstood the test of time given that there were other well developed disciplines which were able to explain the fate of human life; disciplines like Philosophy, Metaphysics, Religion, History and Politics.

The problem in the meaning and interpretations of the words, 'Socius' and 'Logos; was solved later in the 19th Century by a French Social Philosopher named AUGUSTE COMTE' (1798 – 1857). Auguste Comte' was able to combine these two words out of which he invented the word SOCIOLOGY. His initial interpretation cum definition of this newly invented word was the Science of Society. Comte' first revealed his invention of a new science in a series of writings called Cours de Philosophie Positive that he published between 1830 – 1842. It is in one of these series in 1839 that he called the new Science, Sociology. Comte' went on to explain that Sociology will have these purposes or uses:

- (a) To discover the laws of social order that could explain the natural development of society;
- (b) To contribute to the well being of social stability in society.

Why did Comte' call Sociology a Science? The answer is that Auguste Comte' was recognized as the founder of the 'School of Positivism; a philosophical approach in which he emphasized the gathering and accumulation of knowledge about the social phenomena – events, occurrences or happening – through the use of scientific observations, investigations or studies. Consequently, he argued against the use of myths, speculations and the ultimate causes as ways of explaining the social phenomena, e.g. floods, famines, epidemic diseases etc. Comte' urged the use of scientific studies of human societies that would facilitate to discover, predict and to control the observed social phenomena in society.

With such ideas, we can see why Auguste' Comte' called Sociology a science of society, meaning that it would utilize scientific strategies to explain the human societies and all their social phenomena. Always a way of strengthening Sociology, he strongly asserted that it must stand on its own and not as a branch of another discipline like Philosophy. Standing on its own feet, Sociology will be able to develop and acquire its own theories, concepts, facts and empirical methods to help it become a full fledged scientific discipline.

Why did Sociology emerge?

Since we have said that Comte' referred to Sociology as the science of society, you may ask, why did sociology come into being only in the 19th Century and the human societies have been in existence for thousands of years before? Were there no other ways, for example other disciplines that were geared towards understanding and explaining the social phenomena? The answer is, there were such like philosophy, History, Religion, Politics, Mythology and Metaphysics and may be others. But in the 19th Century Europe, there were certain factors or conditions which appeared to influence strongly the need for another discipline or means which would be more oriented to analyzing the human societies. These factors were both intellectual, social, political, industrial and even scientific. We would like now to list some of these factors and also briefly explain each. They are as follows:

- (i) Generally there was a feeling that other older disciplines mentioned above were failing to explain the social phenomena (events, occurrences, etc) satisfactorily. Take philosophy for example; Comte observed that philosophy was too abstract and contained unknowables; or knowledges that the common people did not understand and were perhaps not appealing to their every day lives.
- (ii) Intellectually, there occurred a shift in writings of certain writers of the 19th Century Europe. Prominent philosophers and Historians of this period, like Auguste Comte; Karl Marx (1818-1883); Max Weber (1864-1920); Emile Durkheim (1858-1917); Herbert Spencer (1820-1903), changed from writing ambitiously about the political structures of societies to writing about the industrial revolution societies. In their philosophical writings, they found new interest in reflecting upon subjects or issues like, the family, nature of society, population changes, social institutions and development.
- (iii) Upon the industrial revolution in Europe, many people migrated to the urban industrial centers from their rural areas in search of jobs and better pay. This change had a number of consequences like family disintegration, poor work and living conditions especially among the new urban dwellers, poverty, child labour and abuse, new crimes and thuggery, breach of law and order, alienation and animosity, and many others. Comte' realized that such problems were not natural. Instead they were largely social. They were the result of human collectivities and actions. The solutions could only be found in the contexts of the collectivities and not in the expository writings of the old disciplines.
- (iv) New forces emerged especially after the French and American revolutions. Such forces promised to spawn new democratic systems to replace the old feudal and aristocratic practices which had dominated the European societies ways of life for a long time. Suddenly, many people found themselves empowered to live decent lives compared to the disadvantaged lives before. They found themselves owners of wealth unlike in the past.

As you can see, such conditions were paving the way for Comte, thought and strengthening his position towards founding a new way of studying and explaining the human societies. His new discipline, Sociology, was meant to examine how the human societies in collections and their phenomena are like through actual and practical observations. The old methods of the social philosophers were prescriptive in approach in that they promulgated what the human societies ought to be like. As time went on, Comte's lone effort continued to receive more support and acceptance as other writers mentioned above (item ii) collaborated in the founding of Sociology. As a result of his work, Auguste Comte' was recognized and is honoured as the 'Father of Sociology' even up to the modern times.

Modern Sociology

In the modern times, we can say that Sociology is like what Comte' conceptualized it and much more. It is a science, a social science, grouped together with other well established social sciences disciplines like, Philosophy, Psychology, Anthropology, Political Science, Demography, History and many others.

The modern Sociology has its own well developed concepts and theories as we shall see later. It can develop its own dependable knowledge, verify facts about human societies through the use of its scientific methods of research. Also, Sociology to-day has many branches, sub-branches, major issues or concerns pertinent to the human societies to examine. We shall explain them later on. It has specialized areas of service such as the social work. Sociology is also found forming full fledged departments within the institutions of higher learning such as universities and colleges where students can pursue studies and earn bachelors, masters and doctorate degrees. To-day, Sociology has also many highly qualified specialists, proponents, researchers and teachers in working in social organizations, undertaking research in societies and lecturing in colleges and universities.

Definitions of Sociology

Up to now we have talked about and you hopefully you have all understood and enjoyed reading about when, how and why sociology came into being, and perhaps you are wondering how can you define the term 'sociology'. Well, in modern times, the term 'sociology' has a host of definitions according to its different enthusiasts. We, nevertheless, accept all of them such as the ones I have listed here:

- (a) Sociology is the science of society. This is Comte's original definition.
- (b) Sociology is the science of scientific study of society.
- (c) Sociology is the scientific study of social relationship in society
- (d) Sociology is the scientific study of social behaviour in society
- (e) Sociology is the science of social institutions in society
- (f) Sociology is the scientific study of social activities in society
- (g) Sociology is the scientific study of social interactions in society
- (h) Sociology is the scientific study of social change in society
- (i) Overall, Sociology can be defined as scientific discipline which addresses the social phenomena occurring and being observed in and are part of the human groupings in society.

You may now ask, is there one definition that stands out more prominently than the others? The answer is that all of them are equally acceptable. The only one that we might say is more prominent is Comte's definition because of its historical consideration.

At this point, we want to clarify some of the words we have used in this overall definition as follows:

- (a) SOCIAL: – The word social means something pertaining or belonging to, associated with or part of the human society.
- (b) SCIENTIFIC: – This word refers, here to any procedure, especially a research procedure that follow the natural sciences methods of developing knowledge. Sociology is a social science but uses the natural sciences methods of researching on social issues or questions.

- (c) **SCIENCE:-** A science is a discipline, a subject area that is characterized by a uniquely significant body of knowledge that has been unbiasedly developed, accumulated, organized systematically in an orderly and local manner, through the scientific research. A science, also contain its own theories, concepts, principles, facts and a set of attitudes which can motivate the willingness on the part of researchers to modify, change and even discard any information that is found to be wrong in favour of more reliable evidence or knowledge. This paradigm characterizes Sociology and this is why we can consider it as a science.
- (d) **HUMAN GROUPS:-** Sociology does not study one individual. Instead, it examines collections of individuals in society with respect to the behaviour, activities, problems and many other issues observable in the groups. This is why we have used the term human groupings. By studying each group and all its problems and questions, we end having studying and knowing more about the society which is after all made up of human groupings such as organizations, a groups of school children and many others.
- (e) **PARADIGM:-** A constellation or a pattern of theories, concepts, methods or techniques, knowledges, ideas, beliefs, attitudes, opinions, values and images that are agreed upon and shared by members of a scientific community regarding the fundamental nature of a particular discipline and its subject matter, e.g. Sociology.
- (f) **SOCIAL PHENOMENA:-** The term 'social phenomena' (singular is phenomenon), means a collection of occurrences, events, objects, happenings, structures, all of which are part of, appear in and are observable in a human society. Examples of social phenomena are the social institutions, relationships, behaviours, activities, culture, traditions, changes, organizations, roles, crimes, and many more like political and schooling systems.

The Branches of Sociology

Now that you know how to define Sociology, you should also be aware that it is inevitably a diverse discipline so as to address the various social contexts that are part of a given society. Because of the diversity of social the phenomena, Sociology has tried to cover many old and new aspects through a number of branches into which it is subdivided. Some of these are:

- (i) Sociology of Education.
- (ii) Sociology of Religion.
- (iii) Sociology of Social organization.
- (iv) Sociology of knowledge.
- (v) Sociology of law.
- (vi) Sociology of migration.
- (vii) Police Sociology.
- (viii) Military Sociology.
- (ix) Economics Sociology.
- (x) Mathematical Sociology.
- (xi) Urban Sociology. (xii) Rural Sociology.

- (xiii) Sociology of Art.
- (xiv) Sociological Theories.

And the list goes on. Some of these branches are very obscure, but one notable sociologist, Emile Durkheim, once remarked that there are as many branches of Sociology as there are varieties of social facts in human societies.

Some Issues or Concerns of Sociology

In our definitions of sociology, we have said that it is the 'study of social phenomena.' By saying this, we went to emphasize that each of the named factors to be studied through Sociology is an issue or concern for Sociology. Together, all of them and many others make up the social phenomena in society. This idea should therefore tell us that the list of issues of the 'oyster' of Sociology is very long. We can therefore, say that 'whatever touches the human society and also whatever the human society touches' are the concern of Sociology. Emile Durkheim said that in order to understand the variety of concerns in the social reality of a human society, sociologists should always use a sociological perspective. By this he meant that if we, as sociologists, wanted to understand any issue, question or problem in society, sociologically, we should always use a particular way of looking, viewing, analyzing and finally explaining the social concerns.

The word perspective means an angle of vision. It is a way of looking at something. It is also a way of not looking at something. If, for example, you decide to look at one aspect, your attention, view and perception would be directed towards and more concentrated on that aspect. Other aspects or factors may be near and around you but these would be screened out. Let us suppose that you have entered a standard six classroom and you are asked this question, 'how many girls do you see in this classroom?' Immediately you are asked to answer this question; you start paying special attention to girls. Before, you were not doing so. You just saw pupils, boys and girls. Suddenly the number of girls in this classroom becomes more apparent, readily visible and therefore, this aspect occupies your central view, way of looking. At the same time you block out the number or presence of boys in this classroom. This is your way of not looking. Then you begin counting the girls. This example is a good way of conceptualizing the implications of the word perspective. That is, you direct angle of vision towards the girls so as to begin counting them and finally give the number. At the same time, you block out the angle of vision as far as the boys are concerned so that you do not count any of them also.

The sociological perspective, as recommended by Emile Durkheim, works in the same manner as illustrated in the example above. It emphasizes that whenever we are faced by social phenomena such as questions and concerns, events and situations, issues and activities, occurrences, happenings and behaviours in human societies, we should use a sociological viewing so as to be able to analyze, understand and finally explain the social concerns facing us. In other words, we should always try to apply the correct sociological angle of vision that will provide us with the correct understanding and explanation of the social phenomenon we may be encountering. We should not be relegated to depending on speculations, myths and ultimate causes as ways of explaining the social phenomena. The

proper sociological perspective that we should apply is the empirical observation through the relevant sociological theories, research procedures, analysis and interpretations so as to be able to draw the right inferences about social concerns. It is only by doing so that we can say that we are using Durkheims' recommended sociological perspective. In a social situation, such as a school, there are several problems or questions in which we can apply a sociological perspective approach so as to obtain the right and correct picture, dependable knowledge on, say, pupils behaviours, academic performance, obedience to school rules and regulations, general thuggery, facilities abuse and destruction, gangstery tendencies, assaults and truancy. All these are social concerns that we can examine sociologically.

In the same way, a sociological perspective is utilized to examine several concerns or issues in the wider human societies. Some of the social concerns or issues that we can empirically investigate include the following:

- (a) Social relationships and interactions.
- (b) Social institutions and structures.
- (c) Social behaviour and activities.
- (d) Cultural forces and practices.
- (e) Socialization patterns.
- (f) Social stratification process.
- (g) Social groupings and influences.
- (h) Systems of beliefs, values, rituals, expectations.
- (i) Social change and continuity.
- (j) Systems of social communication.
- (k) Social organizations – formal and informal.

And the list goes on. These concerns illustrate what we have already talked about before; that is, the oyster of Sociology is very large.

The Role of Sociological Perspective

What is the role of the Sociological Perspective with regard to the Social issues?

In sociology and particularly for the social concerns or issue the sociological perspective occupies a central position because it allows or facilitates us to

- (a) Observe and obtain a new and better view of a familiar situation or occurrence and thus understand and explain it better. For example, when you observes social unrest, how would you understand and explain it? Would you hastily conclude that people are on a rampage out of feeling excited or would you say that its because of general economic poverty that has encroached on their daily lives? If your school is experiencing a lot of cases of truancy would you just dismiss the problem as cases of students exercising their democratic right of choosing what they want to do? Is it because there is rampant drug trafficking in the community that is influencing and diverting students attention from school?
- (b) Analyze and explain strange social behaviour and unfamiliar social occurrences. For example, why or where do some students find courage to incinerate their colleagues or attack, rape, injure and even kill female students? These are some of

the strange social behaviours among students that require a new way of viewing and analyzing them. The sociological perspective provides us with the needed opportunities.

BASIC CONCEPTS IN SOCIOLOGY

In the previous discussions, we have seen how Auguste Comte characterized Sociology, as a new science that would have its own theories, facts, ways of obtaining knowledge and concepts. We now need to talk about some of the concepts that also make Sociology what it is, a discipline with its own orientation. We shall use the word concepts to refer to the special terms, ideas, mental images and understanding social phenomena, processes and events or actions. Since there are many of these concepts in Sociology, we shall discuss a few of the major ones. These are: society, culture, socialization, stratification, social institutions, social relationships and interactions, social mobility, social status, position and role, social groups.

- (1) Society: This term is applied in so many situations such that we become confused.

A few of these situations are:

- (a) When we need to point out the territorial location of a nation; for example, the Kenyan society.
- (b) If we want to differentiate cultures; for example we might refer to American society's culture versus the Chinese society's culture.
- (c) When we are referring to formally constituted groups or organizations such as the Bible Society, Church Missionary Society and the Geographical Society.
- (d) When we are denoting racial identity; for example, the African, European or Asian societies.

Although all of these have something to do with the human beings, we still find it difficult to give this term a single well defined definition. For Sociology, however, the concept of society is used to refer to,

- (a) A configuration of human beings who interact with each other so as to ensure the continued existence of that society. Such people support each other, have common interests, ties, customs, beliefs and practices.
- (b) A collectivity of human beings that is capable of self-replenishing through sexual reproduction of children, recruitment and admission of new members from other societies.
- (c) A congregation of humans that exhibits complex systems of actions to regulate, protect, defend, unite, nurture and promote the well-being and survival of all the members.
- (d) A configuration of human beings which is capable of providing effective ways and means of development, communication, roles, responsibilities, and the learning

opportunities for the mental, physical, moral and spiritual growths of all the members.

From all these perceptions and definitions of the term society, the underlying notion is that there are several micro societies within a single macro society.

- (2) Culture: Like the concept of society, the term culture has generated a lot of confusion but also great interest. This term is derived from the German word Kultur which refers to someone who is well cultivate, schooled or behaved. This concept has therefore become a very critical thought wave in every human society mainly because, sociologically much of the complex individual and group behaviours of human beings are better explained on the basis of what is learned and acquired from a given society's culture.

In 1902, Sir Edward B. Taylor, a British Anthropologist (one who studies culture) was the first person to define culture. He defined it as 'that complex whole which includes knowledge, belief, art, morals, laws, customs and any other capabilities and habits acquired by man as a member of society'. In 1950, another enthusiast, Edward B. Reuter, defined culture as the sum total of human creation which included what man has made inform of tools, weapons, shelter material goods, attitudes, beliefs, judgment, institutions, arts, sciences, philosophy and social organization up to the present time. (Ezewu, 1983; p.66-7).

Whereas the modern sociologists do accept these ideas as basic in perceiving the concept of culture, they nevertheless do criticize them. Their criticisms came from what they felt was being wrongly suggested by the above ideas. For instance,

- (i) that culture is one universal, common entity for all human societies in the world; (ii) that if culture is considered as a universal common entity, some societies would be placed at the beginning of the universal culture continuum, others within the continuum depending on, say, the degree, extent or level of civilization, economic development education or weaponry power. This kind of thinking about culture, as sociologists argued, would not be free of connotations of national, racial, ethnics, social and many other kinds of discriminations, denials and down grading of human beings around the world.

Instead of being a universal, common entity among all the world human societies, the modern sociologists view culture as a unique entity in every different society. In essence, this means that each human society in its geographic or territorial location has its own culture that distinguishes it from another society. Infact, a sociologist by the name of Franz Boas has emphasized the uniqueness of culture in each society by saying that each individual human society has its own body of customs, beliefs and institutions instead of different societies having different degrees or levels of one universal culture. Also, different societies do not move along the culture continuum thus reaching different stages in the overall cultural development. (Ezewu, p.67).

Modern Definition of Culture

Culture in contemporary times and Sociology is simply defined as.

THE TOTAL WAY OF LIFE OF A HUMAN SOCIETY

This definition includes nearly everything that is observable and practiced in the life of a given human society. In addition to what we have discussed in conceptualizing culture, there is also another way of viewing culture; this is by characterizing it. What are its characteristics or nature? We shall only look at few of them. More about culture will be discussed later chapter. Briefly, we will characterize culture as,

- (i) Teachable and learnable: What we mean by this is that none of us is born knowing the total way of life of our society or culture. Each one of us has to be taught, shown, learn and practice the various ways of living life in that society as expected. This characteristic has many implications on and for education in any society.
- (ii) Transmissible in specialized settings: This means that culture has special places where it can be more effectively passed on to other people, for example, the family, school and many other special environments.
- (iii) Creatable: The human societies are probably the only creation which has greater capacity than other living entities to change, modify, add on, subtract, renew and build with aims purposes or reasons. As human beings, we can surpass many of our biological limitations by using the mental prowess and create things that can enable us to subdue or conquer the physical environments. In this sense what human beings do becomes part of demonstrating that culture is creatable, for example jet planes, computers; rockets to other planets, skyscrapers just to mention a few.
- (iv) Shared: By this, we mean that we can be given and give aspects of culture by/to others in society, for example knowledge experience, skills and many others especially when we interact.

At this point we want to emphasize that there is a very close relationship between culture and education, mainly because education and schooling are perceived as effective ways of or processes of transmitting the culture of a human society. This relationship is demonstrated by the fact that the content of culture have been installed in various school curricular and subjects.

Other factors we use to characterize the concept of culture are that culture is (i)

Organic; meaning that it belongs to living human beings.

- (ii) Supra-organic; meaning that it continues to exist beyond an individuals lifetime.
- (iii) Not static; meaning that culture is subject to changes, either all or some parts; it can be modified, absorb from other cultures.
- (iv) Stable; meaning that culture contains things that people want to hold on to and pass them on, e.g. greetings.
- (v) Overt; meaning that culture is comprised of observable items, for example, foods, houses and buildings, types of clothes schools, hospitals, roads, farms and types of crops and so on.

- (vi) Covert; meaning that culture is comprised of unobservable elements, like ideas, opinions, beliefs and attitudes that we cannot look and see directly. They are hidden to our senses until someone tells you what her or she believes in or what his/her thoughts, opinions ideas are.
- (vii) Explicit; meaning that culture has actions or activities that can be explained, for example an education system, a political system, laws etc.
- (viii) Implicit; meaning that culture contains things we do but are unable to explain why we do them. For example, a group of people would stand talking in the middle of a busy walk way in a big city like Nairobi, blocking it without caring whether others can find their way through.
- (ix) Manifest; meaning that culture contains things that people actually do, recognized and are seen by others, for example a wedding ceremony.
- (x) Ideal; meaning that culture has the ways that members of society ought to do or belief they ought to do; for example we ought to education our children and believe that we should obey the laws of the country.

Finally, we would like to make one observation over these two concepts, society and culture; that is although these characteristics of culture show that culture undeniably is what tells us how a given society is like and that the two are part of each other, they are however not equivalent. In other words, society is not culture, but instead, it is a large collectivity of people with a common 'total way of life'. Similarly, culture is not society but it is the transmissible total way of life of that society.

(3) Socialization: This concept is defined as the process through which members of society are taught and acquire the culture of their society, for example, knowledge, skills, beliefs, morals, behaviours and more, that can enable the members to be integrated, responsible and contributing individuals in that society.

In other words, what we are saying is that socialization is the vehicle or mechanism by which the 'total way of life of a society' is transmitted from one member of society, such as a parent or teacher, to a child or pupil; an employer to a new-employee.

The concept of socialization also implies that none of us is born knowing all what needs to be known in society. Each one of us at any time, stage or another, we are 'raw materials' for the socialization process. Some of the raw materials we can give as examples are, a newly born child, an army or police recruit, a newly married couple, a student or pupil, a new employee, a first time parent, a starting business person, a trainee and so many others. These examples show us that none of us as shown human being can escape the socialization process. Think about it. Therefore, all human societies are faced with major problems of what to transmit and how or the best methods of transmitting the various aspects of their cultures to the members who are at different levels and stages of life, social positions, situations and responsibility.

The concept of socialization also tells us that as we mature or go through the life-time, we also go through varying sequences of socialization that correspond to the requirement, needs and expected behaviour of the growth stage. For example when you were a newly

born baby and later a child, you were helped and later taught how to use the toilet, to feed, wash and dress-up. Then you started going to school- the nursery, primary secondary and on to University or College. You were educated, trained, joined a club or an organization, was married and then became parent among many other conditions. Therefore, you can see that you began undergoing the process of socialization as soon as you were born and will continue until 'you bite the dust' or your life ends. Whereas all of us will undergo through this process, what will keep changing are the socialization settings, contents, techniques and agents.

In an earlier part of this chapter, we have talked about a close relationship between education and culture. We have also said that the process of socialization is responsible for the transmission of society's culture. There is, therefore, a perception that education and socialization are equal or the same processes. Although they both transmit culture, they do not always use the same methods. Furthermore, if we considered the education in schools, we shall find that it is more structured, rigid and systematic than the general socialization process. In a later chapter, we shall be considering more about education and socialization based on various other aspects than just the socialization concept.

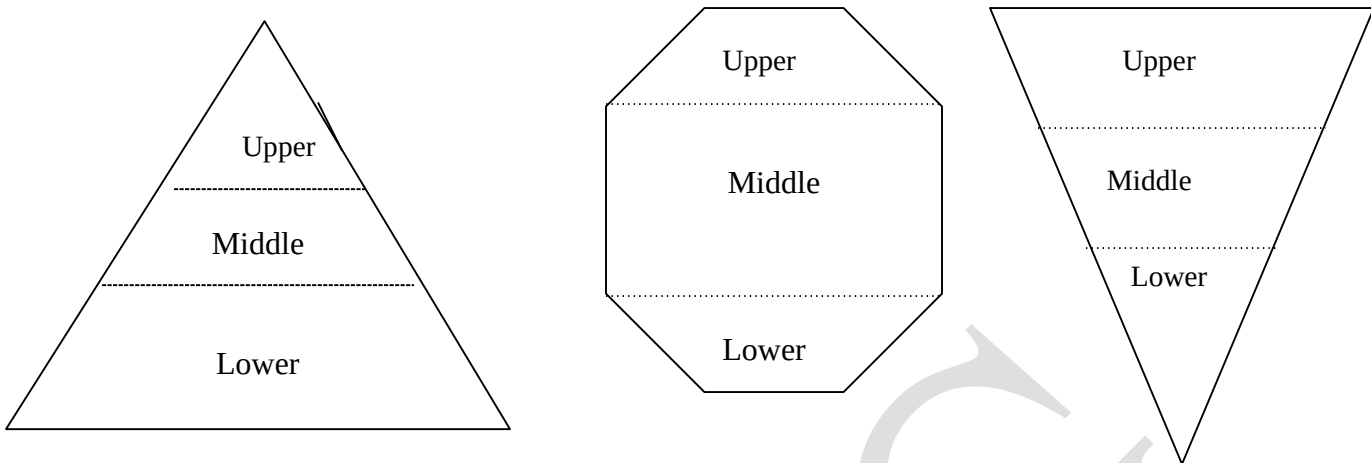
(4) Social Stratification

The term stratification as it appears in Sociology, is borrowed from Geology. It means the arrangement of elements into layers. The layers are known as strata (singular is stratum). The word social means something to do with society. Therefore, the whole concept of social stratification in Sociology means 'a process of dividing and placing individual members of society into strata called social classes'

The concept of social stratification is based on the view that human beings in any given society do not enjoy nor are they provided with equal opportunities to engage in all societal activities. They do not reap equal rewards or even interact equally. Similarly, different individuals in society do not have similar interests ambitions, abilities or even expectations. As a result of these and many other circumstances, a human society finds it inevitable to divide itself into specific layers into which individual members are fitted or placed. These layers are the ones we refer to as strata or social classes. The classes are arranged in such a way that they show hierarchical ranking of society's members in the social classes, according to how the desirable but scarce resources for example, are unequally distributed.

Let us now see how social stratification is perceived in human societies. First, it is operationalized into three major social classes that many of us have heard of before; that is, the UPPER, MIDDLE and LOWER social classes. Second, social stratification can occur in form of one of three models or shapes in a given society as shown here:

- (a) Pyramid model (b) Diamond model (c) Inverted Pyramid model (Most occurring)
(sometimes found) (Least found, occurring)



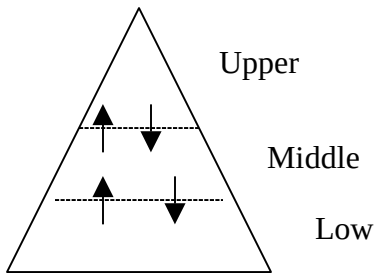
In all cases, the upper class is the most well to do while the lower class is the least well to do. The gaps in the dividing lines means that individuals can move up or down into a different class, according to how their status is changing. For example, a child who is born in a low class family can move up the social stratification ladder through performing well in school, going on to university and qualifying as, say, a doctor, lawyer, engineer or a university lecturer. There are, therefore, a number of factors which society uses to stratify its members into different social classes. Some of these factors are

- (i) Occupation or profession
- (ii) Income, wealth, property or possessions
- (iii) Family type one is born in
- (iv) Level of education
- (v) Prestige, influence, power in society
- (vi) Area of residence
- (vii) Marital status

Later, we shall discuss the relationship between social stratification and education emphasizing how the two affect each other.

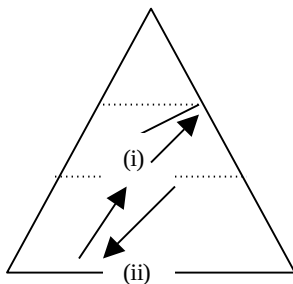
(5) **Social Mobility:** The term social mobility is related to social stratification. It means 'the movement of individuals in society from one stratum or social class to another. The concept implies that in order for social mobility to happen, an individual has or individuals have also to achieve more than they had before. Therefore, the same factors that are used to divide and to place members of society into social classes, are the same that can propel govern social mobility. Also, in this concept there are two types of movements that societal members can undergo as follows:

- (a) Vertical – upward or downward mobilities as illustrated in this diagram.



Notice the open gaps allowing the occurrence of social mobility.

(b) Horizontal – Movement within one class as shown here.



For example, an individual may move from a low middle class to a higher middle class position (arrow (i)) or from a higher middle class to a low middle class (arrow (ii)). The role that education plays in terms of accelerating an individual's social mobility is an important one. This role will be discussed in a later chapter.

In both cases note that there are open gaps which permit the mobility.

(6) Social Institution

The concept of social institution in a human society derives from the structure of and how a living organism, work. In a living organisms such as a human being, there are organs, for example the heart, kidney, liver, the eye and many others. These organs are structured differently to enable them to perform the specialized functions that they do. By so doing, the organs are able to maintain the whole organism.

This thinking is used in Sociology as a model to understand a human society. Using this model a society is compared to a living organism while the social institutions are likened to the organs. We can define the social institutions in society as organs, systems or units which are specially structured or organized such that they can carry out specific functions needed to maintain the whole society. Sociologically, there are six major recognizable social institutions. These social institutions are the Family, Education, Religion, Health, Economy, and Politics. All the other structures, practices or situations that we hear being referred to as institutions, for example marriage, a university, a church, parliament, hospital, can be placed under one of the six social institutions. You think about it carefully.

Since we have seen that education is one of the major social institutions, this concept is a crucial one to understand in connection with education. We shall discuss this view in later.

(7) Social Position, Status and Role

In Sociology, social position, status and role are all related. The term status is defined as the position an individuals occupies in a given society. This status can be high or a low. For example, a manager of a company or a headteacher have high statuses or occupy higher positions. Similarly, a cleaner or grounds worker occupy statuses although theirs are low positions. Each one, however, is essential in the work relationship for the proper operation of the company or the school.

The term social role is defined as a collection or cluster of standardized behaviours or norms that accompany a given social position. That is, it is the collection of behaviour that a person occupying a given social position is expected to exhibit in society as long as he or she continues to occupy that particular position. This idea tells us that expected behaviours change with changes of social positions and that one person can occupy a number of positions and be required to exhibit different roles. A headteachers for example, can play a multitude of roles by virtue of being the headteacher, a husband and a parent, and sometimes a community leader. Again, roles keep on shifting, especially ones that are regarded as traditional male or female roles, e.g. money-earning, and child care.

As we can see and if we examine the school situation, these terms, social position, status and role, are sociologically critical, especially when we consider school leadership, administration or management. The term status and role are also important in socialization. In this case, we shall later discuss the ‘role socialization’ and ‘status socialization: A teacher has a number of roles in the classroom and the school. Which we shall talk about in another section.

(8) Social Groups

This concept has already been discussed earlier as human groups. We however want to define a social group as a number of people, large or small, who cooperate for some common purpose, who define themselves and are defined by others as members of that group, who interact frequently, and probably living together within one area. Members of a social group may have well established routines, patterns, rules and regulations (e.g. a club) which govern the shared characteristics and behaviours expected among the members.

Social groups result from how people in society organize and work, and many of us belong now or have belonged to a social group at one time or another, whether a family or community groups. School children constitute social groups. In the classrooms we see also smaller social groups which are more intimate than the large school group. In each class, pupils form even more intimate friendship, peer, or play groups. All these types of social

groups are of special interest to Sociology because although we did define Sociology as a science of society, this science keys on studying small social groups in society and not the whole society at once.

(9) Social Interaction and Relationship

In any social organization such as school the or even a group, there develops a network of connections between and among the people inside. Such connections cannot be maintained if interactions and relationships are not thriving. The two terms are thus related in that they occur together or one develops out of the other.

Let us first try to define them. The term interaction can be defined as the pattern of acting and reacting towards one another, between each other and among others. For example, when you meet your friends or people you have never met before, how do you act or react towards them? Is your behaviour a welcoming one, cheerful or full of despise and sneer? The behaviour expressions that we display may end up determining the kind of relationship that could develop between you and others.

The term relationships can be defined as the patterns of connections acceptance or denials that develop after two or more people have interacted. This definition suggests that relationships can either be positive, agreeable, cordial and mutual or negative, disagreeable, despise, mistrust and all other manner of dislike. In school situations, the network of social interaction and relationships operate among the various school constituents involving the headteacher and the teachers; headteacher and the students; teacher and students; between and among the students; between and among the non- teaching staff. Sociologically, all these types of social interactions and relationships have implications, problems and ways in which they have influence on the teaching-learning activities and the goal of the school organization.

Summary



In this chapter, we have defined Sociology as ‘the science of society: Auguste Comte cited this definition as the original definition. Other definitions were given as contemporary definitions were given as contemporary definitions of Sociology. The origin of the word sociology was given as the words ‘socius’ and ‘logos: Also, we have discussed four reasons regarding why Sociology originated.

Since sociology is the science of society, there are several issues in society that this science examines. As a result Sociology has as many branches as there are issues in society. One of the major branches is the Sociology of Education. The term, sociological perspective, was discussed as a specialized way of viewing the issue in society.

Several concepts were discussed as part of Sociology. Among these concepts were ‘society; ‘culture’ ‘socialization; ‘social stratification; and others. The presence of these concepts in Sociology, demonstrate what Auguste Comte declared about his new science; that is, Sociology will have its own theories, empirical methods and concepts for it to be a full fledged scientific discipline. As a scientific discipline, Sociology like Psychology, Philosophy,

Anthropology, History, Demography and others, is a social science which nowadays is organized into academic departments in universities and colleges around the world.

Questions/Activities



1. Discuss what you understand by the term Sociology stating its origins and the reasons why or how it originated as a scientific discipline.
2. Sociology is now a 'well recognized and a highly specialized discipline' This fact has been discussed in many ways in this lecture. Using these materials cite the relevant areas to illustrate how Sociology is a 'well recognized and highly specialized discipline. Present your answer in form of a short paper or essay. (about five pages).
3. Closely observe a group of people, either in a school, a village community, social activity such as a game of soccer. Reflecting on what we have said Sociology studies in society or human groups, indicate what issues would make your chosen group a subject matter of Sociology and how. Write your findings in a short paper. (not more than five to seven pages).

LESSON TWO

SOCIOLOGY OF EDUCATION

Introduction

Under the branches of sociology, we have listed Sociology of Education as a branch of Sociology. We want to learn more about this branch because of these reasons;

- (a) The course you are now taking is entitled 'Sociology of Education'.
- (b) You are perhaps in some educational experience, either as a teacher or an administrator.
- (c) You need to understand or obtain a deeper knowledge of the social side of education.

The chapter will discuss a number of areas concerning the Sociology of Education namely,

- (a) The definition or meaning of sociology of education.
- (b) The origins, development and the role of sociology of education.
- (c) The issues that sociology of education addresses
- (d) The connection between sociology and education.

This chapter will therefore, serve as an introduction to the rest of the topics in this unit. All the chapters subsequent to this one concentrate on studying the various concerns and questions in the education and schooling processes which, we hope, will contribute greatly towards your being more aware of, appreciating and wanting to know more about education sociologically.

Learning Objectives



At the end of this chapter you should be able to do the following:

- (i) Define or state the meaning of Sociology of Education.
- (ii) Discuss the origins, development and the role of Sociology of Education
- (iii) Show the issues or concerns, and concepts that Sociology of Education addresses in education.
- (iv) Explain how Sociology and Education are connected.
- (v) Explain why teachers should study and know more about Sociology of Education

Key words

Names

Concepts

- Sociology of Education - John Dewey
- Education - Emile Durkheim

- Olive Banks
- Sir. Fred Clarke
- Karl Mannheim
- W.A.C Stewart
- Ivor Morrish

Definition/meaning and Role of Sociology of Education

In our first chapter, under the branches of Sociology, we have said sociology of education is a branch of sociology rather than of education. Dr. Olive Banks emphasized this idea of Sociology of Education being a branch of sociology and not education, in her book (The sociology of Education, 1968). How do we define Sociology of Education? It can be defined as a

‘Major and specialized branch of Sociology which systematically and scientifically studies the sociological issues, problems and questions that occur within the education phenomenon’

By this definition, we mean that Sociology of Education uses well planned methods and procedures of the research process to investigate and analyze the concerns that are sociological in nature but affect, influence or have impact on education, school, teachers, pupils, and the learning-teaching activities inside the classrooms and the schools; in general for example, the academic achievement of pupils, the relationships between teachers and pupils that may affect the learning-teaching-activities. This definition also means that Sociology of Education is designed to examine various other social forces and components outside the education and school phenomena that have an effect on them. It is because of its ability and the need to the analyse and examine the various environments surrounding the total education process that Sociology of Education came into being and has continued to grow.

The Role of Sociology of Education

The role of Sociology of Education is wholly geared towards enlightening all of us as schoolteachers, administrators, policy makers and planners, parents and the general public, on how the education process in society is like. The Sociology of Education is meant to analyze, examine, investigate or study the various features of education that are affected by an also affect the society. It describes and suggests possible solutions to problems, gives recommendations and implications for and to education but like Sociology, it avoids sounding prescriptive. Ultimately, Sociology of Education provides a specialized sociological perspective of looking at the education process so that we all may obtain more dependable knowledge about and understand it better socially.

Why is this role of Sociology of Education so important? First, education is one of the six major social institutions that we talked about earlier. Second, as a social institution, it is organized, structured, maintained and supported by society so as to fulfill a vital function

that society perse cannot effectively deal with. Third, education and especially the schools, deal with the children, a precious commodity in any human society. Fourth in every human society, we can find evidence of an education system or activities that cost a lot of in terms of human energy and resources. Finally, education in any society is meant to contribute immensely to the development, growth and the well being of all the societal members.

The Origins and Development of Sociology of Education

In modern times, we mainly recognize trained sociologists, educationists or educators as the most likely individuals to have or show interest in studying the education process sociologically. But whereas the origins of Sociology did not have unquestionable beginnings, the new branch of Sociology of Education did. When it was suggested at the end of the 19th century and the start of the 20th century, many educationists and sociologists could not reach a clear consensus on what would be its meaning and function. The reason was how to marry a seemingly well developed scientific area of discipline. Sociology and an ‘non discipline activity called education.

The debate went on until later when two educationists cum sociologists, by the names of Emile Durkheim and John Dewey were able to show that Education comprised themes, conditions practices and characteristics that needed a sociological understanding. The contributions of each one of these two individuals are worthy noting in the origins of Sociology of Education. We shall now discuss what their contributions were towards the marriage between Sociology and Education.

Emile Durkheim (1858-1917) and his contributions

Emile Durkheim was a Frenchman based in the Department of Science of Education at the Sorbonne University in Paris. While there, Durkheim was the Chairman of this Department and also a lecturer and a trainer of teachers. As a sociologist also, he was able to use this opportunity to show how Sociology and Education could merge. In his contributions, Durkheim theoretically emphasized that Education is (i)

Social in Origin – meaning that it comes from society.

(ii) A social thing – that it is owned by society.

(iii) Social in character – that it reflects the behaviour of society (iv) Social in function – that it serves the needs in society.

(v) A social fact and activity – Full of facts and actions found in society (vi) A socializing activity – plays a role in the socialization process in society.

All these features of education in society needed to be ascertained, not through heresay and speculations but instead, through the sociological methods of actual observations as recommended by Auguste Comte. Because of his contributions, Emile Durkheim is often honoured as the ‘father of Sociology of Education’.

John Dewey (1859-1952) and his contributions

John Dewey was an American who was highly respected, and still is, for his remarkable contributions in many disciplines such as Philosophy, Psychology, Sociology and

Education. In his contributions, John Dewey began by getting concerned about the relationship between society and schooling. In his concern he observed that,

- (i) The simple community life structures in his society was rapidly becoming complex one as more people migrated from the rural areas to urban areas.
- (ii) The school and church, all entrusted with the education of the children could hardly cope with the rapid changes:

The children as learners would be inadequately facilitated to fit in the new urban social life and ways of a rapidly/changing complex society; therefore a growing child risked facing utter confusion as he/she became an adult in an urban environment. Therefore, Dewey saw a problem, assessed it and arrived at a conclusion. He also found a practical solution by suggesting the beginning of a new concept he called 'the ideal school: The ideal school would prepare the children to live in the American rapidly changing urban society through

- (i) teaching them to develop a social spirit of cooperation in society;
- (ii) teaching them ways of eliciting this cooperation in the classroom; showing them the means of bringing the school into a relationship with a child's home and the general life in the neighbourhood. He saw the school as a child's second home, a miniature society in which the needs, hopes and interests of children and the expectations of the larger society would be addressed.

In this type of school, the child's social life would be prospered as he/she grows. Ultimately, the society would be more improved. This was John Dewey's contribution to the origin of Sociology of Education.

Later Developments of Sociology of Education

As a result of Emile Durkheim and John Dewey efforts it appeared that Sociology could merge with Education to form Sociology of Education. Further development of Sociology of Education were contributed to by a number of other people in later decades. Briefly, these individuals and their contributions were as follows;

- (a) Sir Fred Clarke: In the 1930's Clarke is noted for having emphasized that sociological knowledge be used when planning an education program to enable it to produce citizens with characters that are desirable in the society.
- (b) Karl Mannheim: In the 1940's, Karl Mannheim is noted for suggesting that education be used as a social technique to socially control and improve society.
- (c) W.A.C Stewart: In the 1950's, he proposed a course in the training of teachers that was based on a basic knowledge of Sociology.
- (d) Olive Banks; In 1968 Dr. Olive Banks strongly suggested that the future of sociology of education lies in it being a branch of sociology rather than education.
- (e) Ivor Morrish: In his book, 'The Sociology of Education: An introduction, (1975), Ivor Morrish emphasized that the growth of Sociology of Education in future, will depend on a close cooperation of sociologists in education, especially those with practical experience in the classroom or in some area of educational system, and educationists particularly those with some training in Sociology. Infact, for

Morrish, did not see so profitable to dwell anymore on whether Sociology of Education is a branch of Sociology or of Education. Instead, it would be more beneficial to be concerned with deciding which are the questions to answer, or the sociological issues to examine in education.

Concerns or Issues for Sociology of Education

In our definition of Sociology of Education, we hinted the nature of the issues or concerns in education that make up the content or scope of Sociology of Education. We emphasized that their nature is or should be sociological. This, in other words, means that since they are sociological, they can come from society and affect education, e.g. drugs problem. Similarly, the issues or concerns can come from education and affect society, e.g. lack of properly trained manpower, literacy vs illiteracy in society.

What exactly are the issues, concerns or questions is Sociology of Education interested in? There are many of them but we shall discuss only few major ones.

(a) Relationship between a society and its education system. In this issue we may for example, want to know or discover how and to what extent other social institutions like the family, economy, politics and religion are involved in the growth, maintenance, provisions, control and the general support of the education activity and schools in particular. When these institutions become weak, lax and distablized, the institution of education can and does suffer greatly. It is in this sense that this issue is of great concern for the Sociology of Education.

(b) Functions and contributions of Education

The questions that sociology of education would examine in this concern have to do with what are the functions, contributions, purposes or aims of an educational system in society. In other words, what is education for or aimed at fulfilling in a society? In answer to this question, education is generally considered as having important functions, for example, it.

- (i) Socializes those being educated;
- (ii) Transmits culture;
- (iii) Develops employable skills among those being educated;
- (iv) Brings about personality and behaviour changes;
- (v) Promotes the physical, mental and moral growths;
- (vi) Brings about desirable changes in the economic, social and technological areas;
- (vii) Enhances social integration and national unity;
- (viii) Prepares and facilitate individuals to obey authority and laws in society;
- (ix) Empowers individuals to develop own ideas, opinions, responsibility, decision making abilities and independent thinking.

Whereas these concerns may be positive contributions, Sociology of Education also studies the negative contributions of education, such as social stratification – class formation; ethnic and racial differentiation; social control and acquisition of power by individuals; acquisition of competitive instead cooperative attitudes in society. These types of questions are the one that make this issue an important source of concerns for Sociology

of Education. The answers form justifications for maintaining and supporting an education system in society as well as the need to keep on assessing education so as know where and how to change it.

(c) School as a Formal Social Organization

An organization is often defined as a social unit that is structured and intended to carry out or pursue specific task(s). Therefore, because all organizations are not structured to fulfill similar tasks, they are not comprised of the same elements. But there are, however, some elements which would be considered as the basic components in all organizations that can be characterized as formal organizations.

Basically a formal organization is characterized by these components:

- (i) A group of people who are charged with fulfilling the task(s) of the organization;
- (ii) A hierarchical arrangement of positions in which individuals are placed to fulfil the organizational tasks; the authority structure is vested in the positions;
- (iii) Assignment of activities, expectations and behaviour to accompany the positions within which activities are done;
- (iv) A set of rules and regulations to govern how individuals will fulfill the organizational activities, tasks or routine work;
- (v) Ways of guiding the decision making and the formal communication systems.
- (vi) The informal relationships between those in organization;
- (vii) The main goal of the organization to attain. The question that Sociology of Education tries to answer is whether the school, based on these characteristics, is a formal social organization and how it fulfills its tasks. Answers to such questions are important for Sociology of Education because they help to tell us about the value of an education activity in society;

(d) The Teacher and the Teaching Activity

In the school organization or community, the teacher is described as the ‘adult representative of society’. This is in itself a great honour. However, even when a teacher is so honoured, and the goal(s) of the organization is well known, if the appropriate means and resources to carry out the organizational activities are lacking, the goal(s) may not be realized. The teaching activity that the teacher carries out in school distinguishes the school as a unique structure in society. The teaching that the teacher does in the school organization and the ensuing interaction with the pupils forms a spearhead towards the attainment of goal(s) of the school. The interaction requires that the teacher should play a number of roles such as being an instructor, guide and counselor, evaluator, judge, decision maker, leader, surrogate parent and disciplinarian.

Since the roles are critical in the teacher’s socializing efforts, there is need to adequately educate, train and prepare the teacher professionally so as to enable him or her carry out the teaching activities satisfactorily. The teacher’s socialization activities have a purpose in society.

Therefore, taken together, the teacher and the teaching activities in the school are important and require the proper kind of facilitory support, will and power and will from society. If these are faulty or poorly provided, the society begins to blame the school organization and its components. It is in this sense that the issue of teachers and the teaching activity is a vital one for Sociology of Education.

(e) The Learner's Learning Environments

A growing child is inevitably is taught by and learns from various situations such as other children, parents, siblings, family, community members, the school teachers and by observation. All these situations form a learner's learning environments. These learning environments have the capacity to influence and determine a learner's acquisition of mental, physical and social knowledges; their present and future abilities; attitudes for interactions, integration and cooperation; behaviour changes and personality growth; individual experiences and competencies as well as discriminations. If the nature of the social environments is such that there is keen interest, coordinated efforts and adequate provisions, a growing child will develop as a well balanced, socially-adjusted and emotionally stable person ready to learn, benefit and lead a full life as a human being in society. On the other hand, if the social learning environments are such that there is indifference, ignorance, social discord, improper family care, condoning of permissive and deviant behaviour, lack of control and guidance, a growing child is bound to grow as an illtrained, ill-behaved person, socially maladjusted, feeble minded uncaring individual, indifferent and an irresponsible member of society. The ability and opportunity of such a child to lead a full-life in society would be greatly impaired.

Because of how important these learning environments may affect a learner's well-being, it is necessary for the teacher or any educator to understand and be aware of how and why the environments affect a learner. It is in this sense that the issue of a learner's learning environments have become a great concern for Sociology of Education.

Concepts in Sociology of Education

We have already said that Sociology of Education is a branch of Sociology. Also, we discussed the idea that Education is a phenomenon that occurs in human societies. Every society inevitably, colours its education system with the various characteristics, behaviours, needs, interests, purposes, expectations and other factors that are found in that society. All these are social phenomena that Sociology examines using its own conceptual framework.

Because of such social factors, Sociology of Education utilizes the same concepts as the ones Sociology uses when studying society. It uses concepts like; Society, Culture, Socialization, Social Stratification, Social Mobility, Social Interactions and relationships, Social position, role and status. Other concepts include Social change, Formal organizations, Authority, Curriculum, Deviancy and many more.

Connection Between Sociology and Education

From the beginning of this chapter, we have touched on many areas in which we can find a lot of evidence regarding the way's in which Sociology is connected to Education. We can find the evidence of connection, for example, in the sections where we have discussed.

- (i) The origins of Sociology of Education
- (ii) The similarity of concepts that Sociology and Sociology of Education use
- (iii) The fact that society is the target material for sociology and, also, it is the source of an education system which Sociology of Education studies.

In addition, we can find the evidence of connection in another way; that is, education, especially the schools, often serve as sources of data or information concerning the various socio-educational issues. Sociology and the other hand supplies the needed and suitable research methods for studying the issues. It is, therefore, important for you to carefully study the areas listed above to ensure that you have understood this connection. You will no doubt, find that Sociology and Education have a lot to offer each other.

Importance of Sociology of Education to a School Teacher

Why should a school teacher know more about Sociology of Education? Should Sociology or Sociology of Education be made part of the teacher training? These are very critical questions. Let us look at a few reasons. Sociology, and particularly Sociology of Education.

- (a) Introduces the school teacher to a new view-the sociological perspective of understanding the total realm of education; that is the schools, teaching activities, teachers, pupils and many other components.
- (b) Acquaints the teacher with the nature of the existing and upcoming socio-educational problems that may come into the running of the school and the classroom.
- (c) Enhances the teacher's role in terms of knowing and being aware of how he/she is doing especially in the classroom when interacting with learners more closely; this is an opportunity for the socialization to take place and not simply an exercise in passing on information.
- (d) Enables the teacher to conceptualize the school community in its entirety as an outgrowth of the larger society, in which there will be conflicts, stresses, competition, agreements and disagreements; moments of joy and sadness, expectations, attitudes, behaviour problems, norms, likes and dislikes, successes and failures, disappointments, stars and isolates; problems of cooperation, motivation, peer-identity, morality and many others. All these require that the teacher should expect and know how to deal with them in ways that would contribute positively to the teaching-learning activities and the smooth running of the school organization.

- (e) Helps the teacher to acknowledge the social purpose of education from a wider societal perspective and not from a narrow personalized-self interest approach
- (f) Helps the teacher to view himself/herself as a change agent using democratic resolutions instead of applying authoritarian and high-handed commands;
- (g) Enables the teacher to learn more about and hopefully apply the research procedures that Sociology of Education uses to obtain and accumulate the dependable knowledge about education.

Summary



In this chapter, we have defined Sociology of Education as a 'major and specialized branch of Sociology which systematically and scientifically studies the sociological issues, problems and questions that occur within the education phenomenon. The role of Sociology of Education was given as that of helping all of us to understand how the education process is like socially. In the origins and development of Sociology of Education, several names were mentioned together with their contributions. Several concerns were cited as being major issues in Sociology of Education as follows; the relationship between Society and Education; school as a formal social organization; functions and contributions of education; the teacher and the teaching activities; the learner's learning environments. It was mentioned that Sociology and Sociology of Education deal with similar concepts and that this is one aspect through which there is evidence of connection between Sociology and Sociology of Education. Finally, the chapter ended by citing several reasons regarding why sociology and sociology of education are important in the training of teachers.

Questions/Activities



- (1) Explain what is meant by the term 'Sociology of Education' Discuss the origins and development of Sociology of Education.
- (2) What is the role of Sociology of Education? What concepts is Sociology of Education concerned with in the education phenomenon?
- (3) Choose any area from among the ones which were discussed as is the main issues that Sociology of Education examines. Then pick a school and using that school, determine and write down questions (at least four questions) that fall under the issue of your choice. Answer the questions using what you have learned about education socially.

- (4) In what sense would you say that Sociology of Education would be beneficial to you as a teacher? When answering this question, think of and use examples of your own, from your experience and school.

LESSON FOUR

RESEARCH IN EDUCATION: APPROACHES AND ISSUES

Introduction

In this chapter, we would like to introduce you to the main research ways that sociology of education uses to acquire knowledge. One of the facts that we have already discussed is that sociology was destined to be on its feet with its own theories, facts and methods. Also, we have said that Auguste Comte meant that sociology would use scientific actual observations in accumulating its facts instead of depending on myths and speculations. What Comte emphasized about sociology being a science and using scientific observations, is embodied in the process that we refer to as 'scientific research'.

The main intention of this chapter is to inform you about the means that sociology of education uses in studying education. We shall not teach you how to carry out or conduct scientific research here since that would be a different course. However, we shall present the following:

- (i) Definitions of terms 'research and educational research'
- (ii) Briefly describe the main 'research approaches' that sociology of Education can use; that is, the descriptive, historical and experimental approaches. (iii) List the methods, instruments, and steps used in educational research.
- (v) Briefly discuss the research issues that may have an impact of educational research. **Objectives**



At the end of this chapter you should be able to do the following:

- (i) Define or state the meaning of Sociology of Education.
- (ii) Discuss the origins, development and the role of Sociology of Education
- (iii) Show the issues or concerns, and concepts that Sociology of Education addresses in education.
- (iv) Explain how Sociology and Education are connected.
- (v) Explain why teachers should study and know more about Sociology of Education

At the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

1. Define the terms 'research' and educational research.

2. Name and briefly discuss the main research approaches in educational research.
3. List the methods used in educational research.
4. List the steps that educational research uses.
5. Discuss the issues having an impact on educational research.

Key Words/concepts

Research

Educational research

Formal

Scientific

Deliberate

Definitions of Research and Educational Research

Research

What is meant by research? For our purpose, we will define the term research in general as,

The formal, systematic and deliberate process which applies the scientific procedures to study, examine or investigate problems, questions and issues so as to:

- (a) Provide answers or solutions to questions and problems in life;
- (b) Discover and develop new knowledge about phenomena
- (c) Verify, ascertain, correct and update existing, wrong and old knowledge about phenomena.

Educational Research

Having defined research as above, we should have no difficulties defining the term educational research. We will define it this way:

Educational research is the application of the formal, systematic and deliberate process of the scientific procedures in the study of education so as to,

- (a) Provide answers and solutions to problems/issues and questions in education.
- (b) Discover and develop new knowledge about education;
- (c) Verify ascertain, correct and update existing facts, wrong and old knowledge about education.

In our definitions, we have used four important words namely:-

- (i) Formal – research is done following accepted, recognized order, rules and regulations; it is written and/or recorded.
- (ii) Systematic – research is a step by step process; not done in a haphazard, disorderly manner.
- (iii) Deliberate – research is planned, has a purpose, aim or reason.
- (iv) Scientific – research, especially social research, follows the investigative ways or methods that the natural sciences use.

Why do we have to learn about research? The answer to this question is crucial so as to realize what role the research approaches play in sociology of education.

- (i) Sociology of education is a branch of sociology.
- (ii) Sociology uses the scientific research procedures or methods to study the reality of social phenomena.
- (iii) Education and schooling are social phenomena. They are part of the social reality.
- (iv) Therefore, sociology of education must inevitably borrow and use the same scientific research approaches as sociology uses.

Broad Research Approaches

There are at least three main research approaches that sociology of education uses when studying problems and questions related to education as a social process. We shall discuss these approaches:

- (i) Descriptive
- (ii) Historical;
- (iii) Experimental approaches

(i) Descriptive Approach

This approach involves studying phenomena by describing: e.g.

- Behaviour of students
- Attitudes of teachers
- School functions or activities
- Academic performance of students
- Voters attitudes and many other phenomena

Descriptive approach collects information that describes or answers questions concerning a current or present situation of a social setting such as a school. The descriptive approach analyzes and reports information as it is at present. The main questions that this approach tries to answer are:

What is, why is and how is the present situation? For example, what is the status of performance among class eight students? What are the perceptions of parents about their neighbourhood school?

The descriptive approach is conducted so as to investigate the current status of many units such as schools or teachers in a given location or division. It is also conducted to study the existing condition of a single unit for example, a single school or class.

The descriptive approach uses the survey, case study and observation as the main methods or techniques. Whereas the survey method is appropriate in study many units scattered over a large area, the case study is suitable in studying a single case. The observation technique can be applied to study many units or a single unit. Each of these method uses the following tools or instruments either singly or more in order to collect information or data.

- (a) Questionnaire
- (b) Interview
- (c) Observation

Normally, the sources of data for the descriptive approach are a variety of fields, for example, a collection of teachers or pupils in various schools.

(iii) Historical Approach

The historical approach involves the study of phenomenon or phenomena so as to understand and explain the phenomenon in the light of the past time. This approach is carried out with the intention of knowing about the past trends, effects or causes related to past events. Through the historical approach, we can learn, for example the past developments, changes, problems and many other concerns that may have had impacts on an event. For example, we can study questions like, the development or growth of teacher education from, say, year 1900 to 2000; The growth of private school since 1960; Trends in the growth of University Education in Kenya since independence; Influence of the British system of Education on Kenya's system of education before and after independence. All these questions require a historical approach for their investigation.

Since the historical approach is more concerned with examining past events and occurrences, it tries to answer questions (like, what was, how was and why was a situation like in the past events or occurrences, discover how and why the past occurrence may have influenced or had an impact on the present events; for example, what social events in the past have influenced or impacted on the social image of teachers?

Because it is more oriented towards studying past phenomena, the historical approach obtains information or data related to such phenomena mainly from stored documents or sources. Such sources contain information or data that can show what, why and how was the phenomenon like in the past. Included in the sources are files, for example school files' reports, for example recorded deliberations of school boards and committees

;personal diaries biographies and autobiographies kept in the national archive and libraries; encyclopedias, reference and text books; works of art, literature, music and play scripts; including information obtained from elderly individuals who may have been involved in or witnessed a particular event. As you can see, the historical approach has a wealth of sources and these are just part of a long list.

The historical approach uses various methods, tools or instruments in collecting data. These include, documents and content analysis, interviews, observations and the questionnaires.

(iii) Experimental Approach

The experimental approach involves the manipulation of varying or changing the value of one factor, referred to as the independent variable, so as to observe its effects or impact on a second factor called the dependent variable. Compared to the other two approaches, the experimental approach is probably the least used in educational research. The reason is because researchers have a difficult task in controlling as well as manipulating variables. Control of variables is especially hard when it comes to studying subjects in the field out of a laboratory situation. An example of a study that can be conducted using the experimental approach is one whereby two groups or more are compared with regard to their behaviour or performance when treated differently. In such a case the model of treatment (independent variables) is varied with each group receiving a different treatment. The observed different behaviours or performances are the affected outcome or the dependent variable. For instance, we can study two groups (A & B) of students with respect to their performance in a final examination. Each group would be taught same subject but using a different instructional method. Group A would be taught a topic in history by their teacher using the blackboard and chalk Group B would be self-taught by reading the same topic material from a text book. At the end of the term the teacher will examine the two groups and then compare them as performance.

The experimental approach tries to find out what will be the results later after manipulating the variable (iv). It is therefore futuristic in the type of questions and answers it tackles. It deals with questions like what will it be, how will it be and why will it be like this or that? This approach uses one instrument or tool, and that is observation, for collecting data.

Research Issues in Educational Research

What are some of the concerns in general research that may have an impact on educational research? There are many of them but we shall deal with only three issues namely:- (i) Is education a science? Is there a science in education?

- (ii) Should education use quantitative or qualitative strategies in analyzing its problems and questions?
- (iii) What ethical considerations should educational researchers observe?

(i) Is education a science or is there a science of education?

This issue searches for the sense in which we are obligated to use the scientific research procedures in the study of education. If there is a science in education, then we may be

correct to apply the scientific research procedures. But if there is nothing like a science of education, then it is not correct to apply the research procedures.

In 1981, a philosopher called Josiah Royce argued that there was no science in education and, therefore, we could not rightly apply the scientific research methods in studying education. But education has theories which it has adopted and uses them to explain its operation. We have already discussed the sociological theories and how they can be used in education. Also, education has **principles** and **facts**, for example principles of teaching and school administration. The theories, principles and facts constitute the science in education. Therefore, education has a science and because of that we can apply the scientific research procedures so as to find out which theories can explain it better, which principles work and what facts belong to education. This issue is therefore, one without any important effect on educational research.

(ii) Should education use quantitative strategy or qualitative method of analyzing the problems and questions?

Since education involves human beings, the issue here is to determine whether the human activities such as education and behaviour are conceptualized better when we quantify them using numbers, or when we qualify them using descriptive words.

This issue, like the one above, should not have great effect on educational research. The reason is because some problems or questions in education need to be quantitatively analyzed such as student's performance and ranking, whereas others like the behaviour, attitudes, opinions of school children towards or in given situations require qualitative descriptions for greater understanding. Therefore, the important factor in this issue is to understand the kind of educational problem or question you are dealing with in order to decide which strategy quantitative or qualitative would be suitable.

(iii) What ethical considerations should a researcher in education be aware of?

This issue, unlike the other two above, is very important. Research in education involves studying human beings and their phenomena, unlike in physical research. This fact creates a number of ethical concerns and dilemmas that can affect educational research. There are a number of ethical rules that we should be cognizant of when we make human being the target of scientific research. Some of these are that if human being are involved in a research study.

- (a) They should not be harmed in any way – mentally, psychologically, physically, emotionally or morally for the sake of obtaining information or in the name of scientific research. If a research study involves any risk, the subjects should be informed. Permission to participate would thus be obtained by written authorization if school children would thus be obtained by written, authorization. If school children are involved in a study, for example, the parents or guardians should be informed and written permission secured from them. It is thus unethical for a researcher to do otherwise.

- (b) Their right to privacy – should be respected and protected. Thus observing human beings without telling them or collecting information from them without their knowledge or permission is not ethical. If any information like a student's personal scores, are to be collected they must be kept strictly confidential, not to be made public in any way. This can be accomplished by presenting such scores in form of group statistics or codes which not associated with individual names or any other personal identifying information. This rule strongly emphasizes that each one of us has the right to decide and grant what kind of information about our personal and private lives becomes public information. It is therefore unethical for a researcher to secretly obtain and then disclose a person's private life details without that persons expresses consent.
- (c) Researcher's integrity and honesty is paramount. This ethical consideration locks out the tendencies for deception and instead emphasizes the absolute need for honesty in conducting research work, obtaining information and finally analyzing and reporting the results. In other words, the researcher must say exactly what went on, how he or she carried out the research and the actual outcome. Thus anyone who reads the research work must be made to believe that what is claimed to have been done, really was done. Otherwise, if data or information are falsified so as to agree with a hypothesized answer, this would be highly unethical.

Finally, educational research can be offered by a number of research oriented ethical considerations. These considerations were described as avoidance of hurting research subject mentally, physically, emotionally, morally or psychologically; respect for and protection of the rights of individuals privacy; researcher's integrity and honesty in carrying out a research study and reporting the results truthfully.

Summary



We have defined research as a formal, systematic and deliberate process which applies the scientific procedures in the study of problems, questions and issues. We have also defined education research as the application of the formal, systematic and deliberate process of the scientific procedures in the study of education.

Four words, formal systematic deliberate and scientific were explained with regard to what they implied in the definitions.

Educational research uses three major research approaches when problems and questions related to education are investigated. These are the descriptive, historical and experimental approach. We have discussed each approach with regard to the kinds of questions each is suitable to investigate. The descriptive approach is suitable in answering questions that concern the current status of a phenomenon using the survey, case study and observation as the main methods. Its tools were named as the questionnaire, interview and observation. The historical approach is more appropriate in addressing questions that pertain to be status of past events using the documents

analysis, interview, observation and the questionnaire as its methods and also the tools for collecting the data. On the other hand, the experimental approach is used to investigate questions that require answers based on future outcome. Its main method and tool is observations.

Questions and Activities



1. (a). Differentiate between general research and educational research.
(b) What is meant by the statement 'educational research is the application of the formal, systematic and specific research procedures'?
2. Name and differentiate the three major research approaches that educational research uses in studying questions/problems in education.
3. Imagine that you are a teacher-researcher in your school. Your school is faced with the problem of mass failure of students following end of term and national exams. If you are told to study this problem and find why the problem is there; (i) Which research approach would you choose to use and why?
(ii) Name the method(s) you can use to examine this problem and the tools that you think are most suitable in collecting information.

LESSON FIVE

SOCIOLOGY OF THE SCHOOL: SCHOOL AS A SOCIAL ORGANIZATION

Introduction

In another chapter, we have learned about socialization; a process through which we, as members of society, are taught and learn how to become responsible and useful people in one's society. We have also learned that through education as a social institution, we become socialized. The socialization that we go through is carried out within various settings such as the family, community, the peer groups, and by a number of agents. The socialization process also occurs within the school system where we meet teachers, pupils and other workers. All of them socialize us in various ways. The socialization that we receive within the families, community and the peer group members, can be categorized as the informal type in the sense that it is done without following any particular rules. But the type of socialization that we go through in education, specifically in the school, is the formal type in the sense that the activities and routines are carried out adherent to established form or code, such as the rules and regulations. This view makes the school a formal organization in society. In this chapter we shall examine the school as a formal social organization, sociologically. We shall do the following:

- i. Define the term 'formal social organization' as well as the school as formal social organization;
- ii. Outline the factors that characterize a formal social organization ;

- iii. Determine how or whether the school is a formal social organization;
- iv. Discuss the social roles that the school plays in society;

Learning objectives



At the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- (1) Define the term formal social organization.
- (2) Discuss what characteristics a formal social organization exhibits.
- (3) Examine and illustrate what makes or how the school is conceptualised as a formal social organization.
- (4) State either,
 - (i) the school IS a formal social organization
 - or (ii) the school is NOT a formal social organization

A. Meaning of Formal, Social Organization

What is an organization? In this chapter for our purpose, we shall define an organization as an entity that is structured in society to serve or pursue a specific objective(s) / goal(s). In 1964, Amitai Etzioni viewed organizations as social units which have been designed in society to carry out certain activities towards the fulfillment of their assigned goals. Using our definition and Etzioni's view, we can conclude that organizations by nature are social since they are structured by, found in and perform activities so as to attain goals in society. However, organizations do not carry out their activities haphazardly. Instead, they follow certain prescribed, established and written rules and regulations. This idea makes organizations also formal. Examples of formal, social organizations include the following: a university, hospital, police force, military, a prison, company, political party, soccer club, and many others.

According to some writers, formal organizations like these examples, tend to be larger, more complex and enduring compared to other human collections in society. They are highly structured and do emphasize orientation toward attaining their goal (Marsden 1988; Scott 1987). We shall hear more about such perceptions when we examine the characteristics of formal organizations.

(B) FACTORS CHARACTERIZING A FORMAL SOCIAL ORGANIZATION

In order to distinguish a formal, social organization from any other collection of human beings in society, we must learn and understand what factors are perceived to be the characteristics of a formal, social organization. There are many of these factors as follows:

- (i) Presence of humans or people. In any formal, social organization there must be people. They are professional, highly educated, trained with specialized skills while others are not. They are both males and or females; they come with

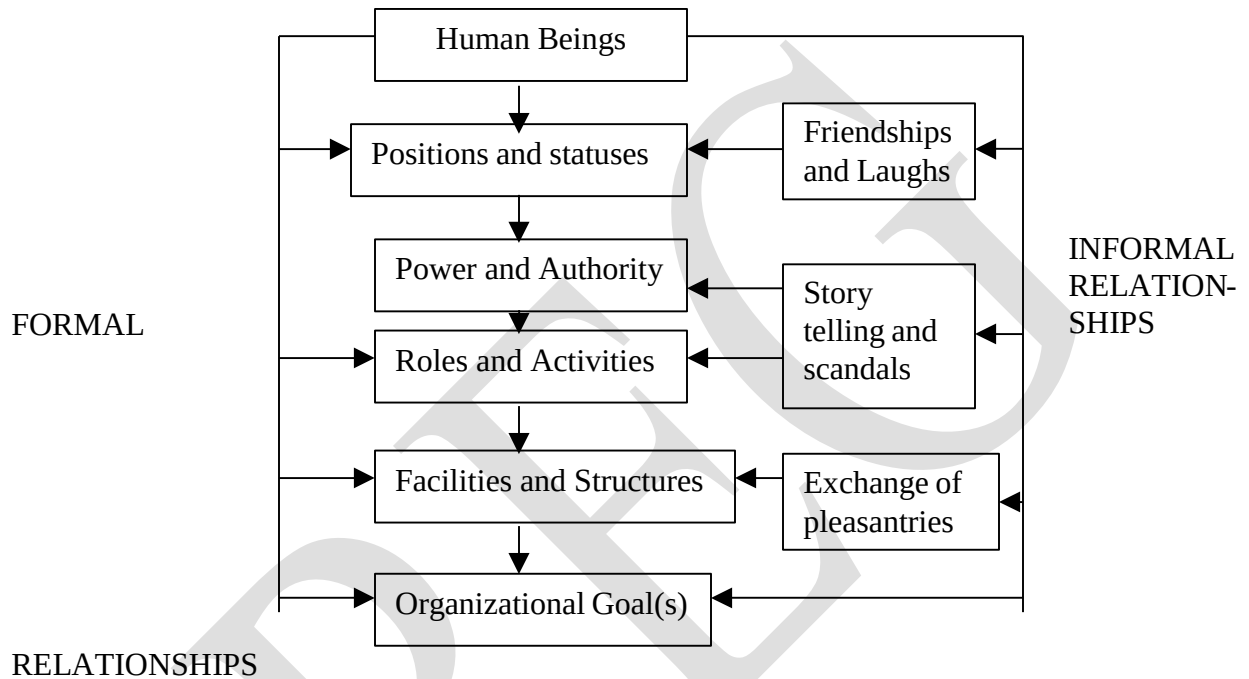
different aptitudes, attitudes, perceptions, drives, expectations, behaviours, complexions and even sizes. However, all of them have a purpose or reason why they are in the organization.

- (ii) Hierarchical order of positions. In a formal, social organization there are different positions that people occupy while serving in it. Such positions are arranged in a hierarchy starting with the position that carries the most power or authority to the position holding the least. For example, there are manager's, director's, or the headteacher's position. Depending on the position held, people are also given relative standing or status in the organization. Within the organizational hierarchy there is the inbuilt bureaucracy that typifies each organization.
- (iii) Roles and Activities. As occupants of the various positions, people are expected to perform different activities, tasks or duties as well as exhibit certain roles. A role is a set of behaviours which a given position occupant is expected to exhibit in the formal social organization. For example, a manager manages and makes decision; a headteacher administers the schools' activities and makes decisions. But both of them must portray different behaviours commensurate with the positions and activities.
- (iv) Presence of rules and regulations. A formal social organization has rules and regulations. These are codified or written formally to guide and to be followed by the position occupants when carrying out their activities and portraying their roles in the informal organization. The rules and regulations govern the relationships among the people, decision making patterns, organizational routines and climate, all of which are meant to nurture the wellbeing of the organization.
- (v) Relationships. In a formal organization there are what are referred to as the formal and informal relationships. Formal relationships operate when people are performing organizational tasks, making decisions pertaining to the organizational tasks and also in the lines of communication and interaction. Ideally, it is expected that there will be impersonal orientation or detachment, on the part of those in the organization especially when serving clients. That is, a formal social organization and its workers are supposed to serve all people equally without favouring some while denying others on the basis of factors like personal feelings, blood relatives or nepotism and friendship. In other words, a formal social organization must be characterized by a 'service neutrality'. On the other hand, the informal relationships operate mostly during and for leisure time wherever people are found. Informal relationships are, therefore, unavoidable during and within the work situations or time; for example, telling stories, scandals, or just exchanging pleasantries, friendships and holding parties.
- (vi) Presence of a goal(s). Every formal, social organization has a goal(s) which it has either been given by society or it has given itself. All occupants of positions and their activities must work towards the goal attainment or realization.
- (vii) Facilities and structures. Most, if not all formal, social organizations, are normally housed in some structures like buildings, offices and such others. These structures and other facilities inside, permit the organization to perform

its functions easily, store records as well as providing comfort for those doing the organizational work.

These are the main characteristics of formal social organizations which can easily be illustrated as follows in this diagram;

Fig. 1: The main formal Social Organization Characteristics



School as a Formal Social Organization

After understanding what a formal, social organization means and its characterizing features, the main question to ask is whether the school is a formal social organization. In other words are these the same characteristics that the school exhibits? How does it show such characteristics? If the answer is yes, then the school can be viewed as a formal, social organization. If the answer is no, then the school cannot be called a formal social organization.

We shall examine each characteristic in the light of the school. See also figure 2. (a)
The Human factor:

The school exhibits this characteristic in a number of ways. First, there is society or community members in form of parents. They are the owners of the school; maintain, support and are thus the source of legitimacy for the existence, organization and operation of the school. The human factor also includes the school committee or board members as consultative bodies, the headteacher, deputy headteacher and other teachers. There are also the subordinate staff and the learners.

(b) School hierarchy factor

The hierarchy arrangement in the daily running of the school, begins with the headteacher. The position holds the highest power and authority in the school. The deputy headteacher position comes next followed by the class teacher, subordinate staff and the learners positions.

(c) Roles and activities factors

In the school there are many activities that all the human beings in it carry out. The day-to-day school administration and or management activities, are entrusted in the highest school positions; that is, the headteacher and the deputy headteachers. They are the main decision makers to ensure that conformity to the decisions concerning the various school activities occur. The teaching-learning activities are vested in the class teacher to organize, plan, oversee and ensure that there exists an environment conducive to these activities occurring in the most desirable ways. Meanwhile, all these position holders are expected by society to reflect the roles that are commensurate with the positions held and the respective activities. They are also supposed to be professionals, be impartial and exercise the service neutrality of the school organization.

(d) Rules and regulations factor.

In order for the school activities to run smoothly and in coordinated manner, there must be formally established rules and regulations. These are necessary to also guide the school operations, interactions and relationships. All the people found in the school must therefore, obey such rules and regulations. Conformity is required. One example of the rules and regulations that must be obeyed by both the teachers and pupils is the time for starting school activities everyday. Reporting to school in proper or the prescribed uniform, is a rule that learners must observe and conform. Similarly, there are rules and regulations requiring that teachers carry on their teaching duties responsibly giving equal attention to all the learners. For the headteacher and the deputy, there are rules and regulations which govern and assist them in decision making, control of the overall school operations and even what actions to take, for example, if non-conformity to the rules and regulations occurs among the teachers, subordinates staff and the pupils. Needless to say that the rules and regulations that are found in the school may come from a number of sources. These sources include the government through the Ministry of Education and the Teachers' Service Commission; the school board/committee; the internally sanctioned rules and regulations set by each school administration and even the ones prescribed by the individual class teachers.

(e) The Relationship factors:

Since the school is largely made up of live human beings, besides non-living elements like buildings and playing fields, there will inevitably be social relationships. People, when they meet, will interact. Often, the outcome of the interactions is that all kinds of relationships will emerge, for example, positive and negative relationships. In the school there are formal relationships involving, for example, the

- (i) School board/committee and the headteacher,
- (ii) Headteacher and the deputy headteacher,
- (iii) Headteacher and teacher(s)
- (iv) Headteacher and subordinate staff
- (v) Teacher and other teachers
- (vi) Teacher and pupils
- (vii) Among the non-teaching staff
- (viii) Among pupils especially between prefects and the other pupils.

Also, there are informal relationships occurring especially among the pupils, among the non-teaching staff and even the teachers.

(f) The Goal(s) of the School Factor

The school in any society or community is part of such systems and it is set to pursue goal(s) that is commensurate with fulfilling the needs of the society. Sometimes, it is possible for a given school to set and pursue its own goal, for example the winner of soccer tournaments every year in the next ten years. However, it remains mainly difficult to separate the school major social goal from that of society or community of which it is part. Any society has the need and the responsibility to ensure that all its members become educated. But since the society does not fulfill all its social goals perse, it delegates such goals to its social institutions. Therefore, the education of the members of society is mainly entrusted to the social institution called education. In turn, this social institution has given the large part of its task to the school, colleges and universities. Consequently they have the same goal as that of the social institution and ultimately, that of the total society.

Besides the social goal, the school organization carries out other functions in society. For example, the school

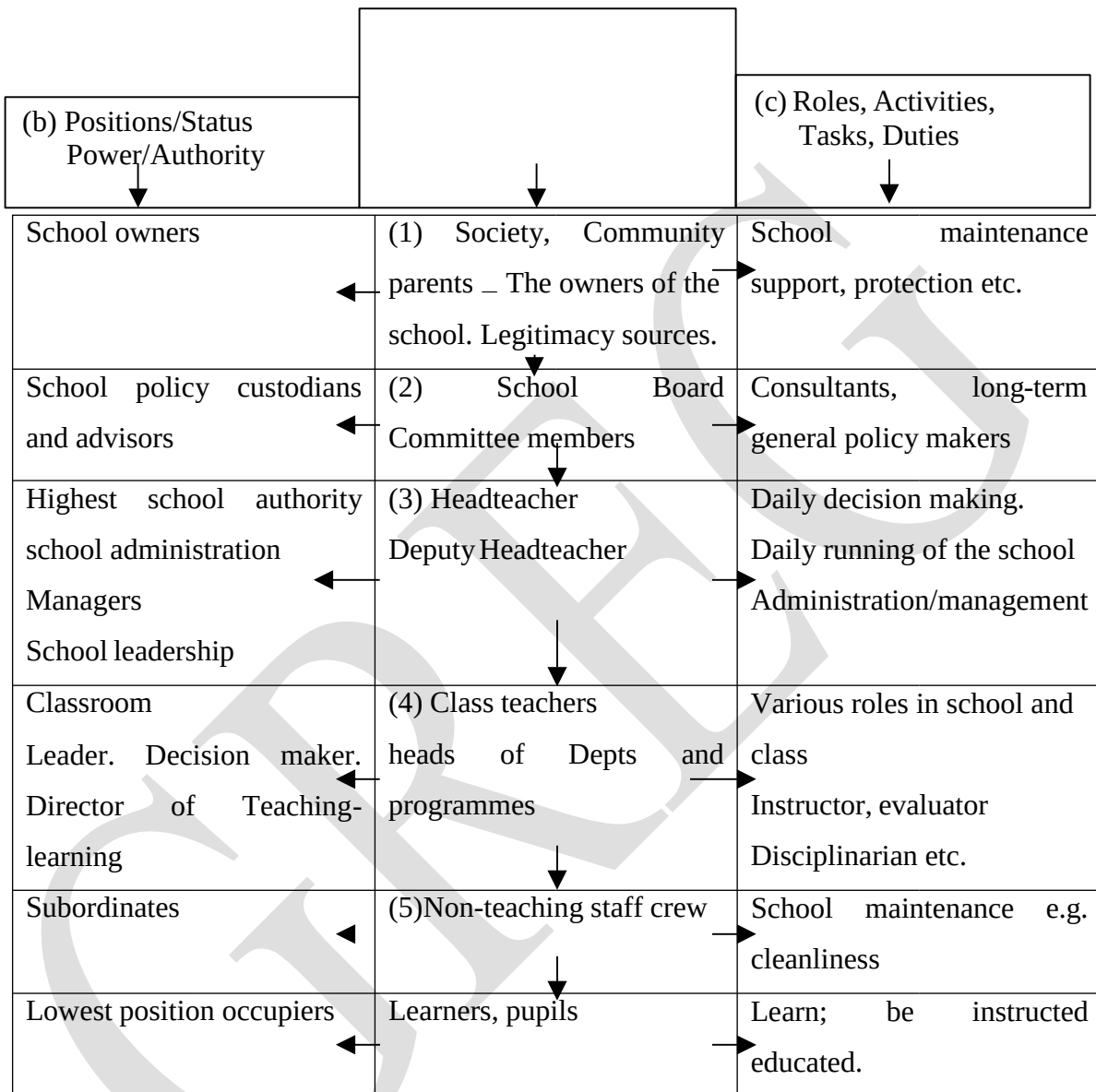
- (i) Transmits and preserves society's culture
- (ii) Reforms character/behaviour of the learners
- (iii) Facilitates social mobility or ascent
- (iv) Facilitates allocation of social positions
- (v) Innovates/inculcates various new skills (technological mental etc) in the learners
- (vi) Emancipates the young ones from the primary care of the family.

Together with these positive/desirable functions, the school also performs other functions which are not so desirable socially; for example, the school plays a part in

- (i) Power acquisition or enhancing of feelings of being powerful
- (ii) Stratification or class formation
- (iii) Indoctrination of ideas in others
- (iv) Enhancing competitive attitudes in society

After studying all these factors exhibited by the school, it can be concluded that the school has all the major characteristics that make a structure a social organization. In short, the school is a formal social organization. The diagram below depicts the ways or characteristics, which makes the school a formal social organization.

Fig. 2 The main characteristics of the School as a Formal Social Organization



The column shown as the human structure hierarchy, shows the hierarchical arrangement of the people in the school organization. It is labeled (a). The (b) Column also suggests the power or authority vested in the position. In the (c) column, it is shows what roles, duties, tasks or activities that these in (a) perform in the school organization. The arrows pointing down from the human structure hierarchy are mean to indicate the flow of formal relationships that are possible. The informal relationships are inbuilt within the organizational roles players. (Adopted from Ezewu, pp. 96,100).

Questions/Activities



1. Define the term 'school organization'; in what ways can you tell whether the school is a formal organization?
2. Select and study one secondary or one primary school with regard to the social relationships in the schools. Classify these relationships as formal or informal in each school. Cite and discuss what kinds of relationships occur among teachers, among students, and between teachers and students. How do these relationships affect the functions of the schools you have studied?
3. Write an essay, about five pages, discussing what goal(s) that a school of your choice has in its organization, which one it has achieved, and which one it has still to achieve. Find out what kinds of obstacles are preventing the goal(s) to be achieved.
4. What is the importance of the rules and regulations in the school organization? For this question interview few teachers (five to ten) and few students (about same number) and then compare their responses regarding whether the two groups agree fully or disagree totally. Are there some responses in which there is agreement while in others there is disagreement? Can you find out why (reasons) there is no consensus (if any)?

LESSON SIX

THE SCHOOL CLASSROOM

Introduction

In the foregoing chapter, we have talked about the school as a formal, social organization and its various characteristics. However, we must realize that the major work of the school organization does not occur in the structure called the school. Instead, it occurs in the school classrooms, where the teacher, learners, teaching and learning activities and the various symbols representing such activities are found. It is therefore, essential to understand and conceptualize some of the important aspects of the school classroom sociologically. Inevitably, because the classroom is part of the school organization, some of the points discussed in the foregoing chapter will be mentioned again.

In this chapter, we shall learn about the school class from a sociological standpoint, paying attention to the following two points:

- (1) The definition of a school classroom,
- (2) The major social characteristics of a school classroom namely;
 - (a) The human component
 - (b) Social relationships
 - (c) Social activities and pupils' roles
 - (d) Social goal of the school classroom.

Learning Objectives



At the end of the chapter, you shall be able to:

- (1) Define the term 'School classroom;
- (2) Cite and discuss the various characteristics of a school classroom.

(1) The school classroom: Definition.

What is meant by the term 'school classroom?' The school classroom can be defined as 'a miniature social structure within the school organization in which socially ordered and measurable activities in the school setting are conducted so that the goal of the school organization is achieved. The activities involve a deliberate and active transfer of

knowledge, skills, values, attitudes and others, from one person such as teacher, to a group of people such as the learners. There are, therefore, a number of classroom characteristics that assist in identifying this school structure as a classroom.

(2) School classroom characteristics

(a) Presence of the human component

A school classroom is made up of two main social actors, namely, the teacher and the learners, often referred to as the pupils or students.

The teacher: One of the definitions of the teacher is that the teacher is ‘an adult representative of society in the school organization’. Another one is that ‘the teacher is a socializer of others not so socialized’. The teacher is also described as the school organization leader in the classroom. In addition, the teacher is recognized as one who has undergone the socialization process longer than the learners; more aware of his/her society’s culture by having lived longer in its social settings; has acquired more basic education as well as professional training.

All these descriptions of someone who is a teacher, allow the teacher to fulfill a number of roles in the classroom in particular, but also in the school. In the classroom, the teacher plays certain assigned roles such as these:

- (i) Instructor: He/she is a knowledge custodian, a deliverer of new knowledge and skills, a facilitator of learning and a resource person.
- (ii) Evaluator: He/she is judge of the academic performance of the learners as well as whether the teaching is being done in the right manner, and also the materials for learning are adequate for the learners’ level of schooling.
- (iii) Disciplinarian: He/she is the source of authority to ensure that there is adherence and obedience to the rules and regulations. In this role the teacher determines the reward and punishment for those learners who obey on one hand, and those who happen to do what the rules and regulations have not prescribed. By so doing the teacher is modifier of learners’ behaviours and a change agent.
- (iv) Group leader: He/she is entrusted with guiding the classroom group, directing the learners in their various activities, managing and organizing other activities that will result in getting the classroom work well done. In this group leadership capacity he/she is also a motivator, inspiring urging and encouraging his/her group of learners to keep charging ahead in their academic work.
- (v) Mediator/conciliator” He/she is a consensus agent in the sense that whenever the learners disagree he/she tries to reconcile the differences, bring them to an agreement through dialogue, making the decision and judgement that would be acceptable to all the parties.
- (vi) Advisor: He/she aims at changing the behaviour of the learners, their personal attitudes, views and approach to life by counseling them, advising and listening to their agonies whenever they confide in him/her.

- (vii) Parent surrogate: He/she is entrusted with taking care of the learner's welfare in the absence of the biological parents during the time that the learners are in school.

Most, if not all these teachers roles do not end at the classroom level. Instead, they are part of his/her duties or work in the school organization as a whole.

The learners

The second part of human component in the school classroom is made up of the learners, often referred to as the pupils or students. The learners in almost all cases, join the school and the classroom that are already existing. The learners find these structures, some of them having been built and on-going for several months or years. In other words, the learners are not born into the school classroom systems. Instead, they enter the classroom so as to receive the 'goods and services' that the school organization is mandated by society to provide. We can thus categorize the learners as the immediate clients or recipients of these goods and services. The parents, and by extension the society, are the indirect beneficiaries of such goods and services. In other words, the learners are taught new knowledge, skills and their behaviours will be changed, hopefully, to desirable habits. Ultimately, upon joining their families and society there will be a spill over effect of these knowledges, skills, desirable habits, responsible individuals and other benefits into the families and society at large.

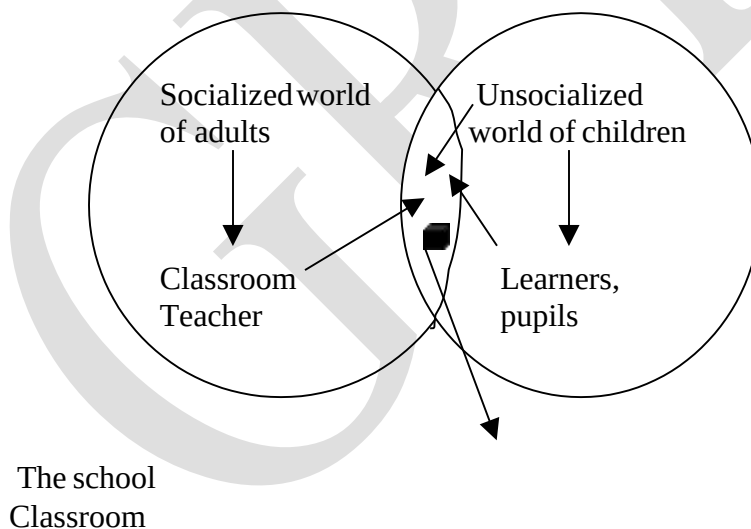
How can we define the learners? In primary and secondary levels of education, we can define the learners in the school classroom as a group of youngsters or children, numbering anywhere between thirty to sixty (30-60), who are considered to be less socialized, less familiar with their society's culture. In other words, the learners have spent less time in their society compared to the teacher. By undergoing basic education in the hands of the class teacher who is more socialized, the learners will be on their way to become more socialized beyond the primary socialization in their families. This is the main reason why they join the school organization and interact with the teacher in the classroom.

Learners as a peer group: The pupils or students in the classroom constitute a PEER GROUP; a collection of individuals who are 'equals' normally in terms of their ages, and whose interaction is that of equals. As members of a peer group, the pupils in the classroom accentuate a sense of belonging, identity and solidarity not only with regard to the peers but also in terms of the level of their class in the school organization. Often, for example, a child will be proud to tell you in which class he or she is in the school. These learners feelings of belongingness, solidarity and identification in the classroom are essential for the stability and cohesiveness that will make the socialization work by the teacher less difficult in the classroom setting.

Diversity of the classroom catchment Area: Both types of the human actors in the classroom (teachers and learners), come from different social settings. Some of their social backgrounds or situations are the different

- (i) Economic statuses
- (ii) Family and/or home types
- (iii) Ethnic origins
- (iv) Religious affiliators, beliefs
- (v) Rural areas
- (vi) Urban areas
- (vii) Behaviours, traditions, practices
- (viii) Opinions, ideas, perceptions
- (ix) Personalities and experiences
- (x) Expectations, needs

However, all of them meet in the school's microstructure, the classroom. Here, the major task and demand facing the teacher is to bring about an effective environment that will permit the socially desirable change and uniformity in such a diverse classroom group of learners so that the class and school organization social goals are realized. This idea of the social diversity in the classroom can be depicted briefly as follows:



We should realize also that it is the adult society through its appointed agent(s) which chooses and employs the classroom teacher, assigns the necessary responsibilities and pays the teachers. On the other hand, the learners have no say in, selecting who they would like to be their class teacher. Nor do the learners pay the teacher's salaries, but they are the direct beneficiaries of the teacher's work.

(b) The Social Relationships and Outcomes in the classroom

Like in the school organization, the relationships in the classroom can also be categorized as formal and informal .

The formal relationships: These can be described as teacher to pupil relationships. Such relationships are viewed as the relationships between two unequal parties. In this relationship, the class teacher is recognized by the learners as

- (i) The leader of the class;
- (ii) One who possesses more knowledge and authority than the pupils;
- (iii) One who is an adult, more mature and even physically stronger than the pupils;
- (iv) Someone who should be respected, obeyed; trusted and a parental figurehead who can be confided in,
- (v) A model who should be emulated

Therefore, in this type of relationships, the atmosphere is mainly of a dominant (the teacher) over the dominated (the pupils). Needless to say that more often than not this relationship leans more towards being authoritarian than democratic. There is however, a reason for it being so. Can you think of it? Hint: the teacher's task and demand. Together with these features, the relationship requires that strict discipline and good behaviour are observed and practiced; prescribed rules and regulations in the classroom routines and activities are observed and followed by all the learners. For example, the learners must follow certain rules in they wish to be absent from class or when they want to ask questions.

Sometimes, because of its nature, the formal relationship is misused. For example, a teacher may use his/her position, authority and power to seduce a student sexually, or to punish a pupil inhumanely.

The informal relationships: These relationships are largely found among the learners during their interaction in and outside the classroom. They can therefore, be described as the pupil-to-pupil relationships. They are mainly the relationships between equals. Each pupil is a member of the classroom group, the peer group, and the social interaction is that of individuals who see themselves as being equal, particularly with regard to their level of education, life experiences and age. In this relationship, there are no formally written rules and regulations governing its operation. However, there may exist loose agreements to which each classroom member may have to observe in order to avoid being blamed, rebuked, denied and even labeled by the group members. For example, if one borrows a pencil and fails to give it back to the owner he/she can be denied next time one has a need. In this relationship, there are several outcomes. For example, the learners recognize each other by their name or nicknames. They develop a sense of 'we', 'my class' and 'our class' as an expression of being part of a specific group. The learners develop ways of communicating, often known only to them, such as the eye contacts, body gestures, language and facial expressions. They teach each other the latest fads in music, clothing, hair styles, how to relate to the opposite sex and much more. They also teach each other how the class and the school systems work, how to deal with the rigours of learning activities. They learn the likes and dislikes, who to associate with as the 'star' of the group

;and who to avoid as an 'isolator' of the group. Also, they learn to label some individuals in the group according to the formed perceptions. Ultimately, the learners acquire a 'survival kit' by having subscribed to the norms and the rules of the game as sanctioned by the members of the classroom learners group. On the basis of such parameters it is thus possible to know who relates with who, the nature of such relationship and what sustains it within the classroom. Thus we can easily study the dynamics of the relationships in the school classroom.

(c) Roles and Activities in a School Classroom

Roles of a pupil in the classroom: We have learnt that the learner or pupil occupies the lowest social position in the school organization. But like the classroom teacher or any other position occupier, the learner has a number of roles which are in keeping with the learning activities in the classroom. The following are such roles:

- (i) Learner: Whether with the teacher in the classroom, or with the peer group members in an outside the classroom, the pupil is always supposed to be in a learning mode. He/she is always learning not only from the teacher and others but also from the environments, both social and physical. By virtue of being a learner, the pupil is expected to perform, achieve good grades in his/her class work.
- (ii) Self-evaluator: The pupil assesses himself/herself and then forms the image of whether he/she is smart or dumb, clever or stupid, fast or slow, neat or careless, quiet or noisy, and so on. The pupil also tries to compare himself/herself with other pupils in the classroom in terms of overall performance. Other ways of self-evaluation is whether one is a trouble-maker, later-come, roudy, messy or inattentive.
- (iii) Self-coordinator: a pupil fulfills this role by ensuring that school time is kept, and all his/her class articles like books, pens, rulers and other learning equipments are ready and well organized for the day's work in the school classroom. In the classroom during the school time, the pupil continues to be a self-coordinator by seeing that all his/her learning articles are well cared for to avoid losing any. At the end of the school time, the student again gathers all his/her classroom equipment before learning the classroom.
- (iv) Conformist: the pupil is conforming when he/she obeys the teacher, the rules and regulations and does the class work under the direction of the teacher. Such conformity is necessary so as to ensure the smooth running of the teaching activities in the classroom. Also conformity to the unwritten classroom group norms by the pupil, facilitates the cordial atmosphere that would be conducive to the harmony and stability in the classroom.
- (v) Clique leader: In some situations and at certain times, a particular pupil may become recognized by a small number of pupils as their leader. Such a student plays this role when he/she acquires followers such that he/she happens to be regarded by the followers as their leader in the classroom more so than the teacher. An outstanding athlete; a daring, fearless or adventurous person; a fear inducing deviant individual, and other characters, could become clique leaders. If the clique leadership role interferes or collides with the teaching activity, the classroom welfare and wellbeing may be disrupted. At the point, the classroom teacher together with the entire school organization, will confront the clique leader and the followers in order to restore calamity and authority in the classroom.

Social Activities in the School Classroom

In the definitions of the school classroom, we have emphasized the view that, it is in the classroom that the activities of the school organization are actively carried out. Mainly, specifically, in the classroom,

- (i) Each learner's mental abilities/understanding and the acquisition of knowledge and skills are measured.
- (ii) The teacher's work, actions and roles are judged effective or ineffective; whether they lead to the social goal of the school;
- (iii) The wider goal of the school is judged as a failure or success. There are, therefore, two major activities in the school classroom which we can observe and tell what outcomes will follow out of the classroom teaching and the learning activities.

The Teaching Activity

Teaching can be defined sociologically, as the active transfer of knowledge and skills from one person, such as a teacher, to another, or a group such a learner or learners. In the classroom, teaching is a social action in which the teacher interacts actively with the pupils. This active interaction is thus intended to result in the transfer of knowledge and skills as part of society's culture. The performance of the teacher in this action can be affected by the type or quality of the role socialization that he/she has undergone during the professional training prior to joining classroom teaching. It can also be affected by the behavioural, attitudinal tendencies and commitment, as well as the age of the teacher. Also, the teaching activity in the classroom can be influenced by the respective teacher experiences in social life and the teaching profession.

In order for the teacher to be effective in the classroom and the pupils to be receptive, he/she must prepare the pupils mentally, socially, behaviorally and emotionally by first greeting them, telling a short story or a current affairs item. This approach creates a relaxed classroom atmosphere and begins to capture the pupils attention. The classroom teacher must be ready to instill certain social values in the classroom, learners by teaching them to be punctual, respectful, attentive, obedient, orderly, trusted, cooperative and others. He must be ready to give advice and counsel when asked to if problems crop up among pupils in the classroom. The teacher must also take part in the administrative matters of the classroom such as organizing and managing the teaching-learning resources, equipment and other materials. The teacher must also discourage damage to classroom facilities and install an effective grading system.

In summary, the teaching activity in the school class classroom must include the following actions:

- (i) design schemes of work;
- (ii) prepare daily lessons;
- (iii) interact with pupils through material delivery;

- (iv) assess the pupils on their performance;
- (v) manage class equipment and materials for teaching-learning activities
- (vi) judge achievement of the classroom goal;
- (vii) create an atmosphere conducive to learning;
- (viii) punish and reward for undesirable and desirable behaviour; (ix) assess the teachers methods of teaching.

The learning activity can be defined, sociologically, as the active acquisition of knowledge and skills through being taught, instructed or reading. It also involves committing into mind and practicing the knowledge and skills so acquired. Those who are undergoing the learning activity should therefore

- (i) be taught by trained/qualified people
- (ii) read by themselves or with some assistance,
- (iii) commit to mind and internalize what has been learned,
- (iv) practice by putting to action what has been learned, (v) be assessed through tests and examinations.

Who decides who should participate in the classroom learning activity? Primarily, the following make such recommendations or decision:

- (i) Parents or guardian of children;
- (ii) Law, for example certain ages should be in class;
- (iii) Social organizations, for someone to acquire skills;
- (iv) Society

What is learned in the classroom? Sociologically, it is the CULTURE of a given society that is taught and learned in the classroom. The term culture is the total way of life of a society, has been dealt with before. The elements of the culture that are to be taught and learned are normally laid out in the school curriculum and syllabuses. These are therefore, social documents which express what and how the culture of the society should be taught to and learned in the classroom by the learners. Thus, we can say, that the curriculum is ordered, planned, organized, written and supplied by society. It has support and carries authority from society.

When does learning become an aspect of social interaction in the classroom? After the curriculum is officially accepted by an agent of society, such as the Ministry of Education, it must be interpreted into syllabuses (summary of courses of study). These are then operationalized into the actual, individual subjects. The classroom teacher must then prepare lesson plans and the notes. It is at this stage that the teacher and the learners will begin to interact in the classroom teaching and learning activities.

(D) The Social Goals of the School Classroom

The school classroom goal is part and parcel of the school's goal. It is however,

- (i) more readily pronounced such that the classroom teacher knows it;
- (ii) more action oriented in that it is fulfilled by doing activities in the classroom;
- (iii) subject to continuous evaluation or measurement through home assignments, class tests and examination of the learners.

Nevertheless, the classroom goal is geared to reinforcing, strengthening and sustaining the school organization goals' that is,

- (i) The education of the pupils,
- (ii) The socialization of the youngsters so as to acquire society's culture; (iii)
The propagation and preservation of society's culture

Chapter Summary

In this chapter, we have discussed the school classroom sociologically. We have defined and talked about the characteristics of the school classroom. These characteristics were, the human component; the social relationships; the roles particularly those of the learner; the classroom activities, mainly the teaching and learning activities. Earlier, the roles of the teacher have been given. Finally, the social goal of the classroom was discussed as one which is aimed at ensuring that the goals of the school organization are attained.

Questions and Activities



- 1) Discuss the human component characteristics in the classroom, showing what roles each part of this characteristic plays in the school and the classroom. What contributes to the social diversity of this component in the school classroom?
- 2) Study a classroom of your choice. Find out what kinds of relationship occur in it. Which ones can you classify as formal and also as informal? In what way(s) can you convince someone that the relationships you have observed help or do not help the goal(s) of the classroom and the school organization?
- 3) Examine the roles of the learner as discussed here. In what ways can you show or illustrate that these roles are real in the school classroom? Use some examples to support your answer.
- 4) Compare and contrast the teaching and learning activities in the classroom. Discuss how those activities are designed to bring about social interaction in the classroom.

LESSON 7

SOCIAL STRATIFICATION AND SCHOOL EDUCATION

Introduction

All human societies from the simplest to the most complex have some form of social inequality. There are families that are classified as rich while others are regarded as poor. This is further reflected in education, where some schools are termed as those attended by children of the rich while others are attended by children from poor families. This lesson is based on social stratification and school education. Areas analysed include social economic status and its effect on education, the dropout phenomenon in schools, public versus private schools, urban versus rural schools, facilities and performance and social mobility and performance. **Objectives**



By the end of this lesson, learners should be able to:

- ❖ Define social stratification
- ❖ Give examples of social stratification in schools in Kenya
- ❖ State how equality can be achieved in the education system in Kenya.

Meaning and Concept of Social Stratification

The term stratification is a word derived from “strata” or layers as used in geology to refer to the way layers of rocks are laid on top of each other. When applied to Sociology, strata are the different positions in which people are arranged in a hierarchy. Social stratification therefore refers to **“the presence of social groups that are ranked one above the other usually in terms of the amount of power, prestige, rewards and wealth that their members possess”** Those who belong to a particular group or stratum will have some common interests and a common identity. They will share a similar lifestyle, which to some degree will distinguish them from members of other social strata.

Mbiti (1974) defines stratification as **“the division of a population into two or more layers each of which is relatively homogeneous and between which there are differences in privileges, restrictions, rewards and obligations.”** He further points out that social stratification demonstrates ranking orders in society and often demonstrates social inequality. Ezewu (1983) states that society is divided into specific layers into which individuals are fitted and categorized. Each of these layers is called a stratum and the process of categorizing and the way members of each stratum relate to one another is called social stratification. According to Jarry and Jarry(1991) social stratification refers to the hierarchically organized structures of social inequality (ranks, status groups, etc) which exist in society.

The Indian caste system is an example of social stratification. The Hindu society in traditional India was divided into five main strata as follows:

- ❖ . The Brahmins- the highest caste of priests and religious people,
- ❖ Kshatriya- rulers and administrators,
- ❖ Vaisya - merchants and farmers,

- ❖ Sudras - manual workers and
- ❖ The “untouchables.”

The Brahmins or priests were members of the highest caste. They personified purity, sanctity and holiness. They were the source of learning, wisdom and truth. They were the only ones to perform important religious ceremonies. The Brahmins were custodians of the law and the legal system that they administered was based largely on their pronouncements. In a large rural economy, the Brahmins tended to be the largest landowners and they monopolized the control of land. At the other extreme were the untouchables. They were defined as unclean, base and impure, a status which affected all social relationships. They had to perform the unclean and degrading tasks such as the disposal of dead animals. They were segregated from members of other castes and lived on the outskirts of the villages and in their own communities. They were degraded to the extent that if the shadow of an untouchable fell across the food of a Brahmin, the food was considered unclean and polluted (Haralambos & Holborn 1990)

In the feudal system of medieval Europe, social stratification was based on land. The more land an individual controlled the greater his or her wealth, power and prestige. Social stratification has also been identified in East European communist societies. The society is divided into white-collar intelligentsia (professional, management and administrative position), skilled manual positions, lower or unqualified white-collar positions and unskilled manual positions. Top administrators, managers and professionals are accorded the highest prestige with the unskilled manual forming the base of the prestige hierarchy (Haralambos & Holborn 1990)

Members of a particular stratum have a common identity, similar interests and lifestyle. They enjoy or suffer unequal distribution of rewards in society as members of different social groups. There is a tendency for members of each stratum to develop their own “Subculture” that is, certain norms, attitude and values which are distinctive to them as a social group. Members of the lowest stratum tend to have a fatalistic attitude towards life. This attitude becomes part of their subculture and is transmitted from generation to generation. They tend to see circumstances as largely unchangeable and view life as composed of luck and fate rather than individual effort. All social systems share certain functional prerequisites, which must be met if the system is to survive and operate efficiently.

Davies and Moore (1945) state that stratification is universally necessary due to the requirement of any society to motivate individuals to fill important social positions. Unequal rewards, including income are seen as a means whereby scarce talents are allocated to important positions. They describe social inequality as ‘**an important unconsciously evolved device by which societies ensure that the most important positions are conscientiously filled by the most qualified persons**’ (David and Moore 1945).

However, this view has been challenged in that opportunities to develop skills are not equal in systems of stratification. Birth and inheritance of social positions are important and recruitment in the elite system is routinely influenced by other factors other than talent. A person’s position in a stratification system has an important effect on many areas of life. It may enhance or reduce life’s chances in obtaining those things defined as desirable and avoiding those defined as undesirable in their society. For example, it influences chances

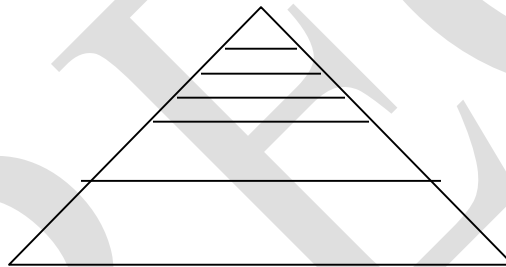
of staying healthy and higher education. No social stratum is self-sufficient and must rely on other groups.

Patterns of Social Stratification

There are various patterns of social stratification. These are identified through the different shapes or structural profiles, for example the steepness of hierarchy and the number of steps in the hierarchy of different systems. These patterns portray forms of inequality based on unequal rewards including income and status grouping or classes. Members of a strata share a common relation to the means of production and they remain identified through levels of education and culture that set them apart from other strata (Jarry and Jarry 1991). Below are some of the patterns in social stratification:

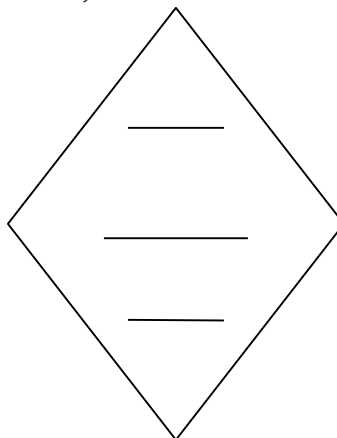
a) Steep Pyramid Structure

Some societies including many traditional agrarian civilizations exhibit a steep pyramid structure, with the elite being at the apex and the unemployed at the base. The upper class may include the bourgeoisie, while the middle class includes the superior and petty bourgeoisie, the working class may include the skilled and the unskilled and finally the unemployed.



b) Diamond Shaped Structure

Modern western societies can be represented as having a diamond shaped structure. The upper class is at the apex and consists of the elites such as businessmen (Bill Gates) and industrialists. The upper middle class consists of professionals and politicians. The lower middle class consists of the majority of the population. These include administrators, teachers, doctors, those in permanent employment and skilled manual positions. The lower class consists of unskilled manual positions, casual labourers and the unemployed.



c) Two class structure

This is the Marxian conception of capitalist society. It has the ruling class and the dominant class. In this class structure, society is seen as increasingly polarizing into two great hostile classes, the capitalist class (bourgeoisie) and the proletariat (Working class). The bourgeoisie exploit the proletariat by paying less than the value of their labour. Through their private ownership of the means of production, the bourgeoisie frustrate the collective and social interest of the proletariat (Jary and Jary 1991).

Capitalist class

Proletariat
(Working class)

c) Three or more class Structures

This is a more complex three or more class structure. It is a class structure in modern western societies. The upper class consists of the elites. The middle class consists of professionals and politicians. The working class consists administrators, those in permanent employment and skilled manual positions. The under class consists of unskilled manual positions and casual labourers. It also includes those in slum areas, those in illegal businesses and asylum seekers.

Upper class

Middle class

Working class

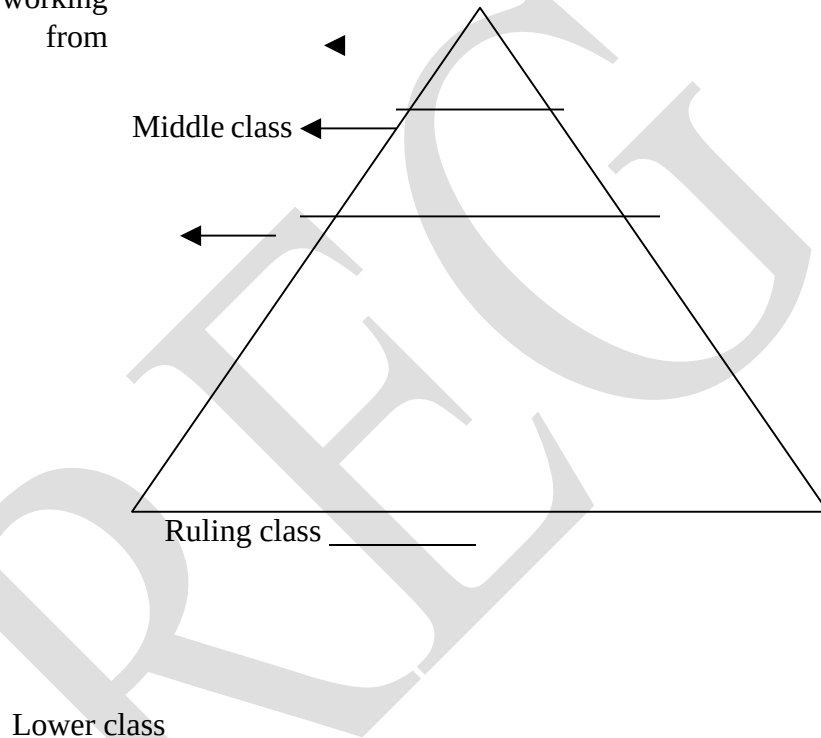
Under class

d) Three structures

This class structure is common in many third world countries, Kenya included. The ruling class comprises the economic elite. In Kenya, they comprise of the very wealthy who are influential in policy and decision-making. They are major owners of the means of production, company directors, top managers, high professionals and senior civil servants. Many are large shareholders in private industry. The power of the upper class is derive from ownership and control of the means of production (Sunday Nation, 2003).

The middle class consists of highly rewarded professionals such as Doctors, Lawyers, Architects, Senior Managers and Senior Administrators. It also includes judges, barristers, solicitors, engineers, lawyers, lecturers and accountants. They are influential in policy and decision-making. Some are owners of the means of production, directors, managers and shareholders in private industry.

In Kenya the lower class comprises the majority. These are manual, non-manual workers and the unemployed. The non-manual workers include nurses, clerks, social workers, and accountants. The manual workers include peasant farmers, masons, carpenters and those in the Jua Kali sector. They are the subordinate group with little influence in policy and decision-making. Many have little or no assets. Their main concern is survival. The power of the working class derives from communalism.



Conceptions of Social Stratification ❖ Status Theory

According to Status theory, all people in society have different **statuses**, which determine the **roles** that they have to play. They accordingly, receive different rewards and prestige from society. Some statuses are **ascribed**, that is one is born into a status such as nobility (aristocracy, such as Kings or queens). One can also be born a commoner. If you are born in a business family, working class or peasant, this is ascription because you did not do anything to have the status. Ascribed status may also be in terms of whether you are a first

or last-born, girl or boy, white or black depending on the significance of that particular fact in a given society.

Other statuses are **achieved** that is, you attain a status through some social process. You become a teacher, a lawyer, or a doctor through your education attainment. Status theory can help us understand social stratification based on gender (women holding inferior positions to men), age (where elders rule society), religion (some societies imposing religious rules of one social group on the rest), ethnicity, (one cultural group ruling others) and race.

Social Class Theory

This view of social stratification is that, society is structured according to “Classes”.

Marxism

Marxist scholars assert that class is a particular individual’s **location** at the level of production, that is, class is a relation of production in the economic sphere. Different modes of production produce different classes. Such classes as the bourgeoisie, petty bourgeoisie (middle class) proletariat (Working class), peasantry and lumpen-proletariat (unemployed, etc) are related in some way to the economic structure of society. Your class determines your life chances.

Based on this theory, the role of education then in a capitalist society is to produce a working force (subordinate group) and a ruling class (dominant group). If the members of the working force are educated to accept their position as normal, inevitable and natural then they will hardly question anything. What education does is not only to provide skills that are required by the working force but also to propagate an ideology that legitimises the existence of people of different status. Education does this by providing skills and inculcating the required attitudes.

Marxist scholars believe that class structures change with changes in the social formation and can actually disappear. Thus social stratification is not a necessary condition for societal existence (Levitas, 1978; Sarup, 1982).

Functionalism

Functionalist scholars such as Max Weber (1947), point out that there are social classes in society but conceive the notion of “Class” differently from Marxists. Their view is that we speak of class when:

- ❖ A number of people have in common a specific **causal component** of their life chances;
- ❖ This component is represented exclusively by economic interests in the possession of goods and opportunities for income, for example equal education may lead to equal employment opportunities and earning power, and
- ❖ This component (for example education) is represented under the conditions of the commodity or labour markets (in capitalist society).

Weber’s view of class covers such indices as wealth, occupation, residence, education and income, departing from Marx’s view of the significance of **production relations**, although recognizing economic factors.

Social Class and Social Status

Social status is used to refer to a typically effective claim to **positive or negative privilege with respect to social prestige**. Social class is subjective and is based on:

- ❖ The mode of living, that is, life style
- ❖ A formal process of education related to the acquisition of the corresponding life-style; and
- ❖ The prestige of birth or of one's occupation

Property and managerial positions are not in themselves sufficient to lend the holder a certain social status. Propertied and property-less may share the same social status. The class of an officer (military), a civil servant and a college student may be widely different in economic terms but their social status remains the same since they adhere to the same lifestyle as a result of their common education.

Status has much to do with prestige although it may go together with class. For example, some aristocratic families, which are considerably wealthy, can be compared to some rich business people. From a property point of view, they belong to the same class, but they do not have the same social status because the aristocrat will have a higher prestige and is therefore more revered.

Social stratification In Kenya

The highest status in many communities in Kenya used to be the traditional ruler. He performed multiple roles ranging from administration of the affairs of the community to constituting the community courts. A class of elders who were internally ranked from the most senior to the junior followed him. Lastly, there were the commoners. In the Masai community for example, authority and prestige was determined by age. Each community was organized according to age groups, each of which had specifically assigned responsibilities in the community. Traditional rulers children received education which was different from that received by the children of commoners.

At the advent of school education, indigenous leaders gave way to a new class of people enjoying high prestige and authority. Education became firmly established as a potent vehicle for moving into the ranks of colonial administration as well as the clergy and trades. The new breed of the educated were not necessarily the sons of the traditional rulers, as rulers prevented their sons going to school since they wanted them to be prepared for the throne. It was this people who were not rulers that became the leaders after the attainment of political independence thus destroying the traditional indigenous class system (Bogonko 1992).

Social stratification was also evident during the colonial era and factors affecting current academic achievement in schools in Kenya are traceable as far back as this era. During colonialism, schools were in three major categories, European, Asian and African schools. Little financial assistance was given to schools for Africans. From 1947 to 1957, Africans or 97 % of the population received 38% (806,000 pounds) of the vote of education while the Europeans and Asians accounting for only 3% of the population received the balance (Bogonko, 1992). African schools were restricted due to limited finances at their disposal, and the social and occupational roles to which they were destined.

European Schools had better facilities. Asians managed because of their strong economic and religious bases to create a viable Asian school system supported mainly through selfhelp. Therefore, while the European and Asian schools had better facilities, better-qualified teachers and students from rich families, the African schools had poor infrastructure with the majority of teachers being untrained.

After independence the education system in Kenya was segmented along socio-economic lines with the rich taking their children to the former European and Asian schools while the poor took their children to the former African Schools. While the former European and Asian schools were well endowed with facilities, the African schools were ill equipped. This affected the overall performance (Sifuna 1986).

Currently, Kenyan schools tend to be ranked by parents and students according to their perceived ability to guarantee education and social mobility. The classification corresponds with the structural features so that the well-endowed schools rank highest in public estimation and entering them is very competitive. Class structure corresponds to the distribution of better-qualified teachers, availability of facilities and better performance in Kenya Certificate of primary Education.

Learners in Kenya can be divided into three major socio-economic categories: high, middle and low socio-economic statuses.

High Class

Families of learners from the high socio-economic category comprises of the very wealthy in Kenya, who are the dominant group, influential in policy and decision- making. They enjoy effective power. They are major owners of the means of production, company directors, top managers, high professionals and senior civil servants. Many are large shareholders in private industry. The powers of these families derive from ownership and control of the means of production (Sunday Nation, 2003).

Middle Class

Families of learners from the middle socio-economic category comprises of the wealthy in Kenya, who are economically stable but not as empowered as the ruling class. The upper middle class consists of highly rewarded professionals, senior managers and senior administrators. They include judges, barristers, solicitors, architects, doctors, dentists, and engineers. The lower middle class includes lawyers, lecturers and accountants. They are influential in policy and decision-making. They enjoy power. Some are major owners of the means of production, directors, managers and shareholders in private industry.

Working class

In Kenya the working class comprises manual and non-manual workers. The non-manual workers include nurses, clerks, social workers, and accountants. The manual workers include peasant farmers, masons, carpenters and those in the Jua Kali sector. They are the subordinate group with little influence in policy and decision-making. Many have little or no assets. Their main concern is survival. The power of the working class derives from communalism.

The Effect of Social Stratification on School Education

Social Economic Status (S.E.S.) And Its Effect On Academic Achievement

Socio- economic status can be defined as the social and economic position of an individual or a family in any given society determined by such factors as the level of education,

occupation and income. The socio-economic status (S.E.S.) of a family has been acknowledged to affect positively or negatively the schooling of that family. Experience and research findings show that the higher the socio-economic status of a family, the more likely it motivates its children to learn in school and consequently to succeed in learning (Ezewu, 1983). Below are some examples of how socio economic status affects schooling in Africa as a whole and Kenya in particular:

a) Early attendance at school

People of high socio- economic status send their children to school earlier than those of low-socio-economic status. This is because they have the means and opportunities of sending them to nursery schools as early as two years. They also know the importance of taking their children earlier as they join the labour market earlier and hence occupy jobs before others. Wealthy and better-educated parents utilize private nursery schools that deploy resources in a manner that creates pre-school conditions, which are conducive to a successful school performance. They also provide initial advantages, which are difficult to match among the poor, uneducated and rural Kenyans.

Families with a high socio economic status prepare their children for school more adequately than those with low socio economic status, as a result, children coming from wealthy background are often more ready to learn as they enter the primary school level and consequently stand better chances of succeeding in their studies as compared to families with low socio -economic status.

b) Provision of books and other materials

People of high socio economic status usually earn a higher income and place more value on school education than those of low socio-economic income status. They are likely to possess financial means and willingness to provide their children with books and necessary school materials and spend a proportion of their income on books. They purchase books, educational toys and read to their children at home, while parents from low socio economic status may lack the money to purchase books and the quest for survival makes it impossible for them to create time for their children. Children in low social status schools share books and materials and it becomes difficult for teachers to give homework while those from high socio economic status have individual textbooks and reference books. They can always read ahead of the teacher.

c) Attendance at the best school available

Some schools are more prestigious than others and attract the best-qualified teachers and receive the attention of the government. Children from high socio-economic status families attend prestigious schools. These families in order to maintain their status do everything possible to ensure that their children attend the best nursery and primary schools to guarantee admission to highly placed secondary schools, the entrance to which is very competitive. The schools have all the facilities.

Highly educated families ensure that their offspring's are schooled in superior institutions increasing influence of home background upon access to good schools and subsequent scholarships. The parents can afford to take their children for private tuition during weekends and in the evenings after school. Children from poor backgrounds may lack extra coaching and textbooks. Fees and other amenities in these schools push children from poor families out of such schools. Parents deliberately demand for extra facilities thus pushing others out.

d) Encouragement in school education

A family may be supportive, neutral or antagonistic to school education. The value to which a family attaches school education determines the motivation with which its children pursue such education. Children from low socio economic status are involved in other activities in the home after school or during holidays, such as businesses or manual labour for basic survival. These results in constant absenteeism and late coming. This is bound to have a diverse effect on academic achievement. In high socio economic status families, there are house helps to carry out house chores and therefore, the learner's study time is not interfered with.

Parental reaction to poor performance in school has an impact on performance. High socio economic status families tend to show more concern over their children's poor performance at school. Most teach their children, encourage them and help them improve in poorly performed subjects or take them for tuition classes. On the other hand, even if low socio economic status families worry over their children's poor performance, they are not always able to coach them. Many are semi illiterate and their low income cannot enable them to take their children for tuition. To some of these parent's, basic survival is given more prominence than education.

In high socio economic status families' parents are very influential and through this influence, coupled by their high expectation in education, they are able to provide both support and bring pressure to bear on teachers so that teachers do their best to ensure that learners perform well. There is close supervision of learners and remedial classes. Parents are able to give tokens of appreciation for good performance and this gives motivation factor to teachers to perform even better. In low cost primary schools, parents may not visit the schools unless compelled to do so. Many are unable to contribute money to be used as motivation for learners and teachers.

Indirectly, poor parents may through talking discourage their children from doing well in school. They may talk of difficulties in getting school fees and other facilities.

e) Provision of a good model English

English is the language of instruction in most primary schools. Children from families with a high socio economic status usually speak good English before going to school. This is so because parents with their own good educational background can provide sound models of English at home for the children to learn from. These children are provided with children's books which stimulate them, greatly fascinating the learning of English and other subjects. Those from low socio economic backgrounds may use English only while at school and are at times extremely handicapped. They are usually spoken to at home in mother tongue. This makes them disadvantaged as they start school at a lower status than those from high socio economic status.

f) Development of interest in school Activities

An all round education should develop the mental and physical potential of the learner as well as character. Parents from low socio economic status homes show less interest in school activities than parents from high socio economic status homes (Ezewu; 1983). Parents from high socio economic status families are interested in both academic subjects and varied school activities. The home and surroundings of pupils from low socio economic status scarcely have the facilities or even space for sporting activities. Parents

from high social economic status show interest in what goes on in school. They support these activities and by extension motivate their children.

g) Academic and job aspirations

The academic aspirations of school children are positively related to the socio economic status of their parents. Children tend to imitate their parents and so aspire to be as highly educated as their parents. More pupils from the high socio economic status groups than the lower socio economic status groups aspire to those highly rated professions for example, medicine, judges and architects. Children from low socio economic status lack role models. They struggle on their own and in most cases cannot advance very far.

h) Home Environment

The home environment plays an increasing influence upon academic performance of pupils in primary schools. While most families in high socio economic status live in peaceful, quiet environments conducive for reading, for learners in most of the low socio economic families, the immediate environment is noisy and not conducive to reading. Congested and poorly lit rooms make reading and revision almost impossible. Due to the noisy environment, most children do their assignments after others have gone to sleep.

Besides malnutrition and poor living conditions, most families in low social economic status encounter disturbances, harassment and violence. This creates worry, tension, anxiety and stress especially in young children. The end results are neurotic attacks, phobia, nightmares and nervous breakdowns. These disturbances have a lot of negative effect on education as the pupils' concentration span in school is adversely affected (Biogiovanni 1979).

However, there are exceptions. There are those who, although they come from high socio economic status families do not perform well in school. Some from low socio economic status families perform well and surpass children from high socio economic status families at school. However, on average, high socio economic status homes encourage schooling more than low socio economic status homes and so such children are more likely to achieve better results at school.

The dropout phenomenon in schools

At primary school level promotion from standard one through to class eight is supposed to be automatic more so with the introduction of free primary education. On the contrary, a great deal of wastage occurs in terms of dropouts and repetition (Eshiwani 1993). In Kenya the overall wastage rate ranges from 30% to 47% (Eshiwani 1979). Dropout implies wastage in the education system. Patterns of dropouts in primary schools tend to be significantly higher among the low social economic status families than the high socio economic ones. Below are some of the factors that contribute to school dropouts: ***a) Poverty***

One of the major causes of learners dropping out of schools is poverty. According to U.N.I.C.E.F. report (1990) approximately 31.7 %of all children under the age of fifteen years live in urban areas and 50% of these are considered to be living in conditions of extreme poverty. Children are forced to drop out of school to help their poverty-plagued families while some become destitute street children. Lack of parental economic stability has led some children to absent themselves from school, to search for food and offer their labour for sale such as in coffee and tea picking, working in quarries, soap stone industries, sand harvesting, hawking and herding. Girls in these families have at times been pulled out of school and married off or employed as domestic workers so that parents get money to

feed other members of the family or educate the boys. This is rampant in low socio economic status families. **b) Cultural influences**

Cultural practices such as circumcision rites, early marriages and moranism have been found to be contributory factors to school dropout in Kenya. However, there are more participants from low socio-economic status families than the high socio-economic status families. A study by Mukhongo (2003) among the Babukusu community in Kanduyi division of Bungoma Kenya, found out that primary school learners tended to drop out of school at a higher rate during the circumcision period than at any other seasons. This practice was common among low socio-economic families, since the majority of parents from high socio economic status families took their children to hospitals for circumcision and hardly participated in these rituals. These children from rich families did not spend school time visiting relatives soliciting for funding nor spend time rehearsing in song and dance before circumcision. There were no prolonged ceremonies after healing. Therefore, while children participating in circumcision from poor families had their school time interfered with; school attendance for children from rich families was not interfered with. Unable to cope with schoolwork after prolonged absenteeism, some of the children from poor families dropped out of the educational system.

Among the Masai and Samburu communities' seclusion during moranism takes a long time and usually results in school dropout. Female circumcision has been found to be a contributory factor to school dropout among females as many girls get married after the ceremony.

In North Eastern Kenya, nomadic culture has made it impossible for pupils to identify with one particular school. There is frequent movement from one area to the next in search of pasture. This has contributed to school dropouts, as pupils are unable to have continuity in their education. Culture is deep rooted among those in the low socio-economic status, particularly among rural communities, where poverty is high. **c) Socialization**

Socialization in some communities has put emphasis on various aspects other than schoolwork. For example, boys after circumcision among the Kikuyu, feel that they are 'men' and have no respect for ladies/ teachers. In some communities marriage and procreation with the aspect of extending the communities lineage is emphasized and regarded of more value than education. This contributes to many youths dropping out of school.

d) Excessive Demands from Schools

Although there is free primary education in Kenya, there are various requirements that parents have to meet. This includes school uniforms, books, desk fee and fee for clubs and school trips. Poor families are not able to cope, the worst being in secondary schools where there is no free education. This has contributed to learners dropping out of the education system.

e) Insecurity

Insecurity has greatly contributed to school dropout, particularly in crime prone areas. Families from low socio economic status mainly inhabit insecure areas. This is because the areas are cheaper in rent and lifestyle (for example the slum environment), or the families

have no alternative but to stay there as that is where they were born and they lack the capital to venture into new sites. The insecurity in these areas affects their children's education, as some pupils are scared to go to school and eventually opt to drop out of school. Families with higher socio-economic status are able to afford affluent and secure areas and therefore their children feel secure to and from school.

In North Eastern province, the shifta menace has contributed to family displacement. This has resulted in pupil's withdrawal from primary schools. In Elgeyo Marakwet and Pokot districts, cattle's rustling has resulted in pupils and teachers avoiding schools and in the long run some pupils drop out of school. Land clashes in Rift valley resulted in many pupils being displaced and dropping out of the school system. Many of the learners affected are from low socio-economic status families as the high socioeconomic families take their children to secure boarding schools. This hostile environment has a lot of effect on learning since some children in such an environment develop intense fear and insecurity and thus develop phobia of leaving their immediate surroundings. School attendance and performance is affected and many end up dropping out of the system.

f) Nomadic Way of Life

The nomadic way of life has greatly contributed to school dropout in North Eastern province. The value for cattle has resulted in families shifting from place to place in search of pasture and water. Some of these areas have neither schools nor teachers. This has resulted in children dropping out of the school system.

g) Lack of Parental reinforcement Parent's views on education and the extent they are able to sacrifice in order to ensure their children get quality education plays a major role in motivating the children to stay in school. The higher the socio-economic status of a family, the more likely it motivates its children to learn and the less it encounters school dropout. In a comparative study by Odawa (1987) between two city council primary schools, one attended mainly by children from high socio-economic status families (Muthaiga Primary) and the other attended mainly by children from low socio-economic status families (Pumwani Primary) it was found that child reinforcement was high in Muthaiga (60%) while very low in Pumwani (10%). In addition to this, parental and community interest in children's education was high in Muthaiga primary while very low in Pumwani. Educational wastage was very low in Muthaiga Primary as compared to Pumwani primary (Odawa, 1987).

Public versus Private Schools

Public and private schools in Kenya can be classified into high, medium and low category schools, according to the socio-economic status of the learner's families. In Nairobi some of the public primary schools under the Nairobi city council that are attended by pupils from high socio economic backgrounds include, Kilimani, Muthaiga and Kileleshwa Primary. Those attended by learners from middle socio-economic status families include Kenyatta University Primary School, Olympic primary school and Langata. The low socio-economic learners attend schools such as Korogocho, Githurai and Dr Aggrey primary schools.

Private primary schools in Kenya can be classified into three major categories according to fee payments. These are high, medium and low cost private primary schools.

High cost private primary schools charge very high fees which make them exclusive for the children of the rich. In Nairobi some of the high cost private primary schools include: Makini, Brookhouse, Consolata Primary, Riara and St Austins. The middle category includes Nairobi Primary, St Annes, St Nicholas and Aga Khan academy. The low cost private primary schools are normally located in slum areas such as Githurai, Mathare and Kawangware. However, there are various contrasts between public and private primary schools in Kenya, such as the following:

a) Facilities

There is a contrast in facilities between the public and private schools attended by children from high socio-economic families and those attended by children from low socio economic families. While both public and private schools attended by children from high socio-economic status families are well constructed, and have amenities such as swimming pools, playing fields, halls and libraries that are well stocked, therefore offering learners a conducive atmosphere for learning, the public and private schools catering for learners from low socio economic families are usually situated in hostile environments with dilapidated buildings and limited amenities.

Availability of Textbooks is higher in Private and Public schools catering for learners from higher socio-economic status than those from lower socio-economic status. Equipments such as computers, photocopiers, projectors among others, which enhance academic activities, are more available in schools for learners from higher socio economic status.

However, in comparison, private schools catering for pupils from higher socio economic status families are better equipped than public schools catering for children from higher socio -economic families. On the other hand, public schools catering for children from low socio-economic families are better equipped compared to private schools catering for children from low socio-economic families. **b) Teacher motivation**

There is evidence that teacher motivation has a considerable effect on academic achievement. Both public and private schools catering for learners from higher socio -economic status families have higher teacher motivation and better performance than private and public schools catering for learners' from low socio-economic status families. This is mainly because, schools catering for learners from higher socio-economic status make education interesting and challenging through fieldtrips, visitation to other schools, sports, participation in school competitions such as drama, music festivals and teachers get tokens of appreciation for good results. In addition to these, the teacher /pupil ratio is low. Teachers are able to give learners individualized attention. Children are able to finish their homework, as the home environment is conducive to learning. They are able to read ahead of their teachers and even challenge the teachers. This makes teaching challenging and interesting. Furthermore, the rich parents reinforce teachers by giving them tokens of appreciation for any good performance.

Teaching learners from low socio-economic status families can be demoralising for the teacher mainly because, students may lack essential facilities such as books, desks, chairs and even blackboards. In schools catering for learners from lower socio- economic status, the ratio of teacher to student is high and this results in the inability of teachers to give learners personalized attention. Children are not motivated to work hard in their studies because of lack of role models at home.

Both public and private schools catering for learners from higher socio-economic status tend to attract teachers of high calibres such as diploma and graduate teachers, because they are established, well known and their pay is good. There is security and professional advancement, unlike in schools catering for learners from lower socio-economic status where transfers and termination of service is more frequent. However, teacher motivation is usually higher in private schools catering for learners from higher socio-economic status than public schools catering for learners from higher socio-economic families.

c) School Culture

Most public and private schools catering for learners from higher socio-economic status have a long tradition of academic excellence as compared to schools catering for learners from lower socio-economic status. They have a culture of good performance and excelling, and many believe in being leaders or holding top positions in society after school. The student aspiration for further education is therefore high and the parents and teacher's encouragement reinforce this. Learners also have a desire to keep the good name of the school. On the other hand, many schools catering for learners from lower socio-economic status have not set their own culture of excellence (Odawa; 1987).

The type of school a pupil is educated in determines the pupil's educational aspiration through its effects on his or her self-perception. There is a strong association between success in school certificate and aspirations for further education.

Urban versus rural schools

Urban and rural schools in Kenya can be classified into high, medium and low category schools according to the socio-economic status of the learners' families. However, in general there are various factors that differ between urban and rural schools. **a) Facilities**

Most schools in urban areas are generally better equipped than those in rural areas. This is mainly because the socio economic status of parents in most urban schools is higher than those in the rural areas. Accessibility of textbooks and school stationery is easier for most learners in urban than rural schools. Some learning equipment such as computers, projectors and photocopiers cannot be used in some schools within rural areas due to lack of electricity yet in urban areas, some learners can pursue subjects of their choice, such as computer lessons.

b) Teacher Motivation

In urban schools teachers have more opportunities for professional advancement as compared to rural areas. They can go for evening classes or Saturday lessons. More workshops and seminars to help teachers improve in teaching methodology are held in urban areas than in the rural environment. These exposures enable teachers in urban areas to have an advantage over their rural counterparts as far as teaching is concerned.

Teachers educational background form a significant variable in determining the performance of pupils in Kenya Certificate of Primary Education or Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education. In most schools within urban centres, teacher morale is high, not only due to the pay but other privileges associated with the schools. The teachers can go an extra mile to ensure their learners perform well. In most rural schools, teacher morale is low. Most teachers are cut off from any professional advancement and usually carry out classroom teaching that is required and nothing more.

c) Language of communication

Pupils in urban schools come from different language backgrounds, unlike rural schools where most of the learners come from the immediate surrounding. A majority of pupils from rural schools are of one tribe, or can all communicate in the language used in the immediate surrounding. Mother tongue is mainly used as the medium of communication among these learners. This affects grammar in English and Kiswahili.

However, in urban areas, English and Kiswahili are the medium of communication, thus the frequency of using these languages in communication helps in improving the learner's grammar in these subjects.

d) Lack of Parental reinforcement

The kind of environment the school is set in and the beliefs of the community surrounding the school towards education influences the child's school attendance and academic performance. When a child's family and friends have little interest in education and state how they are better off economically than the educated people around them, then the likelihood of a child in such families being allowed to stay away from school or drop out of school is increased (Coombes 1974). In rural areas, most parents are semi illiterate and since some feel that they are surviving adequately without education, they hardly motivate their children as far as education is concerned. Most parents of pupils in urban primary schools are literate and encourage their children to excel in academic work.

d) Lack of Role models

Role models play a great role in educational motivation. While in urban areas achievement in education is highly applauded, in rural areas survival techniques and capital accumulation is praised. There are limited academic models in rural areas as most achievers within rural communities migrate to urban centres in search of wage employment. The learners in rural areas therefore lack educated people to identify with, to consult, to be talked to or be challenged by.

Facilities versus performance

School facilities such as desks, instructional materials especially books and school library, enhance school performance (Fuller, 1985). While in schools catering for learners from higher socio-economic status, specific criterion is expected in resource availability and allocation mainly due to enlightened parents and the fees or levies paid, in schools catering for learners from lower socio-economic status, accountability of resources is not strict and this can result in learning taking place without the required resources. Therefore, pupils in schools with all the relevant facilities are likely to perform better than those who go to poorly equipped schools.

In Kenya, school facilities range from well-equipped classrooms, libraries, halls and swimming pools for well-equipped schools, to mud walled classrooms in poorly equipped schools, particularly in rural and slum areas. In some primary pupils, particularly in rural areas, pupils learn under trees and write on sand due to lack of exercise books. In schools with better facilities, performance is better than those lacking facilities.

In a comparative study on how availability of resources within the learners home environment, enhance learning, Odawa (1987), in a study, between learners from Muthaiga Primary School (a public school catering for learners mainly from higher socio- economic

status) and Pumwani primary school (catering for learners from lower socio- economic status) found out the following:

School	Home Library	Television	Radio	None
Muthaiga	62%	87%	100%	-
Pumwani	-	30%	75%	2.5

Source: Odawa 1987.

From the findings of the study, it was noted that many children in Muthaiga primary school were exposed at home to other facilities that enhanced their education, as compared to those in Pumwani primary school and therefore, they were highly motivated and performed better. There is a relationship between school facilities and the economic status of parents.

5.8. Social Mobility and Education

Social mobility is defined as a process by which people move from one social stratum to the next. Social mobility can be upwards e.g. moving from working class to middle class or downward such as moving from middle class to working class. Stratification systems, which provide little opportunity for social mobility, may be described as “Closed”, while those with a relatively high rate of social mobility are “open.”

Importance of Social Mobility

The rate of social mobility has an important effect on class formation. If the rate of social mobility is low, class solidarity and cohesion will be high. Most individuals will remain in the same class of origin and this will provide for the reproduction of common life experiences over generations. As a result distinctive class structures and strong class identifications will tend to develop.

Social mobility can provide an indication of life chances of members of society. It can show the degree to which a person’s class of origin influences his or her chances of obtaining a high status occupation.

It is important to know how people respond to the experiences of social mobility for example, if the downwardly mobile resent their misfortune and form a pool of dissatisfaction, which might threaten the stability of society.

Types Of Mobility a) Contest/Achieved status

These positions are open for competition. Able people are able to achieve. Achieved statuses are not assigned to persons from birth. They are left open to be filled through competition and individual effort. Among the commonly recognized achieved statuses are: **education, occupation, income and marital status**. Statuses that may be achieved in modern society include, college graduate, class positions, union organizer, police commissioner, major in the army, millionaire, pauper, and married man. They are occupied due to personal effort in society. **b) Ascribed status:**

These are permanent attributes for example **sex, age, place of birth, colour of skin, kinship by birth, height, born in a rich or poor family and relationships**. They are permanent attributes.

e) Sponsored Mobility

It is similar to ascribed in the sense that members are assisted to occupy positions.

Note

A good number of African societies combine both the ascribed and the achieved statuses, except that achieved statuses are increasingly more dominant over ascribed statuses. In effect individuals in society are never equals. Through education people are able to move to classes, income, status and prestige.

Influence Of Social Mobility On Education

Social mobility influences education in that, a person's position in a stratification system has an important effect on many areas of life. A breadwinner's position may enhance or reduce chances of the child being in schools with better facilities, qualified teachers and living in an environment conducive to learning.

A parents movement from a lower to middle class status usually results in better educational chances and improvement in their children's school attainment as it increases chances of scholarship, education out of the country, while movement from middle class to lower class usually results in poor performance.

Educational achievement might well become the most important way to reach a high status occupation whether this involves social mobility upwards or the prevention of social mobility downwards. Those with the highest educational qualifications are pursuing the most prestigious and best-paid occupations. People with such backgrounds send their children to the best schools and they end up at universities. They graduate from universities to occupy high positions in society. This means that the high socio economic status occupiers are monopolizing the highest educational levels, as well as the most prestigious occupations. Education therefore cannot be said to be a means of open social mobility especially vertical mobility (Ezewu 1983).

In Kenya children educated beyond secondary schools and pursuing high ranking professionals such as medicine, law and architecture are much more likely to be socially mobile than those who have received only primary education. In poor families, a child is more likely to be socially mobile if he/she has a superior education. A superior education also lessens the possibility of downward mobility for those in the higher social status groups.

Education and Social Stratification

Education is a major contributor to social stratification. Through education people are able to move to various classes in society, for example from low to middle class status. Education also creates increase in income, status and prestige. However, despite this, education has been regarded as reinforcing the status quo. This has been through increasing the gap between the 'have' and 'have nots' in society. Schooling in general is highly selective, preventing some pupils from advancing while allowing others to do so. This it does through the following:

a) Unequal Access to Schooling

Although education increases productivity in all sectors of the economy, access to educational opportunities is still not evenly distributed across the sexes and across regional and social groups and sharp differences are noticeable. There are fewer girls than boys in

schools and even fewer proceed to higher levels of education such as the universities. The few girls who proceed tend to cluster in art-based subjects, leaving science subjects to be pursued by males. While schools are within easy reach in urban areas, since they are very many and transport is easily available for far away schools, children from rural areas have at times had to trek for long distances to schools.

Regional disparities are also evident in education. Those regions that obtained an early lead in education such as central province have tended to maintain leading positions in education besides having more prestigious schools and better facilities as compared to arid and semi arid areas where education was introduced later. Out of the best 54 best candidates nationally in the Kenya Certificate of Primary Education, Central province produced 35, representing 64%. Nairobi had 8, Rift valley had 6, Eastern had 3, Nyanza had 1 and Western 1. Coast and North Eastern province had no student in the best 54 whose minimal score was 468 (Sunday Nation, 2003).

While Central Provinces top candidate had 482 marks, Coasts best had 463 marks while North Easterns best had 435 marks. The best in North Eastern could not even be ranked number 100 in Central province. The 100th candidate in Central province had 458 marks and 450 in the Rift valley (Sunday Nation, 2003).

b) Differences in performance and Educational Attainment

There are marked differences in performance among learners from high and low socio economic families, private and public schools, high cost and low cost schools and urban and rural schools.

In the Kenya Certificate of Primary Education, 2003, the top two pupils countrywide were from the same school, Busara Academy in Nyandarua District with a score of 482 and 481 marks out of 500. Kenya's brightest pair missed only 18 and 19 marks to score the total. This is a high cost private school with a thorough recruitment procedure for any pupil who wants to join the school. The third was from Moi Educational Centre with 479 marks. This is also a high cost private school (Sunday Nation, 2003).

An analysis of the examination results indicates that regional and gender disparities continue to affect the educational system. Out of the top 824 candidates, only 232 were girls. Nyanza province, once a top performer, had only 16 girls among the top 824, while North eastern Province had 17. In Nairobi, the girls performance matched the boys, each having 54 among the top. (Sunday Nation, 2003). Although there was near gender parity in enrolment in standard Eight, 284,054 girls and 303,907 boys, fewer girls as compared to boys did well in the examinations.

In subject areas, boys again outshone girls in all subjects except English and Kiswahili composition. This has a bearing on trends in higher education since only these who excel in mathematics and the sciences have better chances of securing admission to lucrative courses after school and hence, promising professional careers.

Some of Nairobi's public schools that produced best candidates are in the upmarket areas. These are Nairobi primary school, which produced the second top scorer in the province and Hospital Hill, which produced the third top scorer. However, top performing public schools in low cost areas such as Nairobi Olympic Primary School did not feature among the top. The increase in pupil population mainly due to the introduction of free primary Education adversely affected performances in these schools because facilities were overstretched and teachers were few and overworked. Nairobi Olympic Primary had to contend with 3,000 plus pupils spread across the classes, all depending on a skeleton staff and inadequate facilities (Sunday Nation, 2003). **c) Creation of Hierarchies in schools**

Schools in Kenya tend to be ranked by parents and students according to their perceived ability to guarantee educational and social mobility. The well endowed national and high cost schools rank highest in public estimation as they have resources, well qualified teachers and likely to perform better in examinations. Based on school types, students tend to be socially defined and to define themselves in a way that can affect aspirations and expectations.

Categorizing schools as nationals, provincials and district tend to give some schools advantages over the others with national schools having the advantage of being the first to recruit and recruiting best students all over the country. They also attract teachers of high calibre since they are well established and well known. Some high cost primary schools, in order to send many pupils to national schools and therefore market themselves have been known to poach best performing pupils from public schools or from school in rural areas.

District and rural schools are the last to recruit usually drawing most of their intake from those learners not able to fit in National or provincial schools. A majority of their students are of one tribe. The high levels of aspiration of pupils in national schools tend to be due to the reputation that the schools enjoy while most learners in district and rural schools are demoralized. Some of the learners in these district or low cost schools never bond with the schools and spend most of the time looking forward to the time they will be transferred to other schools. This has a major impact on the academic work and affects learner's aspirations therefore dividing them further.

Summary

In this lesson, the meaning and concept of Social Stratification have



been identified. Social stratification has therefore been identified as the presence of social groups that are ranked one above the other usually in terms of the amount of power, prestige, rewards and wealth that their members possess .

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Those who belong to a particular group or stratum will have some common interests and a common identity. They will share a similar lifestyle, which to some degree will distinguish them from members of other social strata. Various theories related to social stratification have been discussed, such as Status Theory, the Social Class Theory and the Marxist theory. Social stratification has been analysed In Kenya, from the traditional to present day society.

Currently the Kenyan society can be divided into high, middle and low socio economic status. The differences in the Socio Economic Status of families has been reflected in education through various factors such as early or late school attendance, Provision of school facilities, the choice of school children attend, motivation or lack of learning motivation and performance. The immediate home environment has also been regarded as playing a major role in education with peaceful, quiet environments encouraging studies thus better performance while noisy congested and insecure environments discourage studies thus affecting academic performance negatively.

Causes of school dropout in Kenya have been analysed and include among others poverty, cultural influences, socialization, excessive demands from Schools, insecurity, the nomadic way of life and lack of parental reinforcement.

In this lesson, public and private schools in Kenya were analysed. It was found that in schools attended by children from high socio-economic families, whether public or private, facilities were adequate. However schools attended by children from low socio economic families lacked facilities. Teacher motivation was higher in both public and private schools catering for learners from higher socio -economic status families but very low in schools catering for learners' from low socio-economic status families. An

analysis between urban and rural schools indicated a marked difference in facilities, with most schools in urban areas generally better equipped than those in rural areas and teacher morale higher as compared to those in rural areas.

In this lesson education has been seen as a major contributor to social stratification through unequal access to schooling, differences in performance/

educational attainment and creation of hierarchies in schools.

77 Conclusion

Social stratification enhances inequality within the society. The effect is greatly felt within the education system, where social stratification creates unequal access to schooling. In the near future those benefiting most from education will be those with advantaged parents who are able to provide the kind of home background needed for studies and then the kind of school, which enables the child to take most advantage of the educational system. This stratification is encouraged by charging high fees and levies in a number of good quality schools to keep off the poor.

The fact that children from higher socio-economic status families are able to attend better equipped schools with highly motivated teachers, while those in low socio-economic status attend poorly equipped schools with demoralized teachers, resulting in differences in performance, with the children from rich families performing better than those from poor families clearly indicates that education cannot be regarded as a means of open social mobility, especially vertical mobility. The high socio-economic status occupiers will monopolize the highest educational levels, as well as the most prestigious occupations in society.

The ability of education to initiate economic and social change is limited by the fact that it is a product of the very environment in which change is being sought. Those who should modify the educational system and create equality are themselves products of it and are very much influenced by it. Efforts should therefore be made to create equality of opportunities in education and the role of the school in creating this equality should be expounded.

Recommendations

- ❖ The government should ensure that all schools whether public or private have adequate facilities and well qualified teachers.
- ❖ In education, learners should be given equality of opportunity, whereby there are same goals, same openings, same means and free conditions for competition. Learners should be provided with equal opportunities to enter school or complete at certain levels.
- ❖ Learners must be accorded a common social experience and common social contact so that there can be social harmony and justice.
- ❖ There must be compensatory education for those children who are socially and culturally deprived so that they can be brought up to the same educational level of attainment as the advantaged children

- ❖ Inappropriate examination questions biased in favour of particular groups either due to their content or the intellectual processes, which they demand, should be avoided.
- ❖ Academic disciplines should be de-emphasized in favour of other activities that are good to society such as sports, community assignments and behaviour.

DRAFT

Questions/Activities



- a) Define Social Stratification and discuss five ways in which it affects academic achievement in Kenya.
- b) Explain how Socio-Economic Status of families affect Education
- c) Discuss whether Education does or does not contribute to social stratification.
- d) Visit two primary schools in your locality. One should cater for learners from low socio-economic status families while the other should cater for learners from higher socio-economic status. Compare the academic performance of learners in the Kenya Certificate of Primary Education for the last three years. Find out the occupation of parents and observe the facilities available.

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LESSON 8

SCHOOL AS A SOCIAL ORGANIZATION

Introduction

An organization involves people, who are trying to achieve something that is perceived to be worthy of pursuing. Organizations are structured for a purpose, that is, to achieve certain goals and objectives. Members in each organization are supposed to interact with one

another in an effort to achieve the organizational goals. In this chapter, the school as a social organization is analysed. In doing so, the meaning and concepts of a social organization, characteristics of a social organization and the nature of a school as a social organization are discussed.

Objectives



By the end of the lesson, learners should be able to:

- ❖ Define Social Organizations
- ❖ Explain characteristics that make schools social organizations
- ❖ Point out ways in which schools can be used as agents of positive change in society.

Meaning And Concept Of A Social Organization

According to Etzion (1964) organizations are “social” units that pursue specific goals, which they are structured to serve. Social organizations can therefore be described as the ways in which human conduct becomes socially organized. Examples of organizations are: universities, hospitals, prisons, armies, churches and schools. Members in each organization are supposed to interact with one another in an effort to achieve the organizational goals and objectives. These goals may either be profit oriented or client oriented. Hagedorn (1983) points out that organization involves bringing people and resources together in a coordinated way to produce a service or a tangible product (goods). Resources include equipment, raw materials, information and time.

An organization can therefore, be perceived as **a collection of people whose behaviour is guided and coordinated to achieve perceived goals** (Gwarinda, 1993). In school, there is indeed a collection of people who are coordinated to achieve some goals. Education is often referred to as a human service organization, that is essentially designed, not – for- profit enterprise, although it may make some profit (Stein 1981).

The Structure of Organizations.

According to Mintzberg (1979) organization have five basic parts, these are:

a) Operating Core

This encompasses those members who perform the basic work related directly to the production of goods and services. In a school, teachers are therefore, the operating cores, as it is they that carry out the basic work of teaching pupils to become what is intended.

b) Strategic Apex

This includes those members who are charged with the overall responsibility of the organization. They ensure that the goals are achieved, presumably in an effective and efficient way. They also ensure that the needs of the owners of the organization are met. In

school, the head teacher, deputy head and the senior teacher constitute the strategic apex.

c) Middle line

This refers to those members who have direct authority over operatives but do not constitute part of the strategic apex. They are first line supervisors and managers. This refers to heads of department. **d) Techno structure**

It refers to the analysts who effect standardization in the organization. They evaluate the operations and make relevant recommendations. In the educational system, such people tend to be external to the organization, that is, District Education Officers, (D.E.O.s), and Assistant Education Officers (A. E. Os) and school inspectors. **e) Support Staff**

They provide support services to the organization “outside” the operational workflow, that is, they are not part of the operating core. They are not the mainstay of the organization but a component of it. In the school, support staff includes secretaries, clerks, bursar, technicians, gardeners, drivers and all those people who enable the operating core to function. They are vital to the success of the school.

Pupils are not included as they are considered to be the product or “raw Materials” of the school’s operations. They come into school and leave as products. They are clients of the school, which gives them services for which they pay.

Characteristics Of Social Organizations

According to Max Weber (1947), all social organizations must ideally have the following characteristics:

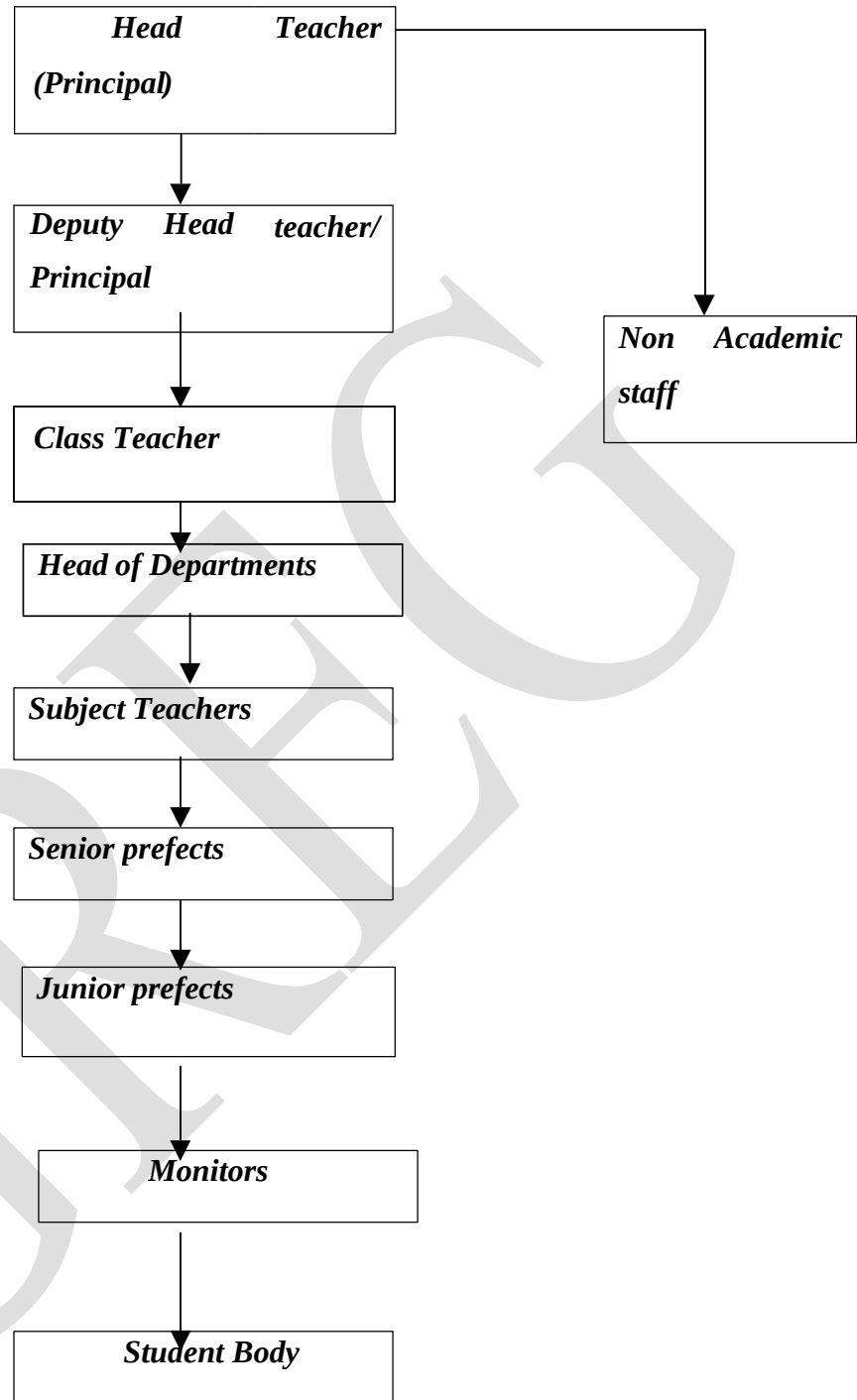
- a) Organizations tasks are distributed among the various positions as official duties. There is a clear-cut division of labour among the official positions.
- b) The positions /statuses are organized into a hierarchical authority structure- superior and inferior. Every organization has a formally instituted pattern of authority.
- c) There is a formally established system of Rules and Regulations, which govern or regulate official decisions and actions e.g. T.S.C. Code of conduct, school rules and regulations. The rules and procedures are intended to achieve specific goals. The rules govern and regulate the behaviour of members.
- d) Officials are expected to assume an impersonal orientation in their contacts with clients and other officials.
- e) Employment in the organization constitutes a career for the officials. An official is in full time employment. Teachers should see themselves as permanently there.
- f) Employment is by merit, based on qualifications

Nature of school as a Social Organization

a) Hierarchy Arrangement

In a social organization there is hierarchy. In schools the head teacher is at top of the hierarchy and can legitimately interact with those below him/her.

The Social Structure of the School



In the diagram above, the central line shows that the head teacher can legitimately interact with any occupier of the positions by passing through the intermediate positions in the hierarchy, while the occupiers of the lower positions in the hierarchy are expected to interact with the head teacher/ Principal or any other official at the top by passing through the appropriate higher positions. In the school setting, this is not always so. The principal can communicate directly with the teachers and students without necessarily passing through the deputy or heads of departments. Ideally, however, the head teacher is expected to reach any occupier of the positions below through the appropriate channels. The arrows

indicate the flow of communication. Clear lines of communication are expected to make the organization more efficient. Having the authority structure of the school more efficiently ordered should result in proper coordination of all the activities of each of the positions within the hierarchy.

b) Positions and occupations

The structure of an organization, is expected to have fewer positions at the top than below, it thus possesses an apex. In the school setting there are more students than teachers. The head teacher is the head of the structural hierarchy. The administrative positions are at the top of the hierarchy such as the deputy and head of departments to increase the smooth administrative functioning of the school.

The school is a bureaucratic organization. The positions are arranged in a hierarchical manner so that the topmost position is superior to the lower ones. Authority is ordered from the most superior position to the lowest. Outside the school system, head teachers receive orders from the Ministry of Education and the Teachers Service Commission. The head teacher, as the chief executive within the school system, is subordinate to the Ministry of Education. However, within each school the head teacher, is the most superior officer and all other positions are subordinate to him.

The head teacher plays a dual function. He is an administrator and a teacher. As an administrator, he oversees the day-to-day functioning of the school. The head gives directives to his subordinates, both academic and non-academic. As a teacher, the head teaches and works for curriculum improvement. The head teacher is accountable for the actions of every other person occupying a position in the school. Authority in the school is ordered from the head teacher to all other positions through the deputy principal and departmental heads, since he/she is the central focus for decision-making. He dictates the environment for interaction. Some head teachers communicate directly or indirectly with the teachers and students. No official of the school system is bureaucratically allowed to have dealings or communication with others outside the school system without the knowledge or approval of the school head.

The school bursar is the head of the non-academic staff and is directly responsible to the head teacher. The head prefect is the head of the student body and has a number of subordinates under him.

The subordinate members of the school system expect the head teacher to provide a leadership role in the school. The head, due to the office, legitimately expects teachers and other staff to fulfil certain obligations. The teacher does work, not in isolation, but in relation to others in the school system. A person performs better when the person has a clear idea of what is expected of him/her and knows what to expect from others.

Understanding the authority structure of the school is one of the means of performing effectively in the school system (Gwarinda, 1993). ***c) Activities***

Primary schools are either hierarchically organized schools or flat organizational schools.

Hierarchical structured schools

In these schools, activities are done officially. The head teacher does not deal directly with the teachers and students but passes the information to the deputy or senior

teacher and others follow the instructions to the letter. The head teacher determines all policies, activities and techniques of the group, dictates the work to be done and is personal in criticisms while remaining 'aloof' in demeanour. Schools emphasize conformity and obedience. By extension authoritarianism is emphasized.

Advantages

- ❖ Official work done effectively and officers are seen to be working.
- ❖ Quality work done
- ❖ Production high
- ❖ Respect to the powers that be.

Disadvantage

- ❖ The atmosphere is repressive, staff motivated by fear of consequences.
- ❖ The head teacher is out of touch with reality, ❖ Low staff morale.
- ❖ The head becomes a target of hostility, fails to integrate with staff and can be sabotaged.

Flat Organizational Structure:

This is a situation whereby head teachers do not adhere very strictly to the official channels. They go direct to the concerned parties. Everybody tends to be involved in the day-to-day administration of the school. The head teacher encourages discussion, ensures that all policies are decided by the group, gives technical advice while providing alternatives for member's choice, is objective in criticism on the basis of 'facts' and tries to be a 'regular' or a 'normal' member of the group. **Advantage**

- ❖ There is job satisfaction. Teachers have a strong feeling of prestige because of their participation in decision-making process.
- ❖ Teachers feel recognized and appreciated. The head teacher interacts more directly with subject teachers and allows them to have a say in the administration of the school and recognizes the contribution of each individual teacher. Teachers are happier than those in hierarchical schools.
- ❖ Motivation is very high because teachers are consulted. Teachers are more involved in administrative duties, so they take responsibility.

❖ Disadvantage

- ❖ Productivity can be low if not well handled **d)**

Rules and Regulations

There are formally established systems of rules and regulations, which govern or regulate official decisions and actions in schools.

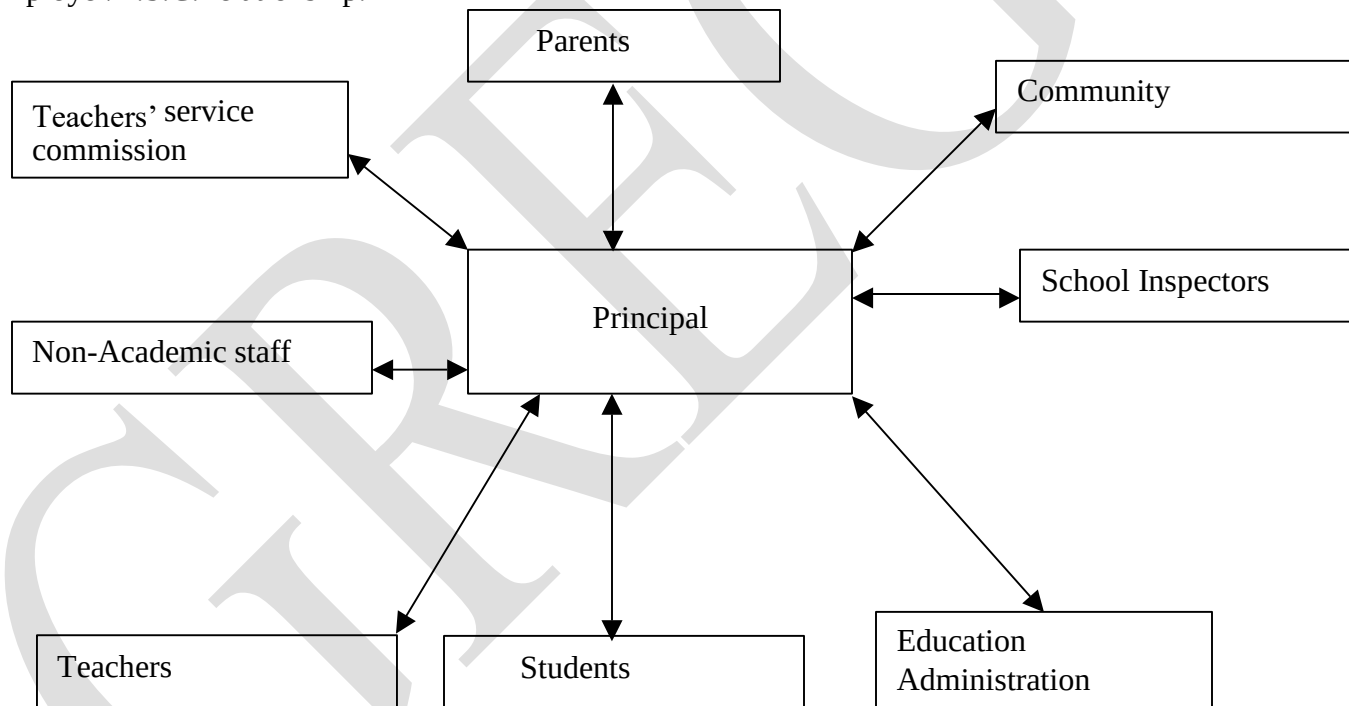
The Teachers Service (Staff) Regulation: This regulates the actions and decisions of the head teacher and teachers. It is externally prescribed and reinforced.

Internal Regulation: This regulates the decisions and actions of the head teacher and members of staff. It is locally prescribed by the school and constitutes the internal regulations in the school system.

Student rules and regulations: This regulates student's actions and is prescribed by the school authority. The regulations are to ensure the uniformity of operations and conformity and participation in accordance with laid down rules.

e) Relationships

There is a network of social relationships within and outside the school system. The head teacher has formal relationship with several people or groups of people both inside and outside the school system. He has dealings not only with teachers and students but also with parents, members of the community, which the school serves, school inspectors and members of the teacher's service commission. The relationship consists of the following: head teacher/teachers relationship, head teacher/ students relationship, head teacher/ non academic staff relationship, head teacher/ parents relationship and head teacher/ employer/T.S.C. relationship.



Head teacher/teachers relationship

The head teacher is perceived as a leader. The head teacher is in control of the teachers and allocates them school duties. The relationship between the head teacher and teachers depends on leadership styles. There are three leadership styles in schools:

❖ *The Autocratic Head Teacher.*

This is a head teacher with unlimited power. He/she requires things to be done without considering the wishes of others. The head teacher is harsh and rules with an iron hand, dictating what the teachers should do. The teacher- head teacher relationship is one of fear, silence and intimidation. This environment discourages initiative and creates poor learning environment (Bennaars, Otiende and Boisvert 1994).

❖ *Democratic Head Teacher*

The head teacher seeks to obtain the consensus of the majority, while allowing for dissenting views. The head teachers are liberal, allowing teacher to participate in decisionmaking. The teacher-head teacher relationship is cordial. (Bennaars, Otiende and Boisvert 1994). This leadership style helps create conducive learning environment as discussions are encouraged and the learners' views listened to. Those under this leadership develop positive self-image and confidence.

❖ *Laissez Faire Head Teacher*

These head teachers lack control of their schools and are usually very chaotic. Teachers have no respect for the head teacher and are frequently absent or when present are busy on other issues besides education. The learning environment is noisy, dirty and chaotic. Performance in such schools is poor as learners and teachers lack supervision (Bennaars, Otiende and Boisvert 1994)

Head teacher/ student's relationship

This relationship depends on the leadership style with students under the autocratic leadership living under fear, silence and suppression. These are the students likely to cause strikes. Students under democratic leadership are motivated, have high self-esteem as they are usually consulted in issues affecting the school. The head teacher student relationship is one of friendship and respect. In laissez-faire type of leadership, the students may have no relationship with the head teacher, as the head is hardly available or accessible. Students are de-motivated, as no one seems to be in control. The students are likely to be involved in anti social behaviour such as drug taking and strikes.

Head teacher/ Non-Academic Staff relationship

The relationship between the head teacher and the non-academic staff in any learning institution depends on the heads leadership style. The non-academic staff under the autocratic leadership work under fear due to intimidation and suspicion due to the heads use of spies. There is also uncertainty as they can be easily sacked. The Non academic staff under are free to air their views. The relationship with the head teacher is one of respect and friendship. In laissez-faire type of leadership, the non-academic staff may not carry out their duties effectively as there is little or no supervision. Non-academic staff members may be de-motivated and hostile towards the head teacher. Their welfare may not be well looked after and many are likely to work without regular pay.

Head teacher/ parent's relationship

This relationship is based on the recognition of the head teacher as an authority figure. The parents look upon the head as an overall decision maker in all matters related to teaching methods and procedures, the curricula and the teachers. On the other hand the head teacher expects the parents to pay fees and participate in school activities.

Head teacher/ employer/T.S.C. relationship

The head is perceived as a leader able to control and direct teachers. The head is expected to follow rules, regulations and procedures laid down by the employer. Supervision is not done too closely yet there is adequate control.

The teacher has social relationships involving:

Teacher/ students' relationship

In this relationship the teacher introduces formality and authority. There are rules, regulations and set procedures to be followed by learners. A teacher may succeed in creating more intimate, informal relations with learners or creating hostility and indifference). Pupils regard the teacher as a source of power, resources (knowledge and skills) as well as personal satisfaction (such as recognition, approval, acceptance) (Robertson 1996). In the classroom the teacher is expected to play multiple roles, which include teaching, guidance and administration (Benaars, Otiende and Boisvert 1994).

The authoritarian teacher has the highest amount and quality of work done but the pupils tend to have low morale. The democratic teacher has moderate work done. The pupils have high morale and high work motivation. The laissez faire teacher has little work done and whatever is done is likely to be of poor quality as the pupils lack direction.

However, concern has been raised on the effect of differentiation amongst the pupils and its consequences on effective teaching. Studies have shown that student attitudes to particular teaching styles and teaching methods vary according to the students' own personality. Student-centred instruction tends to be preferred by those students who 'reject traditional sources of authority', have strong needs for demonstrating their personal independence and are characterized by a high drive for academic achievement. The type of student with high authoritarian needs is likely to be unhappy in the student centred class (Banks 1968).

It has been pointed out that teachers exhibit a good deal of unconscious discrimination against children from lower socio economic backgrounds as compared to those from upper socio economic backgrounds. This bias is assumed to arise from the adherence of middle class values, which characterize the schoolteacher by virtue of their social class position. Children from lower socio economic status families are at times regarded as unrewarding to teach due to their low levels of motivation and indiscipline that makes them difficult to control. Teachers have raised complaints over habits of some of the including aggression, lack of cleanliness and indifference to hygiene. It is much easier to teach and interact with children who are highly motivated to learn and who respond to the teacher's efforts (Banks, 1968)

Teachers' relationship with the students is negatively affected by such behaviour as stealing, lying, aggression and destruction of property. Teachers may prefer and relate well with children who are easy to teach and so, unwittingly discriminate in favour of well to do children who are more likely to be hard working and well behaved. Teachers do sometimes discriminate against lower class children, not by giving them less attention but by giving them less approval (Banks, 1968) **Teacher/ Non-academic staff relationship**

This relationship depends on the teacher's personality. If the teacher is harsh, intimidating, the non-academic staff may show fear, hostility and avoidance, but if the teacher is friendly and social, the non-academic staff may show friendliness and respect.

Teacher/ parent's relationship

Parents expect the teachers to teach and guide their children. The relationship between parents and teachers is influenced by the learner's background. Schools catering for learners from high socio economic status tend to involve parents more in school activities therefore creating frequent contacts between parents and teachers. The relationship is

frequently one of friendship and respect. On the other hand most parents from low socio economic backgrounds display fear and at times hostility towards schoolteachers.

Several roles of the teacher may sometimes conflict with one another. In such a situation the teacher has to determine which one should take precedence. For example, a teacher may be seen as working within three interacting and overlapping organizational systems, which consist of:

- a) The bureaucratic principles of the school
- b) The principles of professionalism which emphasize autonomy, independence and freedom and
- c) The informal work group values, which are those un-coded systems of beliefs and orientations that bind together individual members of the school staff.

Teacher/Teacher relationship

The teacher is enmeshed in a whole system of social relationships, which include not only pupils but also colleagues on the school staff. There are a number of factors, which underlie clique formation among teachers. These include age, length of service, sex, values and interests. Segregation between sexes, and between college and non-college graduates is evident (Corwin 1965) among teachers in schools. In some schools those who teach Science based subjects segregate themselves from those teaching art-based subjects. Differences are at times manifested in relation to socio-economic status.

Informal teacher cliques in schools compete with each other for power and influence within the school system and influence with administrators, parents and pupils. Conflict will arise between older and younger teachers, or senior and junior teachers over the introduction of new methods, organizational forms or procedures. Other controversial areas include allocation of funds to particular departments, clubs and activities. Timetable allocation, duties and responsibilities can result in conflicts among teachers. Informal relationships between teachers are important aspect in the functioning of the school (Banks 1968).

Student Relationships

Pupils form significant social groupings in schools. These social groupings are characterized by a distinct youth culture, which is to a large extent distinct from, and can even be in opposition to the adult world of the teacher and the school.

The students' relationship consists of:

Student –student relationship

This relationship depends on various factors such as academic performance, hobbies, classes, sitting arrangements and socialization. Hostilities may arise due to divergent views and opinions. According to Gwarinda (1993), the student-to-student relationships encompass various categories such as:

❖ *The stars;*

These are the most popular students. Popularity may be through positive or negative attributes depending on type schools culture. For boys' athletics and for girls looks and personality are the chief determinants of status, rather than academic achievement. The 'stars' may be informal leaders of students and may influence pupil /pupil relationship and

teacher-pupil relationship in school. Teachers should try to discover the informal power structure within the classroom and use it to create harmony and a conducive learning environment. ***The Neglectees;***

These are students who want to identify with popular students but are themselves not popular. ***The Isolates;***

These students are neither popular nor do they try to identify with popular students. They live their own independent lives and are hardly bothered with what occurs in school or the classroom.

The Rejectees;

These students are hated and rejected by other students either because they behave differently, look different or are regarded as spies for the administration.

Not all students go along with the values of the 'leading crowd' and these students may not be isolates. They may form their own well-integrated group (Banks 1968).

Hargreaves (1967) pointed out that there are two value climates in schools, the academic and the deliquescent. The academic sub culture is characterized by hard work, a high standard of physical hygiene and dress, the avoidance of 'messing' in clad and of copying work from another pupil. The delinquents sub culture is the opposite. Dress is deliberately nonconformists, long hair, and participation in actions that are against school rules are encouraged. At the same time messing 'in class becomes a substitute for work, truancy is frequent and copying is the rule. Smoking and fighting are signs of status. Students tend to associate with others from their own value climates. The school dominated normative culture comes to be opposed by the anti group culture.

Being aware of the student relationship can help the teacher run the class in a balanced way for example giving the star leadership roles where appropriate, ensuring the inclusion of neglectees and isolates in group work and counselling isolates, neglectees and rejects (Gwarinda 1993). Students are not born into a school system; rather they join it by accident'. (Ezewu; 1983). They can be regarded as both members of the school and clients.

The relationship among all the members in a school organization is controlled by the patterns of social interaction, for example how teachers interact with the head teacher and the pupils and by the frequency and duration of contacts between members. The relationship between each of these groups is conditioned by rules and regulations of the school system either made for it or by it for the internal regulation of its affairs.

Organizational Goals of the school

Every organization, including the school is expected to have an organizational goal, which it must strive to attain. When attained, new goals are set and new strategies for reaching them identified. Questions have been raised on what goals schools ought to pursue and whether schools should set their own goals as ends in themselves or should the goals reflect values of the society as a whole. The school is not distinct from the community or society in which it carries on its business. It cannot pursue goals different from the values of the society of which it is a part.

The goal of the school is learning. To attain this goal in any school system, all the members of the school, including the students must be able to contribute their own share of effort. The students ought to be seen as members of the school system interacting with

other members and striving to attain the school goal. Even when the head teacher and teachers play their role well, the school goal may not be realized if students fail to play their part. The school is a service organization to the society. Organizations cultivate distinctive patterns of behaviour, which are adapted more or less to their functions. The school as an organization is expected to serve society in the socialization of its youth. The school therefore is established to serve directly the students and indirectly the society.

Summary



In this lesson the school as a social organization is analysed.

Organizations are defined as “social” units that pursue specific goals, which they are structured to serve. Social organizations are therefore described as the ways in which human conduct becomes socially organized. The structure of organizations consist of five basic parts consisting of Operating Core, Strategic Apex, Middle line, Techno structure and Support Staff. Characteristics of organizations include among others clear-cut divisions of labour and specific rules that govern and regulate the behaviour of members.

The school being a social organization has the positions of authority arranged in a hierarchical manner so that the topmost position is superior to the lower ones. The head teacher holds the most superior position. Authority is delegated from the most superior position to the lowest. The head teacher is expected to provide leadership role in the school. The relationship between the head teacher and teachers, students, and non-academic staff depends on the style of leadership.

The head teacher has formal relationship with several people or groups of people both inside and outside the school system. He/she has dealings not only with teachers and students but also with parents, members of the community, which the school serves, school inspectors and members of the teacher's service commission. Other relations include the teacher student relationship, teacher /Non- academic staff relationship and teacher parent relationship and student- student relationship among others.

The goals of the school are not distinct from the community or society in which it carries on its business. It cannot pursue goals different from the values of the society of which it is a part.

Conclusion

The school is a part of a wider social system although within its own boundaries, it operates a special sub-system. The child comes from the community that has socialized it in certain skills, habits, attitudes, feelings, values and perceptions to the school culture. The school as an organization has its own behavioural, skill and value requirements to which the child and other members of staff must adapt. Efforts should be made to understand the child's background and his/her relationship to other members of the school community.

The school in turn, influences the community and society in terms of the 'finished product' that is, the pupil who enters society with new skills, behaviours and values. Pupils in a school give it a certain character and reputation. People in society judge a school by its pupils. Whatever method of leadership the school adapts, it should make effort to shape its learners to fit in society. Methods of school leadership affect the whole society since they can contribute to positive or negative school achievement.

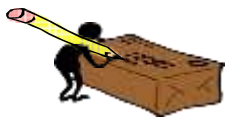
Recommendations

- ❖ Communication is a vital component in all organizations. Pupils in schools interact with their teachers as human beings. They should be listened to. Members should be able to interact with each other freely. Open interaction between teachers and

the administration and teachers and students, enables teachers to have a strong feeling of prestige, job satisfaction and participation and this improves academic performance.

- ❖ In a school organization there should be clarity on the organizational goals, rules and regulations, and hierarchical structure. This will reduce disagreements among members. Uniformity established all most adhere to specific rules and regulations
- ❖ All members of the school community should play an active role in its development. It has been found out that, the more a teacher is involved in decision making of the school, the more likely the teacher is to take initiatives in the discharge of duties and consequently the more creative and efficient the teacher becomes. The more involved students are (through consultation) in the decisions made for the school, the more they are likely to identify with the school and work hard to portray a positive image of the school.
- ❖ Participation is an important ingredient in social systems even among peers. For an organization to attain its goals, all the members have to participate actively in the activities of the organization. It is important for head teachers to be aware that there is leadership styles that promote wholesome learning while others serve as barriers.

Questions and activities



Discuss the structure of an organization

Identify characteristics that make a school a social organization.

Discuss the similarities and differences between hierarchically organized schools and flat organizational schools.

List the differences between Autocratic, Democratic and Laissez Faire head teachers

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LESSON 9

GENDER AND SCHOOL EDUCATION

Introduction

Inequality in education tends to manifest itself in various ways, such as gender disparities in school accessibilities. This lesson analyses the influence of gender on school education by stating the meaning and concept of gender, analysing factors contributing to the neglect of gender issues, indicating the purpose of gender analysis, discussing gender related theories, gender issues in education and the role of education in achieving gender equity.

Objectives



By the end of this lesson learners should be able to:

- ❖ Define Gender
- ❖ Give examples of gender inequality in schools in Kenya
- ❖ State how gender equality can be achieved in the education system.

Meaning and concept of Gender

The term gender refers to the set meanings, roles and expectations that society ascribes to each sex. The concept itself is different from the term sex in that sex is biologically determined while gender is culturally determined. Gender is culturally determined and can be different from one particular society to another or from one community to another. Gender refers to the masculine and feminine roles. Either males or females can play these roles (Gwarinda, 1993). Whereas it is quite easy to tell each individuals sex, it is not easy to tell ones gender. Gender is therefore a construct. We cannot measure it directly but we can only use certain measurable indicators, which can help us to infer its nature, form and extent.

The word gender is derived from Latin Noun GENUS, meaning kind, sort and group. The term “GENDER” was until recently specifically used to refer to classes or kinds; Masculine, feminine and neuter. In English Language, such classification tends to be along natural lines. The meaning of gender changed in the 1970s. It was expected to include: A classification of social and cultural traits that differentiate between the masculine and the feminine socially and culturally and traditional and other traits assigned to gender to bring out differentiating factors, evident especially in distinguishing between their masculine and feminine characteristics.

Sociologists and Social psychologists argue that while sex refers to the biological characteristics by which human beings are categorized as ‘male’ ‘female’, or in rare instances ‘hermaphrodite’ (in which the biological characteristics of both sexes are actually or apparently combined), gender refers to the social and social-psychological attributes by which human beings are categorized as ‘masculine’, ‘feminine’ or ‘androgynous’ (in which the social –psychological characteristics of both genders are intentionally or unintentionally combined) (Jarvis and Jarvis 1999).

Many sociologists stress that within sociological discourse; gender should be used when referring to the socially created division of society into those who are masculine and those who are feminine. Whereas ‘male’ and ‘female’ are terms reserved for biological differences between men and women and boys and girls masculine and feminine are reserved for culturally imposed behavioural and temperamental traits deemed socially appropriate to the sexes. These traits are learnt via a complex and continuing process of **socialization** (Jarvis and Jarvis 1999)

Manifestation of Gender Disparity in Society

Gender disparity is displayed within societies in various ways. Some of these include:

- a) The assumption held by society that girls and by extension women are less intelligent. As a result jobs that are less challenging are given to them. For a long time in Kenya Ministries such as Finance, Health and Security were a preserve of men while the ministry related to sports and social services was given to women.
- b) Men occupy positions of leadership and authority. By extension they dictate who gets what. A case in point is the East African Assembly when the East African countries were to provide representatives. Women were allocated various seats but because of the domination of males in Kenya, this did not materialize. Most qualified Human Resource is male. They therefore occupy leadership positions in every sector of the economy and to keep these positions secure; many justify the view that women are unable.
- c) Girls and women who venture into the male dominated careers are seen as deviants. They are viewed with suspicion, as regarded as either not earning their positions in a rightful manner or being assisted. They are seen as intruders in the male dominated domains. These include women who fight for positions of authority such as members of parliament. They are ridiculed with their past history normally brought to the lime light as a proof of how incapable they are, however men's past life, however immoral it might be is hardly scrutinized. Some of the women and girls who struggle to change their destination in life are subjected to harassment and a few who succeed are regarded as having been compromised particularly through sexual favours.
- d) Vocal and assertive girls and women are labelled as deviants, misfits, troubleshooters and divorcees or those who will never be married. This label is supposed to silence them. Society expects them to be obedient, subservient. Educated women and girls are at times treated with suspicion and hostility. The highly educated such as university graduates are viewed as immoral, infertile due to over use of family planning methods. They are regarded as radicals who deviate the societal norms. Some of these girls and women end up not getting partners as a result of the negative labels in the society. This view is not held for males.
- e) Culturally women and girls are not supposed to patronize certain social places such as hotels unless accompanied by their partners. In Kenya there have been cases where women have not been served or have been sent away from hotels because male partners did not accompany them. However, a lone male can be served. In order for married women to acquire passports, men or Husbands must sign the forms to allow issuing of the documents. Title deeds are allocated to males and in most societies division of land and property for inheritance is given to the male child.

Factors contributing to the neglect of Gender Issues in society

Over the years, the focus on gender as an aspect of social problems of equality and opportunities has been minimal or non-existent. Reasons for this neglect are: **a) *Lack of differentiation between gender and sex:***

To most people, the mention of the word gender implies women. Consequently, roles and duties performed by women or girls, for example domestic chores, rearing children were often associated with the gender understanding. Due to the confusion of gender and sex, it was thought that specific, biological based functions that females played for example, bearing, suckling, caring for children were always naturally determined along gender lines.

b) Traditional beliefs

The existence of powerful traditional beliefs and assumptions as helped create gender typing. Beliefs such as females cannot be heirs or rulers in society, and only males have this inherited, ascribed honour to be heirs of possessions, have helped discourage women from vying to inherent this positions. Some women perceive and preach that socially high offices are not God given to women, only to men. They have helped strengthen social positions in society that males are superior to females. (In elections, women in particular do not often give votes to other women as political candidates or office holders as they believe women are incapable of holding such high offices).

c) Confusion on the intelligence of women

It had been assumed in many societies that women were less intelligent than men. This assumption was largely due to the absence of statistical evidence concerning comparative studies touching on male and female intellectual differences.

d) Reinforcement of differences between men and Women

The presence of strong influential forces based on social class, ethnicity and even religion reinforcing the human differences between men and women and the roles each should play in society has affected gender awareness. For example, in religion, there is still a strong belief that women cannot serve God as ministers, pastors or prophets, only men can. This belief continues to influence the consideration of gender issues.

The Purpose of Gender Analysis

Gender analysis proceeds from the premise that, from the very beginning, there is inequality between boys and girls, which is translated into unequal power relations between men and women at all levels of society (Molokomme, 1997). Thus one finds that in society, a patriarchal structure exists, whereby men have control, power and authority over women. Patriarchy (from “Pater” Latin for “father”), literally means “rules by the father”, therefore rule by men. Gender analysis thus seeks to examine the “social relations of domination and subordination between men and women structured into the institutions and workings of society”.

Gender in Conventional Theories of society

a) *Functionalism*

Functionalism generally looks at women as being disadvantaged only because they are required to play certain roles that ensure the smooth functioning of society. Functionalist scholars argue that the primary role of women is that of being mothers and housewives (the family concept of father, mother and children being held as vital). It is argued that, accordingly, the position of women on the labour market (that is, outside the home) is weakened compared to that of men who are constant breadwinners.

Other arguments advanced by functionalists (Haralambos and Holborn, 1990) are that: -

- ❖ Women tend to be “secondary bread winners” (compared to men), therefore, they tend to be regarded as less valuable in terms of equal pay;
- ❖ Women are not as geographically mobile as men since they tend to be tied to the home, while career advancement usually requires residential mobility which men easily execute; and
- ❖ Women tend to be over-abundant in occupations “suitable” for them making their demand less pressing for industry, commerce, and etcetera.

Functional theory thus considers the male-female relations as inevitable based on the roles they play as, indeed, the result of the biological role of bearing children, a role which is, according to the theory *ascribed*.

b) *Marxism*

Among the Marxist scholars, Friedrich Engels was the first to delve into the gender question in the Nineteenth Century. The basic starting point of Engels (1972) is that in communal society many years ago, men and women were equal because there was no *private property*. All major means of production were communally owned.

In Marxist theory, private property is wealth or resources owned by a few people who exploit the labour power of others. It is *not* the same as *personal property* used by oneself for one’s daily needs. Engels argues that at some historical point, men began to appropriate property, turning it into private property and women became dependent on men for survival in exchange for sex and the creation of heirs to the men’s property.

From then onwards, men have elaborated their control over women in all spheres of life (Engels 1972).

Whatever the exactness of the historical roots may be, the important message from the theory is that the source of men’s power over women is the male ownership of the means of production and until property relations are changed, women will always hold an inferior position to men on the whole.

Vladimir Lenin (1974) lays down two major steps in emancipating women from male oppression:

- ❖ Legislating for equality between men and women from male oppression;
- ❖ Abolishing the private ownership of the means of production to ensure that, through engagement in socially owned enterprises, women can be released from ‘household bondage’ or ‘household slavery’.

To Marxist scholars, therefore, marriage itself is a property relation in class-based society in spite of notions of ‘love’ that may be said to be attached to it. *Feminism*

There are three categories of feminism (Haralambos and Holborn 1990), these are:

Radical Feminism

They blame the exploitation of women on men and the patriarchal system based on the family. Thus men are the ruling class and women are the subject, exploited class. Women must, accordingly liberate themselves by overthrowing patriarchal society to establish equality of the sexes or even to replace patriarchy with matriarchy. ***Marxist or socialist Feminism***

They blame women's oppression in the different ownership of the means of production between men and women. Women's emancipation is regarded as possible only with the socialization of the means of production and destruction of social classes (in the Marxist sense) under the socialist and communist revolution

Liberal Feminism

They advocate the gradual equalization of the sexes through reform or incremental adjustments of inequality. It is considered that the creation of equal opportunities, for example in education, should eventually lead to quality.

Gender issues in Education.

a) Unequal access to schooling

There are inequalities of educational opportunities between boys and girls.

Although enrolment and participation of girls in education is nearly 50% in Kenya at the primary level, it is very low in some provinces such as North Eastern and Coast provinces. However, in general the enrolment decreases as one moves up the educational ladder. The low educational enrolment and participation of girls can be attributed to the socio-cultural attitudes, which favour education of male siblings. With the rise in the cost of education and living standards, girls more than boys have to stop schooling either through marriage, dropping out of school due to lack of fees, or having to fend for the family by becoming house assistants or hawkers. Some have to take care of their siblings after parents die of H.I.V/A.I.Ds.

b) Differences in performance

Recent studies in National examination show that except in languages, girl's achievement is comparatively lower than that of boys particularly in mathematics and Sciences. This disparity can be attributed to previous systems or philosophy, which tended to offer pure sciences to boys schools but general science to girls schools or more boys schools offering sciences than girls schools. These factors can discourage girls from competing with boys in mathematics and sciences.

c) School attainment

This is the length of time that one remains in school and the level of education that one attains. Low school attainment has often been reported significantly among girls than boys. The reasons behind this occurrences are early pregnancies, gender unfriendly environment for example girls given extra burdens such as house chores after school while the boys are left to do their homework, negative social practices such as female circumcision and early marriages. A girl is kept at home rather than a boy when there are limited resources.

d) Sex Stereotypes

Educational systems worldwide tend to exaggerate sex differences and effects in ways that limit educational opportunities of girls in particular. Gender stereotyping occurs in official curriculum, teaching materials like books and organization of subject choices.

Another factor related to stereotyping is the labelling theory. This begins with a false diagnosis out of the belief that girls are un-mathematical, lack a biologically given ability or lack spatial and analytical thinking. This label is eventually internalised and conclusively accepted thus bringing in the powerful self-fulfilling prophecy that there are certain subjects' girls cannot perform well in.

e) Under representation

Women are underrepresented in decision making in education although they make up the majority of the teaching force especially in primary schools. Girls are under exposed and protected from the environment within which their personal expression can be cultivated. In classroom participation, boys tend to dominate the classroom activities especially in talking, answering questions and responsibilities. This environment provides a situation in which it becomes difficult for girls to participate in class discussions. Boys dominate because of socialization.

f) Socialization Process

Gender identity begins in the family where parents treat male and female infants differently. Parents discourage feminine behaviour in sons. Boys are encouraged to show braveness, curiosity while girls are encouraged to be obedient, kind, submissive and cheerful.

g) School Curriculum

It is the general practice in our educational system, to channel females into subjects considered 'female' at all levels such as Home Economics, tailoring and secretarial studies, barring them from subjects considered tough and thus 'male' subjects such as Mathematics, Science and engineering. What this means is that females are discouraged based on the subject choices, from challenging males on the job market as adults and these results in gender inequality operating in such societies throughout life.

Studies of subject textbooks reveal that images of women and girls are hardly depicted in roles/areas like presidents, managers, and doctors in these books, while men are often depicted in such roles. Women are however depicted in roles such as nursing, airhostess, and secretaries. Such images when depicted in subject textbooks tend to impact on the children's self images and can influence their carrier selection and attitudes later on in life. Many Text Books portray girls as less superior being than boys. Strong characters are referred to as 'he' even if they reflect girls. Weak characters are normally portrayed as women. Girls are therefore socialized to view themselves as weak and the society accepts this position.

The Role Of Education In Achieving Gender Equity

Schools are useful vehicles through which gender inequality can be tackled. This can be through the following:

a) *Modification of attitudes;*

The school curriculum can be used to bring change of attitude in learners on sex roles. This can be achieved through discussions on issues such as sex roles and stereotyping. Retrogressive customs that hinder the advancement of females can be analysed and better alternatives suggested. The curriculum should come out clearly on sex role and sex stereotyping. The curriculum should not be skewed, such that, boys are exposed to courses that place them in a better position for jobs.

b) *Revision of Textbooks*

School text books particularly set books should be revised to change the “female image.” The set books should prepare both boys and girls well for the challenges ahead of them. No characters should be portrayed as weak simply because they are female or strong mainly on the basis of being male. Women and girls should be portrayed positively. Writers should employ neutral language when writing books.

c) *Encouragement of Girls in Science Based Subjects*

Girls should be introduced to and encouraged to pursue technical education subjects that are oriented to technical jobs in addition to science subjects and boys should be taught subjects such as Home Economics. Deliberate efforts should be made to encourage girls to take science-oriented subjects. Science subjects should be demystified for the girls to take them with ease.

d) *Sensitisation on Education for the Girl Child*

The public should be sensitised through barazas and mass media to take the girl child to school. Girls should be allowed to go back to school after delivery depending on circumstances rather than being expelled completely as undesirable examples or models for others. No child should be denied education simply because the child is female.

e) *Government support*

Whenever boys’ education is given preference, girls’ education should receive deliberate support through scholarships and bursaries. There should be support of non-formal education of women groups and adult literacy classes. The government should take stern measures against members of society who contribute to their daughters’ dropout cases from school through retrogressive actions such as circumcision, early marriages or deliberate refusal to pay school fees. Girls should be allowed to go back to school after delivery depending on circumstances rather than being expelled.

f) *Establishment of Girls schools*

More schools for girls’ especially boarding schools should be established particularly in crime prone areas such as North Eastern Province or where cultural practices such as female circumcision and early marriages are rampant.

Summary

This lesson analyses the influence of gender on school education. The term



gender in this lesson is used to refer to the set meanings, roles and expectations that society ascribes to each sex. Factors contributing to the neglect of gender issues in our society such as the lack of differentiation by many people between gender and sex, traditional beliefs, societies underrating of the intelligence of women and the reinforcement of differences between men and women, with the women being regarded as the weaker sex is discussed.

Various theories are discussed such as the Functionalism theory where women are viewed as being disadvantaged only because they are required to play certain roles that ensure the smooth functioning of society. They argue that the primary role of women is that of being mothers and housewives (the family concept of father, mother and children being held as vital). On the other hand Marxist scholars argues that at some historical point, men began to appropriate property, turning it into private property and women became dependent on men for survival in exchange for sex and the creation of heirs to the men's property. From then onwards, men have elaborated their control over women in all spheres of life, the source of men's power over women is the male ownership of the means of production and until property relations are changed, women will always hold an inferior position to men on the whole. On the other hand, Radical Feminism blames the exploitation of women on men and the patriarchal system based on the family.

Gender issues affecting education such as unequal access to schooling, differences in performance, school attainment, sex stereotypes, the under representation of women in decision making, the socialization process and the school curriculum are discussed. Suggestions are made on how education can play a role in achieving gender equity. This includes modification of attitudes; revision of textbooks, encouragement of girls to pursue Science based subjects, the sensitisation of society to educate the girl child *and Government support*

Various theories are discussed such as the Functionalism theory where women are viewed as being disadvantaged only because they are required to play certain roles that ensure the smooth functioning of society. They argue that the primary role of women is that of being mothers and housewives (the family concept of father, mother and children being held as vital).

On the other hand Marxist scholars argues that at some historical point, men began to appropriate property, turning it into private property and women became dependent on men for survival in exchange for sex and the creation of heirs to the men's property. From then onwards, men have elaborated their control over women in all spheres of life, the source of men's power over women is the male ownership of the means of production and until property relations are changed, women will always hold an inferior position to men on the whole. On the other hand, Radical Feminism blames the exploitation of women on men and the patriarchal system based on the family.

Conclusion In Kenya, gender disparities are reflected in education through unequal access to schooling, with more male than female students having access to schooling. In academic performance male students seem to perform better than females and to proceed to higher levels of education. In society in general, there is under representation of women in major decision-making bodies. However, the school can play a role in creating gender equality in society by giving all learners equal opportunities of advancement and by dispelling

regressive beliefs through influencing and modifying attitudes. Issues related to gender roles and relationships have a direct impact on human development and education because, for national development to occur, men and women must have equal access to the resources and benefits of development.

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LESSON 10

DRUG ABUSE IN SCHOOLS

Introduction

The history of the human race has also been a history of drug use. Since earliest times, herbs, roots, bark, leaves and plants have been used to relieve pain and help control disease. In and of itself, the use of drugs does not constitute evil; drugs properly administered have a medical component. Unfortunately, certain drugs also initially produce side effects, such as euphoria, a sense of feeling good, elation, serenity and power. However, what began as the use of drugs for relaxation evolved in time into a problem of dependence and abuse (Kerachio 1994).

Objectives



By the end of this chapter, learners should be able to:

- ❖ Define drug abuse and list some of the drugs abused in schools in Kenya
- ❖ List factors that contribute to drug abuse in schools in Kenya
- ❖ State the effect of drug abuse in Kenya and
- ❖ Give suggestions on how drug abuse can be stopped in the society in general and schools in particular

Meaning and concept of drugs, drug use, and drug-abuse

A drug is any chemical substance that, when taken into the body, can affect one or more of the body's functions. These include substances that are useful or harmful to the body.

Drugs can be divided into three simple types; positive, negative and hard drugs. Positive drugs are those accepted by society. They can be bought easily from shops, chemists, herbalist, hospitals or any other community based health centre. They are used to cure ailments. Negative drugs are drugs taken for pleasure or for making someone feel 'high'. Some of these drugs are socially accepted but their effect on the user is a slow drive to permanent addiction. Examples of some these drugs are; alcohol, Tobacco, Khat (miraa) and glue. Hard drugs are chemically made to stimulate the user and one becomes 'hooked' to the habit and soon begins to show dependence on the drugs. These drugs include Bhang, opium, heroin, mandrax and cocaine.

Drug abuse refers to the use of drugs for purposes other than therapeutic ones. In therapeutic use, drugs have intended effects aimed at relieving certain symptoms while the subject abusing drugs takes them to experience some effects associated with them. This may lead to dependence where the subject takes the drug on a continuous or periodic

basis in order to experience the psychic effect or to avoid the discomfort of not taking the drug. Not only do unpleasant physical symptoms occur when the drug is withdrawn, but the body habituates itself to the drug's effect and larger and larger doses are required. Psychologically, the addict is unable to face life and its problems without the drugs.

The addict has a chronic physical and psychological compulsion or craving to take the drugs in order to avoid unpleasant physical and psychological effects resulting from withdrawal from the drugs (Jarry and Jarry, 1999). Therefore, a drug is abused when its use causes harm to personal health, to others and to the society.

Types of Drugs

❖ Alcohol (ethanol);

This is a sedative hypnotic drug obtained by fermenting of carbohydrates using yeast. The active form of alcohol is ethyl alcohol or ethanol. Alcohol includes busaa, muratina, mnazi, beer, wine and whisky. Alcohol is a depressant, a drug that slows down the body's functioning (Lions Clubs International, 1992).

❖ Cannabis sativa (bhang)

This is the scientific name for marijuana (bhang). These are relaxant drugs. The active ingredient is called Tetrahydrocannabinol (THC).

❖ Amphetamines:

This is a group of behavioural stimulants that temporarily increase energy and mental alertness. Khat (Miraa) is an example.

❖ Analgesics

These are drugs that relieve pain without the loss of consciousness. Such drugs include aspirin and paracetamol.

❖ Anesthetics

These are drugs that cause loss of sensation of feeling especially pain. They affect the nervous system. General anaesthetics produce a sound sleep and are used for surgical procedures. Local anaesthetics are drugs that deaden a specific area of the body for medical procedures such as dental extraction. Xylocaine is an example of such a drug.

❖ Anti-depressant:

These are medicines used to treat patients with depressive psychological illness.

❖ Anti-psychotic:

This is a drug that produces an effect of emotional quietness and relative indifference to one's surroundings. These drugs are also called major tranquillizers. ❖

Barbiturates:

These are sedative hypnotic drugs that decrease the activity of the central nervous system and depress respiration, affect the heart rate and decrease blood pressure and temperature.

❖ Caffeine

This is one of the bitter crystalline alkaloids found in coffee (Cola drinks and chocolate). It acts as a central nervous system stimulant and mild diuretic.

❖ Cocaine

It is a white, crystalline, alkaloid, which acts as a local anesthetic. It is a dangerous, illegal stimulant. It causes increased heartbeat as well as a rise in blood pressure. In high doses, it can cause paranoid, thought disturbances and tachycardia. Crack or crack cocaine is the

free base stable form of cocaine. It produces a 'high' much more intense and rapid effect than that of normal cocaine.

❖ **Codeine:**

This is a sedative and pain-relieving agent found in opium and commonly used in cough syrups and analgesics.

❖ **Ecstasy:**

It is a designer drug that gives users a great sense of well being affection for all those around them, increased energy and sometimes hallucinations. Its adverse effects can make users feel ill or experience a sense of loss of control, dehydration and long time memory and weight loss.

❖ **Hallucinogens or Psychedelics**

These are substances that produce profound alterations in perception. Users may see, hear and feel things that are not there and may exhibit psychotic behaviour. These drugs include Lysergic Diethyl amide (LSD) and Mescaline

Hashish

A drug made by faking the resin from the stalk, leaves and flowers of the marijuana plant and pressing it into cakes.

❖ **Heroin**

A semi-synthetic derivative produced by the chemical modification of morphine. It is highly addictive and potent than morphine. It exists in white or brown powder form.

❖ **Khat (Miraa)**

This is an evergreen plant tree botanically called catha edulis. The parts used as drugs are the leaves and the fresh fender shoots that are plucked and then chewed by the users. The parts contain two known chemicals referred to as cathinone and cathine whose pharmacological properties are similar to those found in amphetamines.

❖ **LSD-Lysergic Diethyl amide**

This is a drug manufactured from lysergic acid, which is found in ergot, a fungus that grows on rye and other grains. It is one of the most potent mind-changing chemicals and is mostly ingested by placing a small square paper containing the drug on the tongue.

❖ **Morphine;**

This is a derivative of opium, which has a depressing effect on the central nervous system, particularly respiration. Morphine is the major sedative and pain-relieving drug found in opium.

❖ **Narcotic;**

Medically this is a drug that produces sleep or stupor and also relieves pain. Legally, a narcotic is any drug regulated under the Dangerous Drugs Act and should only be obtained with a doctor's prescription. ❖ **Opiate:**

It is a drug that is derived from the opium poppy. Morphine, codeine or heroins are in this category. Opiates induce sleep, relieve pain and are strongly addictive. Heroin is the most abused opiate. It produces a euphoric dream state. The user becomes desperate to avoid withdrawal syndrome and may engage in aggressive and risk-taking behaviour.

Opium:

It is an opiate derivative obtained from the juice of opium poppy. It takes the form of dark brown chunks or of a powder, which is usually smoked or eaten. The law strictly regulates its use and sale.

❖ **Rohypnol:**

‘Club drug’ is a tranquillizer that helps to relieve anxiety and helps in sleep. It is prescribed for insomnia .It is popular in clubs and parties for giving a drunken –like high. Rapists, who spike the drinks of victims, use it.

Some of the Drugs and their intake

Drugs	Type	Intake
Depressants	Alcohol	Swallowed
	Methaqualone	Swallowed
	Barbiturates	Swallowed/injected
Narcotics	Tranquillizers	Swallowed
	Heroin	Injected/sniffed/smoked
Hallucinogens	LSD	Swallowed
	PCP	Swallowed/injected/smoked
Stimulants	Amphetamines	Swallowed/injected
	Cocaine	Injected/swallowed
	Nicotine	Chewed/swallowed
Relaxants/Euphoriants	Marijuana	Smoked/ sniffed/swallowed
Inhalants	Glue	Sniffed
	Gasoline	Sniffed
	Paint thinner	Sniffed

The Drug situation in Kenya

Kenya risks being overpowered by an international network of drug peddlers, if it does not invest more in the surveillance campaign. There are many Kenyans whose vast riches can be linked directly to drug trafficking; besides Kenya being a key transit point for narcotics destined for America and Europe (Daily Nation, 2003).

The country is the conduit between producers in Pakistan and war-torn Afghanistan and consumers in the west. The frequent seizure of drugs at Jomo Kenyatta International airport is sufficient proof of the fact that large quantities of heroin are moving through Kenya (Opala; 2003). The United Nations International Drug Control Programme world drug report (2000) groups Kenya among four African nations that feature prominently on the global anti-narcotics map. The others are Nigeria, South Africa and Tanzania. These, countries, it says, are notorious for either the consumption or manufacture of heroin (Daily Nation, 2003).

Dozens of Nigerians and Tanzanians have been arrested at Jomo Kenyatta International Airport with heroin sachets, while Kenyans and South Africans are better known for dealing in mandrax. Earlier this year (2003), a Kenyan was seized with 10,000 tablets of mandrax on his way from the airport. Another Kenyan, specifically a Kenya airways stewardess, was arrested with 27 kilos of heroin from India. In 2000, 28 kilos of heroin was seized and four kilos of cocaine. It is noteworthy that the authorities seize less than a third

of the drugs that come through Kenya. Almost Sh.3 billion worth of heroin was seized in Mombasa and Nairobi between 1994 and 1998, all linked to Kenyan drug barons at the coast. (Daily Nation; 2003).

Hashish is disguised in Kenya as tomato sauce, instant coffee or chocolate before it is moved to South Africa and Europe. Kiambu and Nairobi have been cited as the packing points for hashish from Afghanistan, Egypt and Pakistan. Bhangi, whose large amounts have overwhelmed authorities, is produced in Kenya, especially in the Mt Kenya Region, and comes also from Uganda through Lake Victoria and the Kenya/Tanzania border via Kuria and Namanga. This happens despite stiff penalties such as, the Kenya Narcotics Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act 1994, which provides for life imprisonment for peddlers. Kenya also acceded to the 1988 United Nations Convention Against Drug Trafficking in 1992(Daily Nation; 2003).

Drug abuse in learning institutions in Kenya

More than a fifth (22.7 per cent) of primary school children in Kenya have taken alcohol and more than three fourths (68 per cent) of university students. A large number of learners across all age groups have been exposed to alcohol, tobacco, miraa(Khat), glue sniffing and even hard drugs such as heroin and cocaine (*National Baseline Survey On Drug and Substance abuse Among The Youth In Kenya, October 2002*)

The patterns of drug abuse were found to vary with females more likely to have been exposed to alcohol, tobacco and bhangi more than males. Males had a higher exposure in miraa and inhalants. The study found out that the prevalence of drug use increased from primary to tertiary institutions. Alcohol was the most frequently abused drug followed by Miraa, tobacco and Bhangi. Youths staying with parents are at the lowest risk of abusing drugs followed by those who stayed with relatives. Those who stayed with friends were most at risk followed by those staying with either a sister or a brother. Those staying in towns had a twofold risk of having tasted alcohol, tobacco, miraa, bhangi and inhalants (glue) compared to those in rural areas. This is an indication that exposure of the youth in urban areas in terms of their lifestyles predisposes them to drugs as compared to those in rural areas.

Institution type and drug use

Institution	Alcohol	Tobacco	Bhangi	Miraa	Inhale
Primary	22.7	2.2	1.6	5.3	2.1
Secondary	43.8	6.2	7.1	22	8.7
University	68.5	10.2	7.6	30.9	5.6
National Polytechnic	60.7	11	11	26.1	6.8
Other Institutions	47.1	9.3	8.5	21.8	4.7

Source: National Baseline Survey On Drug and Substance abuse Among The Youth In Kenya, October 2002(Unpublished Report)

Children of more learned parents are at a greater risk of abusing drugs. This is due to modernization where affluent parents expose children to alcohol and drugs. The youth at

learning institutions are the worst hit, with a greater influence coming from peers and some of their own teachers. It has been observed that children, both girls and boys, aged ten years can smoke a whole roll of bhang. Youths from rich families abuse drugs more than those from poor ones. Those from poor families cannot continue education for lack of school fees, and are more likely to consume local brews.

The Concept of a Delinquent Sub-Culture

Some functionalists have proposed that delinquency (such as drug abuse), tends to operate as a sub-culture opposed to the main culture, that is, the sub-culture is non-utilitarian (it is not productive), malicious and negativistic (Cohen,1995). It is a destructive sub-culture. Cohen argues that the delinquent sub-culture is a form of social adaptation to failure to achieve goals through legitimate means (success at school), among adolescents. Cohen argues that it is rampant among working class pupils who cannot attain societal goals using middle-class means. He asserts that differential opportunity leads to illegitimate (Illegal) opportunities as the only alternative for such youths. Therefore, equal opportunity (especially to education) must be provided to combat delinquency.

Factors influencing drug use in schools

a) Modern day rite of passage

Many adolescents get into drug use as a way of signifying to themselves, peers and grown ups that they are mature and can fit in any social group. Adolescents who use alcohol but avoid other drugs tend to have more self-confidence and feel less lonely than their peers who use 'hard' drugs. Students may use alcohol and cigarettes as a way of hiding their true self.

b) Media

Alcohol and cigarette commercials are an integral part of prime time television advertisements. They are advertised with tempting and appealing languages. Given the fact that most youths spent time watching televisions, it is inevitable that attitudes towards drinking and smoking are reinforced. Drug abuse is rampant among the youth because some copy role models such as musicians from the west who are successful, although they are known drug users.

c) Peer Influence

Most youths influence others through social relationship centred on friendship and peer groups rather than families. The need to conform to their groups results in some indulging in actions such as drug taking to please other youths. A group of students who smoke may influence their peers to become partakers of drugs (Plant and Plant 1995). A student may smoke as a means of approval or entry into a certain group.

d) Ignorance

Most youth's are ignorant about the side effects of drugs. Deceptions coupled by their ignorance are powerful weapons used to lure them into drug taking. Uncontrolled indulgence in the so-called fun and pleasure, are turned into pathways to share drugs. Many youths are poorly equipped on the long time effects of various drugs. They venture into drug use mainly for experimental purposes but later they became addicted.

Some parents are ignorant and passive, never imagining that their children could abuse drugs. This assumption may prevent such parents from discussing the danger of the vice with their children.

e) Breakdown of family unit

A break down of the family values and structure because parents have lost control over their children who have freedom to experiment on alcohol and drugs. Youths have to cope with more distressing conditions than their counterparts a few generations ago. Without the benefit of experience, unstable families and stressing conditions many turn to drugs for solace (Chowdhury 1995). These affect poor and affluent families.

f) Easy accessibility to drugs

Drug peddlers target school children for a sure supply market particularly children from rich families. Drug moguls are cleverer by the day. They produce designer drugs whose molecular structures have been altered but whose potency is stronger than ordinary ones. With the alteration of the molecular structure, the merchants can elude legal specifications by claiming they are not trafficking forbidden drugs. The drug trade involves money, police cover ups and syndicates. Some of the law enforcers collaborate with drug peddlers. The menace starts right from the family level. Drug peddlers gain accessibility through school fences and video showrooms. Bhangis are widely used and abused because they are obtained cheaply. In some regions everybody as a norm, including women and children, takes miraa.

According to World Health Organization (1987), exposure plays a crucial role in drug abuse. In a group of ten addicts that were studied, four got into the habit because of exposure to drugs. Students may be exposed to drugs by parents, teachers, friends and members of the society.

Unemployment

Unemployment among the youth is one reason why many are indulging in drug abuse, as they are often idle. Because of lack of jobs, the adults have resorted to selling drugs to schoolchildren to earn a living. They do not care to whom they sell the drugs or alcohol so long as they earn a living.

Laxity in school management

Some school administrators do not seem to care or have administrative skills of curbing drug abuse (Kanya 2000) as a result, some of their students indulge in the vice. Some teachers, parents and members of the community smoke openly in front of students. This behaviour is likely to change the perception of students towards smoking. Some may be tempted to emulate.

❖ Labelling

Drug abuse can occur as a result of labelling. If a student is always referred to as a trouble maker, ignorant, anti social etc by teachers and fellow students, the label is given a major status and it affects the individual's self concept (self image), making the pupil prone to deviant behaviour as a component of their personality.

❖ ***Hostile Environment***

There is too much violence, hostility, fear and uncertainty in the world we are living in today. This has resulted in anxiety and depression among many people. Drug taking is seen as an escape from all these as it helps reduce anxiety and tension thus creating courage and determination (Irura, 1994). Some young people use drugs to cool down certain pressures such as anger, stress, anxiety, fear, boredom and depression. Young people who are vulnerable and insecure may use drugs to boost their self-esteem and also to escape from reality.

Symptoms of Drug Abusers in schools

❖ ***Company***

When the student suddenly gets new friends, is secretive about the friends and spends a great deal of time with these unknown persons yet is very sensitive and almost abusive when asked about the friends.

❖ ***Physical appearance***

When the student appears drowsy and disoriented, with a cold clammy skin. Other symptoms include excess sweating, running nose and watery eyes. The student may have widely dilated pupils and will often wear dark glasses to protect eyes from light and long sleeved shirts to hide injection marks. The student may have traces of white powder around the nostril and at times scars on the inner arm.

❖ ***Character***

The student may frequently complain of headaches and display memory loss, such as lack of homework completion and not remembering what homework was given. Poor concentration in class and daydreaming may be noticed. The student may display acute irritability over minor issues, be unnecessarily argumentative, violent yet at other times display nervousness, outbursts of laughter and loud speech.

Effects of drug abuse in schools

Poor performance

Drug abuse hampers learning as those who take them lack concentration and are always drowsy. They waste more time thinking about how to acquire the drugs than on academics. This is a major waste on human resource.

Indiscipline

Most students on drugs steal from others, in order to have money for drugs. Some are violent and bullies as they feel they always have to be defensive due to their negative actions. Many are very untidy and often breaking school rules such as sneaking out of the school compound. These actions result in being sent home and missing class lessons. Many end up performing poorly in academics. Drug abusers are likely to exhibit violent behaviour towards their fellow students and teachers. Subsequently, such vulnerable groups spend more time thinking about their security than studies (education). This can result in poor performance.

Dropouts

Students on drugs are more likely to drop out of school than those not on drugs due to lack of interest in education and the need to have more money to buy the drugs. This results in teachers and other educational facilities being under utilized in these schools.

HIV AIDS

Youths on drugs are more prone to unprotected sex **Loss of life**

There have been cases of students losing lives due to drug abusers. A case in point is the 1999 Nyeri High School arson in which four prefects were burnt to death by their colleagues, and the 2001 fire tragedy in Kyanguli Secondary School, where 67 students died in a fire started by arsonist. According to the National Campaign against Drug Abuse (NACADA) director, by 2007, drug abuse will have claimed more lives than aids in Kenya, a country where 92% of youth aged between 16 and 26 have experimented with drugs (Daily Nation, 2003).

Cases of students injuring or killing each other in fights after taking drugs are common. Young drug abusers are usually more impulsive, more delinquent, more depressed, more suicidal, less successful in school and less self-confident.

Smoking is responsible for nearly five million deaths in the world (Amayo and wangai, 1994;Irura, 2000). Lung cancer is 20-25 times more in smokers than in non-smokers.

Summary



This lesson analyses drug abuse in schools. A drug is defined as any chemical substance that, when taken into the body, can affect one or more of the body's functions. Drugs can be divided into three simple types; positive, negative and hard drugs. Positive drugs are those accepted by society and are used to cure ailments. Negative drugs are drugs taken for pleasure or for making someone feel 'high'. . Hard drugs are chemically made to stimulate the user and one becomes 'hooked' to the habit and soon begins to show dependence on the drugs. Drug abuse refers to the use of drugs for purposes other than therapeutic ones. Various types of drugs and their effects are discussed.

The drug situation in Kenya is also analysed with the indication that it is getting out of

Summary

control as Kenya risks being overpowered by an international network of drug peddlers and drastic measures need to be taken to curb the problem. Drug abuse in learning institutions in Kenya is alarming with more than a fifth (22.7 per cent) of primary school children in Kenya having taken alcohol and more than three fourths (68 per cent) of university students. A large number of learners across all age groups have been exposed to alcohol, tobacco, miraa(Khat), glue sniffing and even hard drugs such as heroin and cocaine.

Factors influencing drug use in schools in Kenya include among others; Youths wanting to signify that they are mature, media influence, peer influence, ignorance, breakdown of family unit, the easy accessibility to drugs, unemployment, hostile environment, laxity in school management and labelling where a student who is always referred to as a trouble maker, ignorant, anti social etc by teachers and fellow students will use drugs as escapism.

There are various symptoms that can indicate drug abusers in schools among them are the company students' keep, physical appearance of students and character of students.

The effects of drug abuse in schools in Kenya include poor performance, indiscipline, school dropouts, HIV AIDS and loss of life.

Conclusion

Whatever reasons may be cited to rationalize drug abuse, it does not have any significant benefit to human life. Besides getting 'hooked' to the habit, one's performance and discipline are affected. Drug abuse also calls for expensive and difficult rehabilitation procedures, shortens career prospects and creates health problems. Therefore, stopping the habit has its long-term benefits besides reducing diseases. School administrators, teachers, parents and the entire society should play their rightful roles in sensitising the youth on the dangers of drug abuse.

Recommendations

a) Job Creation

Unemployment is one of the major contributors to idleness, drug peddling and abuse among the youth. The society and by extension the government should erase that state of hopelessness. This could be attained through job creation. **b) Censorship of Media**

The government should ensure that programmes in print and mass media do not influence youth negatively on drug use. Police should take action on video showrooms where drugs are sold.

c) Policies

The government should formulate policies for school heads and teachers on how to deal with drug abuse in schools. Taxes on tobacco and its products should be increased to make them more unaffordable and strict penalties should be given to people selling drugs to youths. Drug offences should not be bail able. Bars, pool centres and video shows should be removed from residential areas. Designated places for smoking should be set aside and it should be a crime punished by law if found violating the law. Businessmen should be prohibited from selling cigarettes to schoolchildren

d) Sensitisation

Seminars and workshops should be held for teachers, students and parents to sensitise them on drug abuse. Efforts should be made to minimise stress related activities. School administrators should be in serviced on skills of detecting the vice among students. Parents who are smokers should be sensitised to avoid smoking in the presence of their children. Teachers should be equipped with the skills and knowledge of identifying drug abusers and counselling them

e) Accountability

Parents should take their responsibility in childrearing seriously and ensure that their children account for the money given. They should not abdicate their parental roles to other agents of socialization such as peer groups, teachers and house helps.

f) Development of Youth Talents

Public land should be repossessed and used to develop youth talents such as sports, drama and arts. Social halls should be built where they can hold informative seminars on ways to avoid drugs.

g) Conducive School environment

Drug abuse can be countered through making the school experience pleasurable and rewarding. Counselling problem students rather than castigating them gives positive results. Teachers can help the problem pupils understand their own problems so that solutions can be arrived at. Good classroom and school management will reduce undesirable behaviour in learners. Cooperation between schools, parents and the community will help to counter drug abuse in society. Guidance and counselling units should be strengthened in schools.

Government Involvement

The government should introduce the study of drugs as a compulsory course in schools and colleges. This would make students more aware of the dangers associated with the vice. The government should set up national consensus groups composed of members of the police force, teachers, the clergy, pharmacists and consumer organizations to sensitise people on the dangers of the vice. The body should also have the power to investigate cases of people or businessmen who sell drugs to the underage or students (W.H.O1987).

Rehabilitation

Students addicted to drugs should be rehabilitated. These centres should be established throughout the country.

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LESSON 11

THE SCHOOL TEACHER AND TEACHING

Introduction

The status of a profession in any society contributes to the self-esteem and the manner in which those within that profession perform various roles in society. Teaching is a career that has undergone various transformations. It was once a respected job in society, referred to as a noble profession but a lot has changed and teaching as a career has raised various debates particularly on whether it is a profession or not. In this lesson, the school teacher and teaching profession are analysed under the following major categories: teaching as a profession, characteristics of a profession, social image of a school teacher, roles of a school teacher, and issues facing school teachers. Other issues pertinent to teaching are also considered.

Objectives

By the end of the lesson, learners should be able to:

- ❖ Define teaching
- ❖ State characteristics of a profession and discuss whether teaching is a profession.
- ❖ List down five barriers to professional status in teaching
- ❖ Discuss the changing role of teachers in present day society

Teaching as a Profession

Definition and concept of Teacher and Teaching

The term teacher and teaching have been used to refer to specialized activities in our societies. Teaching is referred to as “**the process of providing information, knowledge or skills to others**”. Teachers then strictly refer to the “**people who are involved in the process of providing information, knowledge or skills to other people**”. They derive their title from the act of teaching. Hough and Duncan (1970) define teaching as ‘**a unique professional, rational and humane activity in which one creatively uses ones knowledge to promote the learning and welfare of others**’. Based on these definitions it can be deduced that teachers give instructions to learners and are also charged with the responsibility of facilitating the acquisition of knowledge, skills and instilling discipline. In a broader sense, teaching can be viewed as the work or service given to learners by the teachers. Professional teachers are trained people in the art of teaching. They are paid a salary or wage for services they render to their customers. Terms of employment for these professional teachers vary from place to place. The teacher’s service commission employs the majority of professional teachers in Kenya.

In Kenya, we have different categories of teachers in schools. These include teachers in public, private or non-governmental schools, teachers in pre primary, primary, secondary, colleges and universities. Teachers can also be categorized as trained or untrained. Teachers fall under three categories of age: Old, middle aged and young teachers. Their behaviours and mannerisms would also be dictated by their age. Normally, old teachers tend to portray old-fashioned manners and rigidity while younger teachers on the other hand tend to be more liberal. This at times causes conflicts in the profession.

Historical development of teaching profession

Traditionally, teaching enjoyed relatively high status and prestige. Ancestors used informal teaching to pass over skills and knowledge that was essential to society. Greek sophists are believed to have been the earliest known teachers. They consisted of a group of well-learned teachers who moved from place to place teaching. They usually charged a fee for the services rendered. Sophists were prominent in the art of public speaking or rhetoric. They were able to put doubts or confusion into the minds of the youth. Based on this, the youths were able to develop a high degree of thinking and reasoning. As a result, they could challenge dogma, and any form of opinion or belief that did not seem to be knowledgeable. The Greeks began to discourage charging fees for teaching during the time of Socrates, they believed that fee payment would degrade or lower the value of education. Socrates moved from one market to another teaching without charging fees for his services. The term 'teachers' became more pronounced at the time the Romans conquered Greece and introduced a kind of hierarchy. The Romans introduced two groups of professional teachers. The first was, the '**Literator**' a teacher in the primary school and '**Ludi 'Magista' or 'Rhetor**' teachers who taught in the Roman Grammar schools. This period marks the beginning of honouring the teaching profession, when people could see and appreciate the role of teachers in society. They began to advocate for teachers salary based on their services. Plato was among the earliest advocates for salaries for teachers. He felt that teachers had a big role in society, which gave them the honour they deserved. During the middle age schools began to be diversified, and as a result the system of preservice training was introduced and became compulsory for anybody aspiring to become a teacher.

The teaching profession in Kenya has its roots in early missionary efforts to establish and spread schools for the education of the masses. Missionaries were particular on the people they trained as teachers. They had to be people of good moral conduct who could be emulated by members of the society. They were people who displayed a lot of sincerity and love for children. Their pay was minimal and at times they relied on tokens given by members of the community, however society valued them as they were regarded as wise, and people who opened doors to education.

Early teacher training colleges or centres were adjuncts to secondary and intermediate schools (Bogonko, 1992). These have, over the years, developed into fully independent colleges at various levels of specialization under the administrative management of the Ministry of Education, Science and Technology.

In the decade preceding independence in Kenya, the teaching profession was given better status and recognition by the formation and existence of two semi- autonomous bodies whose responsibility was to see to the training needs and professional growth of the teaching profession. These bodies were Eastern and Western Teacher Training Organization, referred to as E.T.T.O and W.T.T.O. These bodies worked under the auspices of the Ministry of Education. Through these bodies, teacher training and the teaching profession took a firm root in the country (Bogonko, 1992).

In Kenya, teaching profession has steadily grown both in status and quality over the years. By June 1960, there were 20,360 teachers in schools in Kenya, with 4,089 students in training colleges. In January 1991, there were over 300,000 teachers in schools. Teacher Training Colleges had a population of more than 15,000 students. In 1992, there were over

8000 students training for the teaching profession at university level (Shiundu and Omulando 1992).

The teaching profession has also undergone metamorphosis in Kenya. Teaching as a profession was generally highly regarded before independence as teachers were among the most highly educated people in society. With independence and the growth and opening up of opportunities in other professions for indigenous people, teachers were no longer alone in this advantaged position. Consequently, the profession lost most of its original lustre. Teaching has become a big industry in Kenya, employing many people throughout the country. However, with the large numbers of the educated joining the teaching profession, poor pay and lack of motivation, the teaching profession does not enjoy high status in society as it did before. Arguments have been raised that teaching is not a profession. It is therefore important to analyse what professionalism entails and whether teaching falls under this category.

Characteristics of a profession

The term 'profession' is not a precise descriptive concept but more an evaluative concept. The term profession is a symbol for a desired conception of one's work and hence, oneself (Hoyle 1969). Since the most prestigious occupations (e.g. medicine, law, architecture, dentistry) are termed professions, the term is symbolic of the status to which less prestigious occupations aspire. Profession is defined by Jarry and Jarry (1991) as '**any middle class occupational group, characterized by claims of a high level of technical and intellectual expertise, autonomy in recruitment and discipline, and a commitment to public service**'. Lieberman (1956) states criteria characteristics of a profession. These are: -

a) Essential social service

A profession performs an essential social service that is central to the well being of society. The practitioner is also concerned with the well being of the clients. Teaching meets this criterion. Teaching throughout the ages has contributed so much to the improved welfare of humanity and its ultimate survival. In schools, individual children are socialized for occupational roles in society. Teachers have helped influence the learners with the values held and cherished in society. Teachers have also contributed in national development by pointing out obstacles prevalent in society, such as drug abuse in learning institutions, which make change in positive direction difficult, so that the youth can understand how these obstacles originate as well as how they can be dealt with.

Schools are agents of social growth, development and reform (Shiundu and Omulando 1992). Based on this concept, society expects teachers through teaching and being in contact with the youth, to help preserve and transmit cultural heritage. This is by promoting and improving on those aspects of culture that form the cornerstone of our society. In Kenya, the society wants teachers to assist the youths to know and adhere to principles such as unity, integrity, honesty, to fight corruption, discipline and value hard work. Teachers have been at the forefront in emphasizing these values in our school system.

Society expects teachers to help transform culture. They are regarded as vital instruments in the reconstruction, changing and improvement of culture. Teachers have played a major role in convincing learners to avoid retrogressive practices such as female circumcision, early marriages, cattle rustling and moranism. In Kenya some teachers have

been involved in the rescued f girls from early marriages at the risk of their own lives. Head teachers have reported parents who got their daughters from school to marry them off to the police at times risking being shunned by the whole community. Teachers have also contributed to student's individual development by helping them realize their potential. They have also influenced the welfare and academic progress of their students, as examination success is dependent among others on the teacher's skills in helping the learners.

b) Training

A profession requires a lengthy period of academic and practical training. In medicine, in order for one to qualify as a doctor, training takes between five and seven years, plus one year of internship. Only such qualified people can perform operations on patients. There is an impassable gulf between an amateur and the professional. In addition to this, professional examination and practising licence are issued to members (Bogonko, 1992).

On the other hand, Teacher training is not fixed but varies from six months for pre primary teachers in private colleges to four years. Some teacher training institutions have one teaching practice session while others have two. In addition to these, during teaching practice, some institutions visit their trainees and assist them many times while some visit them once or in serious cases not at all. This brings confusion on how to judge a really trained teacher and the assumption that teaching skills are common sense knowledge about controlling children, which almost any literate person can master and practice.

Most professionals such as medicine and Law lay down the minimum requirements for anyone considering pursuing that profession and candidates wanting to join them have to pass professional achievement and aptitude test administered by the professional bodies concerned. But teaching defies this arrangement and its members do not have the degree of control over the standards of entry to it that members of other professions exercise in their calling. The TSC (The employer) governs the entry requirements, the terms of service as well as the code of conduct for the teaching profession (Bogonko 1992).

At times the gap between a trained and untrained teacher is hardly noticeable and this raises questions of professionalism. Some learning institutions in Kenya would rather have diploma teachers from institutions such as Kenya Science and Kenya Technical Training College rather than university trained teachers. They insist these teachers are better trained and more thorough in their subjects. Teacher Training Colleges, particularly primary teacher colleges admit students with low academic grades (D+), leading to the view that teaching cannot qualify as a profession but as a craft in which any untrained person can engage when he or she has only a little better knowledge than the average pupil.

c) Specialization

A profession is founded upon a systematic body of knowledge and is not merely concerned with exercise of some skills but a skill, which has an intellectual foundation. Members must be specialists in their areas of specialization. For example, qualified doctors have knowledge that anyone else, not trained in the profession does not have access to. For

this reason, someone cannot doctor patients simply because one has mastered the subject matter of Biology or Chemistry. This is not true of teaching.

Except for university lecturers, who have a corpus of knowledge in their respective disciplines, primary and secondary school teachers might not be in possession of much knowledge that is not within the grasps of the educated lay public. If this is so, then only in terms of some esoteric skills in teaching methodology could teachers claim special ability.

d) Freedom to practice

A profession has a high degree of autonomy. This includes: -

- ❖ The autonomy of the individual practitioner to make decisions in the interest of the clients
- ❖ Autonomy of the profession as a whole to make decisions about modes of operation. The profession claims autonomy in determining the conditions of practice and the right to determine standards of membership. Members must practice their profession freely but in accordance with the laws of the land.
- ❖ To open office without hindrance provided one respects the laws of the land.

Although individual teachers have autonomy over students work in the classroom, this is limited in that the syllabus has to be covered and the head of department and the head teacher monitors the work. In addition to this, national examinations play a role in determining which areas in the syllabus should have great emphasis. At times the teacher has been unable to make decisions in the interest of the learners, the clients.

In Kenya, there has been a lot of complaint by teachers over set books such as “KIU’ and Kitumbua Kimeingia Mchanga” books teachers point out, do not portray any moral values in society. The churches in Kenya have also been against these set books but despite the complaints, students still use them as set books. In private schools, the freedom of the teacher is further curtailed. There are particular high cost schools where the administrator literally supervises what is taught and how it should be taught; divergence from their expectation can result in dismissal. Teachers therefore become passive players in their own fields while medical doctors on the other hand can make independent decisions on the drugs to administer and the treatment to give.

e) Board of Operation

A profession should have a board of operation. This is an overseer that supervises and disciplines errant members. The medical Practitioners Board and the Law Society of Kenya advice and discipline doctors and lawyers respectively. This is not the case with teachers. The main board of operation, the Teachers’ Service Commission, mainly deals with the recruitment, salaries, transfer and discipline of teachers, hardly on matters concerning the improvement of teaching as a career. Most of the authority of the teachers service commission lies with the government.

On the other hand, the Kenya National Union of Teachers (KNUT), which should fight to uplift professionalism in teaching, lacks the capability of doing so mainly because it is more of a trade union than an organization controlling quality of teaching. The majority of the top officials in KNUT have not been previously in the teaching profession and therefore are limited as far as teaching is concerned. KNUT therefore, though a teachers unions, cannot contribute sufficiently in giving teachers the professional status they deserve and at

times creates too much political interference in the profession. Teachers claims to be professional in Kenya, is therefore weakened by the authority structure, subject to bureaucratic rules and regulations. Other authorities rather than themselves mainly decide teachers work conditions.

f) Code of Conduct

Professionalism requires that practice must be guided by a code of ethics or rules of conduct. High ethical standards become part of the professional personality. Professionals have a service ethos, which means that the interests of the clients come first. The members themselves must set the standards.

In teaching profession the Teachers Code of Conduct is prepared elsewhere by the employer or Teachers Service Commission and the teachers have to adhere to it. However, while in other professions, a breach of the code can result in immediate expulsion, there have been cases in the teaching profession where breakage of the code has resulted in transfers and at worst some of the head teachers associated with embezzlement of school funds or pregnancy cases have been promoted to higher posts. Some teachers associated with absenteeism and drunkard ness have simply been transferred to adjacent schools.

g) Generates in service Growth

Professions generate in service growth by exposing members to new findings within their fields, further training and research. Teaching satisfies this criterion in that there have been in service and refresher courses for teachers of various categories. The Ministry of Education, Science and Technology has been at the forefront in sponsoring some of the training, to confer on some teachers a qualified status and help to update the knowledge of the teachers with a view of raising quality in teaching. There has been an annual head teachers meeting particularly secondary school heads to improve on quality of education in their schools.

Teachers have participated in school educational tours, where besides visiting top performing schools in the country such as Starehe boys Centre and Precious Blood- Riruta, to find out from fellow teachers their teaching strategies, they have also visited schools in Uganda and Tanzania. However, teachers have raised complaints that some efforts towards teacher's professional growth are sporadic and not meant to raise the professional status of teachers. A case in point was a trip by head teachers outside the country, which though funded by various schools through some fee collected from parents, ended up being more of a shopping spree than an educational trip.

h) Unity

In a profession, members are united and support one another in case of criticism e.g. lawyers practice together and support one another. Teachers lack cohesion and are fragmented by qualification levels and specialization. Post primary teachers tend to keep a status distinction between them and the more poorly qualified and lowly paid primary school teachers. Teachers have therefore, failed to make teaching a career which is as solid and recognized as law or medicine. Each of these professions is made up of a closely-knit elite with very distinctive levels of academic achievement, while teaching is composed of many people with different levels of educational achievement. In addition, teachers are scattered across the length and breadth of the nation thus rendering their organization difficult. Teachers lack a self-governing framework to which they can claim to belong. All these differences undermine unity in the entire teaching profession.

i) Interest of Client

Professionals have the interest of their clients at heart. Doctors, lawyers and a few teachers fight to the bitter end to safe guard these interests.

j) Unique Language

Professionals have a unique language, e.g. lawyers, doctors

k) Prestige

Profession has to be accompanied by prestige. Not all teachers would want to be referred to by their profession.

l) Dynamic

A profession should be dynamic, getting new ideas and shedding off old ones. A majority of teachers do not update their knowledge and notes. Yellow notes show this.

j) Practice freely

Members of a profession normally allow free exchange of ideas. They also practice while observed by others e.g. lawyers and doctor do team work while performing their duties. Teachers see it as interference. A head teacher who is supposed to supervise teachers is not allowed to go near classes.

Factors hindering acquisition of Professional status in Teaching

a) Social Economic background of Entrants

The standing and respect accorded to a profession is to some extent affected by the social class background of its recruits. The higher the social strata from which recruits generally come, the higher the status of the profession and the higher the status of a profession, the more it will attract recruits from the higher social strata. The more economic empowered the members in a profession, the stronger they are in fighting for better terms to uphold the socio economic status of members within their profession and restricting entry to the profession.

Originally, teaching was a career pursued by the well to do in society, expatriates and a few intelligent member of the working class. It was a means of upward social mobility. However, the demand for education, coupled by the increase in teacher training colleges, universities, and teacher courses for mature students, such as open learning, distance learning and parallel programmes, opened up more chances for training in teaching and resulted in more recruits from poor family backgrounds joining the profession. The low fee charged in teacher training as compared to medicine or law has resulted in many trainees from the low socio economic status families joining the profession thus contributing to the lower status of the profession and the inability of its members to bargain for better terms.

b) Large Number Of Entrants

One major factor militating against professionalism in teaching is the large number of entrants in the field. With free primary education, Pre service courses and parallel programmes, which result in many people pursuing education even in remote areas, the recruitment for teachers even the untrained teacher has been high. Besides, interfering with the quality of the profession, large recruitment of teachers affects their economic status (Wages), which puts them at the lowest rank of the wage ladder and affects their upward social mobility. With a large number of teachers trained and unemployment, any threat to down tools by those employed does not have a major impact since replacements are

available. The government may be constrained to improve their pay because of financial implications.

Some of the teachers join the profession as the last resort. Such people may not be committed to the profession. They are tempted to keep their eyes open in case there are other openings hence high turn over.

c) Gender Imbalance

There is a marked imbalance between sexes in the teaching profession; with females being the majority at the lower levels particularly primary and secondary levels and males being the majority at tertiary level. Teaching therefore has a relatively high status in the occupations followed by women but a relatively low status among occupations followed by men. The gender imbalance in teaching, with the majority of teachers being women, has resulted in diminishing the general status of the profession, compared with other occupations, which are usually dominated by males. This has contributed to a public image of teaching as a lowly job for people with low salaries (Dove, 1986). Teaching at primary level is considered more suitable for women since it involves young children thus childcare skills are required. Many members in society view an occupation that involves childcare as a low prestige career.

d) Age Factor

In many traditional African societies respect is closely linked to maturity by age. Whereas people have respect for the school as an institution, this respect is not easily transferred to the teacher, more so if the teacher is youthful. Age is still a strong status factor in society and the literacy or training of a young teacher may not persuade the elders of a community in which a young teacher works, that the teacher has a higher status. The issue is made more complicated if the young teachers lack moral uprightness. This is because society entrusts the upbringing of the young to the teachers. Schoolteachers who conduct immoral affairs with their pupils such as befriending or impregnating them have seriously harmed the image of the teaching profession in society. The fact that the teacher has an almost constant integration with the public in the performance of duties renders the teacher vulnerable.

Due to recent expansions and teacher shortages, particularly with the introduction of free primary education, many teachers are young and teach levels and subjects for which they are not trained. This affects professionalism

Wastage in the teaching profession is high among younger and more recently trained and recruited teachers. It is estimated that the current rate of yearly turn over in the teaching profession in Kenya is approximately 30%(Shiundu and Omulando, 1992). This is expensive as the teaching profession ends up losing these teachers' ability and potential. It also helps create the concept that those who stay in the profession are not the brightest. This affects staff morale and professional cooperation.

e) Lack of Commitment to Teaching Profession

Membership to professions such as law, medicine and architecture implies a life long commitment to the profession. A doctor whether wage employed or self employed will

practice medicine. However, commitment to the task of teaching is not as apparent. For example:

- ❖ A teacher may practice teaching and also run a food kiosk, two careers unrelated to each other. One may also resign from teaching to enter into preaching.
- ❖ Many join the teaching profession as 'second choice' in many cases after failing to enter their preferred professions. Some join teaching as a safer landing ground particular during the era of unemployment.
- ❖ Many have joined teaching because they were relatively weak academically and were scared of pursuing what they perceived as more competitive and challenging careers. Some have joined teaching because they feel it is less challenging as one can teach same things year in year out and vices such as absenteeism, poor time keeping, badly prepared lessons and untidiness can be tolerated.
- ❖ Members from other professions can join teaching, unlike other professions that are specific in their recruitment.
- ❖ Upward mobility in teaching (Deputy Head/head Teacher, District Education Officer) often takes the individual practitioner out of the classroom or out of the school.

In many countries, teaching has become a dumping ground for those who cannot make it elsewhere, for those who use it as a stepping-stone to better occupations and for those who feel that as teachers, they can afford time to do other things. Such people are not committed to teaching as a career (Shiundu and Omulando, 1992).

f) Salary

The salary attached to a profession is partly a measure of the esteem in which the profession is held in society, a reflection of the relative scarcity of the skills required in the practice of the profession and partly an indication of the powers which the organization/profession can exercise in its own interests.

Teachers do not in general receive salaries comparable to those received in professions such as medicine, law and architecture. The salary given also depends on the employing person or organization. There is also some vagueness in society concerning the esteem of teachers and the nature of the skills and knowledge required for the task of teaching. Although the teachers union have fought a long and relatively successful campaign for improvement in the pay conditions of teachers, they have not apparently been able to wield the same degree of power as organized professionals such as doctors.

One factor which perhaps prevents a more rapid increase in the salaries of teachers is that whereas the social functions of doctors, judges and lawyers are immediate and clear, since they are constantly dealing with what are crucial issues for their individual clients, the functions and responsibilities of the teacher are more diffuse and the effects are felt over a longer time scale. This makes teaching to be regarded as part of a normal process, which is experimental for everyone (Wilson, 1962).

Teachers are among the lowest paid 'professional' in the world thus they lack power to be vocal and voice their grievances. Economic hardships make them an easy prey for intimidation. They are downtrodden and unappreciated (Majasan, 1995). It has proved difficult to upgrade them en masse due to sheer numbers and the discriminatory

qualifications involved. Discriminatory qualifications separate them into four categories that cannot be equated to one another to give them a common front, the Pre School and nursery, the primary or elementary, the secondary school and the tertiary. Neither the educational background nor the professional training required is of the same standard in the four categories hence creating disparity in remuneration, which adds to the problem of professionalism.

In Kenya, low salaries have contributed in some teachers engaging in activities such as running small businesses, tuition, preaching and farming. Such activities obviously interfere with their educational activities and duties and create challenges of reconciling the socio-economic and professional demands.

g) Nature of the final Award

The final academic award obtained by the majority of members of a profession is regarded as a general indication of its intellectual standards. Only a minority of teachers have university degrees, with a great percentage having certificates and diplomas. This has resulted in lower status of the profession. Efforts are being made to open up degree programmes. **h)**

Professional Culture

Members of a profession interact in training, employment, and professional associations. Through these interactions a profession generates a distinct culture embracing its fundamental values, the norms that govern the behaviour of members, its symbols (Greenwood 1962). This culture creates professional solidarity, self-esteem, and self-consciousness. Professional culture helps create unity and solidarity among members.

In teaching profession, the 'Professional culture' is not very distinct. The degree of interaction between teachers at primary, secondary and tertiary levels, or those in Public and private schools is almost non-existent. They also hold divergent views on teaching and at times hostility between teachers in different kind of schools has been noted, and between those who teach and those who lecture.

While there is demand to keep the professional culture in fields such as medicine, law, aviation, and there is often exerted pressure on members of the professions to keep up to date with current issues that affect their profession, through reading, research, seminars, in order to survive in the market, there is often less pressure on teachers to improve teaching quality and many have taught using the same text book, notes and applying similar teaching strategies year in year out.

Mobility in the profession

In most societies, achievement is assessed by one's upward occupational mobility and increase in salary rather than the skills performed. In medicine and law upward mobility can be deduced through increase in consultancy and the number of clients but the practitioner stays in the same profession. Upward mobility in the teaching profession often requires the teacher to leave the classroom, for example when one comes a head teacher. This career pattern creates a division within the education profession between those teachers who teach and those who have moved higher in rank such as administrators. The fact that a teacher has to move out of the classroom in career advancement serves to reduce teachers' commitment to classroom teaching.

The concept of skilful, committed teachers having to leave the classroom and at times education due to promotion helps reinforce the view that teaching is simply a stepping stone

to ‘greener pastures and those who remain in teaching are the less innovative. Promotion is at times riddled with corruption as people buy positions hence, the new policy of re-advertising for head ship in secondary schools in Kenya as reinforced by the Assistant Minister of Education Dr. Kilemi.

i) Religious Influence

While most professions are independent from religious influence, the religious roots of education have established the idea that teaching is a vocation for which relatively low material rewards can be expected. Although modern teachers may be fighting for higher pay, there has remained a public expectation that teachers should be self-sacrificing.

Islamic and Christian influences have affected the role of the teacher in schools. There is a link between koranic teaching and dependence on charity, thus teachers in early Islamic tradition were much respected (high social status) because they were men of knowledge who cared enough about the Koran. Their duty was to teach others but at the same time they were expected to be poor (low class position). According to Islam tradition, local teachers were not supposed to receive fixed salaries or set fees, but to depend on gifts and charity from students and relatives.

Christian influences on the teaching role were similar to Islamic influences in that teaching attracted relatively high status and low economic standing. European missionaries therefore defined the teachers’ role as one of self-sacrifice, low pay and subservience to paternalistic moral control. A teacher suitable for the post was not assessed just on ability but also on personal habits and the ability to sacrifice.

Historically, Christians and Muslims had high regards for teachers and placed teaching as per with preaching but they did not see the need for paying teachers. This influence has permeated in present day society where teaching is at times viewed as a vocational call. This may have an influence on the remuneration of teachers.

Is teaching a Profession?

Efficient teaching throughout the ages has contributed so much to the improved welfare of humanity and its ultimate survival. Despite the role played by teachers in societies, arguments have been raised on whether teaching is or is not a profession. Some people have regarded teaching with contempt, stating that it is a refuge for mediocre people who are industrious but unimaginative, uncreative, people with average drive for power, average ambition, hence Bernard Shaw’s frequently quoted maxim that “**He who can, does; he who cannot teaches**’ (Majason, 1995). This view has also contributed to teaching being regarded as a career for the weaker sex, women.

Some of the factors that contribute to teaching not being regarded as a profession include the following:

- a) Teaching lacks mystique, that is the hidden meaning that causes feeling of wonder and reverence associated with medicine, law and other professions.
- b) Schooling is now commonplace and teachers are regarded as ordinary workers with common skills.
- c) A teacher’s knowledge particularly at primary level is not a special kind over which they have monopoly, as do doctors and lawyers but is composed of many different

- aspects of knowledge such as maths, History and chemistry. These subjects are often learned and relayed by teachers at a simple level only.
- d) Teachers lack a professional body that can assist in the development of skills. Teaching skills are therefore regarded as commonsense knowledge about controlling children, which anyone can do.
 - e) A professional is regarded as a highly responsible person whose decision is crucial to the well being of the client. Teachers are often not seen as people who make crucial decisions concerning the learners or education. Decisions are usually made at the ministerial level.
 - f) Professionals are trained in their areas of specialization. Kenya has a number of untrained teachers.
 - g) Training colleges particularly primary teacher training colleges have a history of admitting students with lower academic qualifications than university entrants.
 - h) Teachers are subject to bureaucratic rules and the authorities rather than themselves mainly decide regulations and their work conditions.

However, teaching can be considered a profession due to the following:

- a) Professionalism demands a continuous in service growth. There has been arrangements and sponsorship of in-service and refresher courses. There are also occasional meetings of heads of schools and educational tours.
- b) A profession performs an essential social service that is central to the well being of society. The practitioner is also concerned with the well being of the clients. Teaching meets this criterion. Teaching throughout the ages has contributed so much to the improved welfare of humanity and its ultimate survival.

The Social approach to professionalism

The issue of professionalism or lack of professionalism in careers legitimises selection in a capitalist stratified order. Those careers that are regarded by the majority as professions such as medicine, law architecture, require higher points for entrance. Most of those who acquire the required entry points are from either high cost or good public schools with better facilities and trained teachers. These courses are very expensive and the majority of those able to pay for them are from the high socio economic status families, therefore professionalism seems to be determined by the social structure of society and this reinforces social inequality. Inequality in professional status can only be resolved by the elimination of inequality in the general society as a whole.

According to the Socialist Egalitarians, capitalist systems, by their very structure cannot create equality as they survive on unequal distribution of resources. Therefore, in order to create equality in various fields and give all fields equal status to become professions, there must be a drive to create equality in society through direct intervention in the distribution of resources, reduce income gaps, provide adequate housing, health and other social services on equal basis to all fields. There is need for direct political intervention in the whole social structure.

When the gap between the high paying and low paying professionals is eliminated, then a common culture rather than one that serves the elite in society will emerge and true

professionalism can image. A simultaneous process of eliminating inequality in society 's structure is essential for professionalism to thrive.

Different careers have different status, which determine different rewards and prestige from society. Those in careers regarded as professions such as medicine, law or architecture, have power and authority. They can influence and control people, decisions or events. They can use coercion in whatever form to have their wishes fulfilled. Inequality in professionalism can be traced through remuneration and qualifications that creates differences in accessibility and opportunities between people in different professionals.

Social Image of a School Teacher

In order to achieve professional status within the teaching fraternity, a stable and dedicated team of qualified teachers has to be raised. The expected qualities include: **a) Initiative** Teachers should know what to do in varying circumstances without endangering the lives of those around them particularly the learners. Teachers should ensure those seeking their guidance, especially their clients, the learners do not loose vital opportunities in academic development, due to the teachers indecision or inability to react promptly and appropriately to emergencies. Teachers should have a through understanding of their learners in order to assess and analyse situation and take the necessary measures.

b) Patience

Teacher should not be too hasty in their reactions; they should listen to learners without passing judgement. Learners need to be comfortable and confident in order to learn effectively. Teachers should be patient enough in order to create optimum conditions for effective learning. Learners with divergent views should not be shunned or ridiculed particularly if the views do not agree with the teacher's own perception. Patience should also be practiced particularly when dealing with learners from low social status who may not complete assignments given or come with required textbooks or those students on drugs.

However, patience at times lacks among some teachers. Cases of assault perpetrated by teachers against pupils, teachers against teachers particularly male against female or head teachers against pupils have been reported in schools. Unfortunately, some assaults have resulted in some pupils becoming deaf, blind, suffering broken limbs or death. A professional teacher should avoid physical aggression.

c) Sympathy

Professional teachers are sympathetic to the plight encountered by their clients. Learners may be struggling with situation beyond their control such as drug abuse or broken homes. They need attention and guidance. Teachers should be able to encourage and console these learners while at the same time emphasizing the importance of the learner performing well academically. Cases such as lateness, absenteeism, inherent cruelty in some children, parental ignorance and suppression of children by parents need to be treated by the teacher with a lot of caution and sympathy.

However, compassion is one attribute most lacking in schoolteachers today. This is because the materialistic attitude, where nothing goes for nothing has permeated societies and since teachers are part and parcel of society, they too have been influenced. The interest of learners should be a basic qualification in teaching.

d) Respect

This is an important personality trait, not only in teaching but also as a model for pupils in society. In school and within the classroom environment, every learner deserves respect. A teacher's respect for learners goes along way in establishing confidence and rapport among learners and teachers. This is necessary for effective learning.

Respect for teachers or their students is at times lacking in our learning institutions. Rape cases of female students and female teachers by some teachers have been reported in these institutions. There are also cases of male teachers sodomizing male pupils. The professional teacher values self-respect and respect for others and upholds the rights of pupils and colleagues. He does not need to demonstrate assumed superiority by physically and sexually subduing others (Gwarinda, 1993)

e) Flexibility

Teachers should be flexible. They must be able to listen to learners with an open mind and modify their stand if necessary without sacrificing principles. Teachers should analyse divergent opinions given by learners in order to bring out what is helpful to learners without changing rules or condemning learners. Rigidity by teachers and administrators is one of the major causes of school riots that have at times been so fatal and led to loss of students' lives. Flexibility does not mean being unprincipled but being liberal and accommodating **f)**

Firmness

Teachers must be highly principled, disciplined and firm. Firmness should go side by side with flexibility. The teacher must be firm and fair to all learners. Firmness should not imply rejection of any other ideas except the teachers.

g) Honesty

Teachers must be transparent, honest and seek after truth at all times. They should reinforce same attributes in learners. Cases of lack of transparency have been reported in schools particularly embezzlement of school funds by the head teachers. Some teachers have been caught in vices such as stealing and giving learners national examination papers. Some teachers absent themselves from classrooms to run their own businesses yet they collect pay for teaching. Cases have been reported where teachers do not teach well during class hours so that parents can pay for holiday tuition or evening classes for their children with the same teacher. These practices diminish professionalism in teaching.

Lack of honesty is also demonstrated when teachers engage pupils in child labour such as performing various private chores at the teachers' houses for nothing when logically, they should be in the classroom. Some teachers use drugs against the law and use pupils as sources (peddlers) of the drugs. Teachers regarding learners as cheap source of labour is exploitation and dishonesty. Professional teachers do not squander school resources nor misuse the clients but utilize them effectively for the benefit of the school.

f) Foresight

Good teaching involves encouraging learners to have a vision, be able to project themselves into the future and to see that through education and hard work, they can reach great heights. Learners should be encouraged to see themselves as being in charge of some great establishment and succeeding in life. Foresighted teachers interpret trends of events and make useful forecasts in the development of schools and subject areas. They advise their learners on which careers to pursue and the qualification needed.

However, the situation is not always so in most schools. Some learners dreams and careers have been shattered due to bad advice by teachers particularly in subject selection, other learners particularly girls have been ridiculed and discouraged from pursuing subjects that are regarded as being in the male domain such as science based subjects. School need teachers who can resolve problems by foresight as well as hindsight, teachers who can bring realism in response to existing practices and interpret accurately influences of society on education.

g) Intellectual curiosity

Intellectual curious teachers read more about their own subjects and other interests. They increase the span of their teaching, thus enriching their subject areas. Curiosity and keenness by teachers promotes efficiency and success. Teachers should be sensitive and sharp, not allowing things to happen around them without noting. Intellectual curiosity puts teachers squarely in charge of their classrooms and gives them assurance of class control.

Farrant (1980) states that a good teacher is one who has a good understanding of what his pupils need to learn and also their capabilities for learning. He is capable of judging just how much he needs to intervene in each pupils learning and knows the most effective way of providing the assistance. Thus, the skill of teaching lies in knowledge, who, what and how to teach and also being able to judge when.

The Teachers Role in Society

Although questions abound on whether teaching is a profession or not, one issue that is often agreed on is that teachers play a vital role in society. Such roles include the following:

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a) Human Resource Developer

Teachers play a vital role in human resource development by teaching academic subjects, developing syllabuses, writing books, preparing learners for examinations, marking and coordinating examinations. In addition to these students expect teachers to pass over information and ideas to them, they expect teachers to teach them well so as to excel in their examinations. Parents expect them to promote academic excellence. All these roles contribute to further advancement of learners and therefore their participation in national development. ***b) Administrative/Leadership***

One of the duties teachers perform in schools is administration, particularly in their own classrooms. Teachers have to exercise efficient management over pupils, the resources at their disposal and the various programmes of learning that are going on in their subject area to ensure learning proceeds effectively and that the desired standards of output are maintained (Farrant, 1980). They provide leadership in school for the institution to achieve its goals and objectives. Teachers are also planners and coordinators of events such as sports, music and drama.

Teachers are expected to provide leadership in the community by acting as development coordinators and facilitators at grass roots in the village or at community level. They are expected to take leadership roles in Harambees, conservation, family planning, education and health related issues. They are assumed to be educated, read widely and therefore have knowledge and skills to do this. Teachers are also expected to participate in communal activities such as secretaries in rural committees, church elders and chairpersons in various organizations. Development partners expect teachers to become key figures in plans of revitalizing villages or beginning cooperative efforts.

c) Disciplinarians

Teachers are expected to be disciplinarians at all times and mould learners into responsible citizens even if the home background contributes to negative vices and influences the learner in a different direction. They are expected to keep their classes controlled and conducive to teaching without recourse to punishment or excessive shouting. However, what happens outside the school in society can affect the standard of discipline in the school.

Teachers teaching learners from high socio economic status have encountered threats and intimidation due to disciplining students. They also encounter Parents who are highly educated and know their rights and will therefore analyse any disciplinary measures taken against their children. In schools where most learners are from low socio economic status, some parents have assaulted teachers, taken them to court or withdrawn children on the belief that their children are being disciplined because they are hated and despised simply because they are poor.

Despite all these, teachers have to ensure that their classes are well disciplined. Teaching would not be possible without discipline.

d) Guidance

Teachers are supposed to provide guidance and counselling to their learners. With rapid changes in society and various influences such as drugs and sicknesses such as AIDs teachers can no longer afford to restrict their profession only to teaching. Once in a while teachers will be called upon to assist their learners by discussing various vices in society and how they affect the youth. Teachers should advise students on subject selection, careers and further education.

e) Participation in Curriculum Development

Teachers should be able to review the curriculum, suggest modifications and be involved in policymaking. They should be able to assess the level of comprehension in textbooks recommended for their subject areas. Parents are becoming more knowledgeable and they are challenging teachers on the content of knowledge and skills given to their children. On the other hand, the government expects teachers to introduce to students ideas of national unity and development. Curriculum developers expect teachers to adopt new ways of teaching and new syllabuses. Adult literacy classes expect teachers to improve their reading and writing skills while the government expects teachers to introduce to the students ideas of national unity and respect for state institutions.

f) Role Model

The teacher embodies the central values of society and is responsible for the maintenance of moral consensus in a secular society (Durkheim 1961). This role exposes teachers to many pressures and conflicts in society. The public expects too much perfection from teachers and this at times interferes with their private lives. They are expected to be shining examples in the community. Besides embodying the African culture, they are expected to lead a comfortable, reflected through by being smart and confident, good physical appearance and good housing. They should also be committed to education, and fight against drunkard ness and social evils.

It has been regarded as anti-social for teachers to take alcohol, smoke, dress shabbily or marry their own students yet some would like to participate in these activities like any other citizens. Teachers are not supposed to engage in business, as it is believed this will interfere with their profession, yet this very exacting expectation is not commensurate with what the same society pays them. It is unrealistic to expect teachers to live at sub-standard levels and still be role models to their learners or be shining examples in the community.

Teachers are looked upon as the custodians of those values and practices of human society that enhance the quality of human life, this often creates dilemmas for the teacher who clearly appears to play contradictory roles of progress and conservatism by trying to hold on to “archaic” values. However, it is important for teachers to conduct themselves in a manner that makes it worthwhile for the learners to imitate. This does not mean being pretentious and hypocritical but behaving according to truly internalised positive values that enhance the quality of human life (Gwarinda 1993).

g) Political Coordinators/facilitators.

Teachers are expected to be political coordinators and facilitators within their communities. They are expected to be able to socialize politically and empower the learners and the public on political matters for example, their rights, the role of parties and patriotism. They are expected to be at the forefront in the fight against evils such as corruption, exploitation and tribalism in the society Teachers are seen to be in a better position and more influential with students and the masses.

While society is all too ready to heap expectations and obligations on the teachers, it is surprising to find that teachers are not usually given the material reward, training or social prestige to match their supposed importance.

Changing Role of The Teacher

The school is an important agent of socialization, and teachers form an important component of the school. However, teachers have to play changing roles due to the following:

a) The world has become too complex for many parents due to technological Advancement. The global village concept and the disintegration of the traditional family unit have put many parents in despair. There is a lot of information, both valuable and invaluable that children get access to through the Internet, print and electronic media and pen pals. Parents may not be able to control this accessibility due to lack of skills in operating the Internet, video or being too busy and unavailable. The teacher is therefore left with the responsibility of handling the learners and advising them on what to select and avoid in the rapidly changing world.

b) Agents of socialization have failed to socialize children well. Parents have abdicated their role to teachers and house helps mainly because some are too busy at their workplace or in businesses, with the desire to acquire more money hence maintain their social status or move higher in status. Some of these parents can go to any lengths even corrupt methods to acquire wealth. The teacher is left with the responsibility of ensuring the learners do not follow or admire these vices.

The age factor has contributed to some parents lacking control over their children. Some parents are ignorant of what is expected of them as parents. This is mainly because some parents get their children when they are too young (14-16years) and end up being almost at par with their children in their reasoning, some get their children when they are too old and cannot therefore understand them or socialize. The teacher therefore is left with the role of bridging this gap.

Teachers have become Parent substitutes. Most parents have left child rearing to teachers. Teachers are expected to impart discipline and moral attitudes and behaviour in children. Many teachers in schools have been left to play the role of foster parents. This is mainly due to breakage of the family, resulting in most children ending up in broken families with no one to confide in except their class teachers. Lack of contact with the extended families, such as uncles, aunts or grandmothers to confide in, particular in urban areas has resulted in most learners confiding in their teachers.

Based on the materialistic aspect in society, many parents have delegated the duty of child rearing to teachers in search of property. Many parents from high socio economic status families are hardly at home, as they have to acquire more wealth to retain their social status. To them as long as they pay the high fees and get their children materially comfortable, the teacher should cater for the rest. Many believe teachers are trained and paid and so should take care of their children as they are very busy. On the other hand, in low socio economic families poverty has contributed to parental absenteeism in search of basic needs. For some of these children, the only source of solace, encouragement and hope is their teacher. The roles played by the teacher's consist of correcting learners according to school rules and disciplining them effectively in the interest of the children and society. Parents expect teachers to be role models, to discipline their children and instil in them moral values.

However, playing the parental role has caused dilemma for some teachers, for besides overloading them and affecting the teaching programme, some children's upbringing has at times conflicted with the teachers' expectations and caused rifts between teachers and parents.

- c) Religious organizations that were once regarded as centres of solace for the youth are now shunned by most youths. This is because they are viewed as boring places, places for the old, sickly and poor. The preaching that is given, is sometimes regarded as an attack on the youth without the humility to listen or understand what they are going through or offer them workable solutions to their problems. Avoidance of religious organizations means that the teacher has to instil the moral aspect learners fail to get from religious organizations.
- d) Children spent more time in school than at home. The teachers therefore might understand the students better than their own parents and at times play the role of substitute parents.

However, the competency of teachers to play these roles is called to question putting into consideration the following:

- a) Most teachers are very busy because the curriculum is very loaded. Spending time that should have been used in analysing course objectives; subject content and teaching methodology on guiding and counselling learners may have a negative impact on the learners' academic performance. The curriculum does not have an aspect of socialization, nor is this aspect examined and hence lack of interest.
- b) Most teachers lack political and parental support. Although they may try to play various roles and help to bring up morally upright learners, if the school does not perform well academically, they will be blamed. They are blamed for all the failures and are not credited for the good things.
- c) Some of the teachers expected to assist learners are ill prepared mainly because they are old and at times their outlook to life is considered old fashioned or are young and require guidance and to be socialized first. Some lack experience due to the high turn over.
- d) Teachers have to work more than before because the majority of the learners have been dislodged from their societies. Students are unique and their problems are varied. This requires different approaches. Teachers normally are not trained on these approaches and quite a number do not know how to handle the student Issues. At times they have made the learners situation worse than it had originally been. Professional counsellors are better in dealing with some of the cases.
- e) Teachers are always under pressure as schools are often scrutinized by society. All would want to know what goes on in schools. It is difficult for teachers to cope with this stress in addition to playing parental roles.

Issues affecting school teachers Retention

Most professionals stay within their careers but the rate at which teachers leave the teaching profession is so high and alarming. Besides low salaries, there is delay in payment with teachers normally earning after others, this acts as a de-motivating factor. It is worse for some of the teachers when flimsy excuses such as breakdown of computers is given as a reason. Many teachers are at the mercy of their employer such as the Teachers Service Commission and can be posted to remote areas of operations, areas with no water, electricity or social amenities. The policy of transferring teachers from one post to another within relatively short periods of services results in disorientation and low commitment to teaching. Some find teaching less challenging as they teach the same classes, same topics year after year. It is also not easy to move through the ranks as compared to other professionals.

Teachers also face criticism frequently, particularly when students fail or go on strike. Politicians also harass teachers particularly heads of schools, especially when they are perceived to be opposed to government policies or to the sitting politician. Some of the students may also intimidate teachers, particularly if they are from the well to do families or those on drugs. The local community may intimidate teachers particularly if they are perceived as foreigners and thus denying their own sons and daughters employment or as a result of a few teachers misbehaving. In some schools particularly high cost urban schools, parents have dictated to teachers how schools should be run and their children disciplined. These factors contribute to many teachers moving out of the profession. Parents may also dictate on who should be posted in their schools. Normally teachers from far off places are not welcome.

❖ Recruitment

Employment or recruitment of teachers depends on the individual, organizations or the government. These groups base on different criteria, with some basing on qualifications while others base on friendship and nepotism. Productivity also depends on the quality of the employed teachers. However, quite a number of those people who go for teaching did not pick on it as their first choice. Many of them fail to get other jobs as a result they opt for teaching. The implications of these are that such teachers will not be stable at their

jobs since they will have divided loyalty and they will not be motivated. They lack commitment and dedication.

❖ **Motivation**

Many teachers are de-motivated that is why the turn over is high.

❖ **Remuneration**

Teachers are poorly paid compared with other professionals. At some stage, even cooks and house servants in urban areas earned more than teachers (Bogonko, 1992). Another dimension of this issue is that teachers in well to do private schools earn more than those in public schools. Above all African teachers earn less than expatriates or European and Asian teachers of similar qualifications in private schools.

Summary



In this lesson teaching and the teaching profession is analysed. Teaching is referred to as the process of providing information, knowledge or skills to others. Teachers are the people who are involved in the process of providing information, knowledge or skills to other people. There are various categories of teachers. These are teachers in public, private or non-governmental schools, teachers in pre primary, primary, secondary, colleges and universities. Teachers can also be categorized as trained or untrained.

The teaching profession in Kenya has its roots in early missionary efforts to establish and spread schools for the education of the masses. The teaching profession has undergone a lot of changes. Teaching as a profession was generally highly regarded before independence as teachers were among the most highly educated people in society. With independence and the growth and opening up of opportunities in other professionals for indigenous people, teaching lost its high status.

In this lesson, characteristics of a profession are analysed. These include among others, the performance of essential social service that are central to the well being of society, training, specialization, freedom to practice, a board of operation and a code of Conduct. Professionalism generates in service growth, unity, interest of clients, unique language, Prestige, dynamic and practice freely.

Factors hindering acquisition of professional status in teaching include among others, the social economic background of the majority of those joining the teaching profession which limits their bargaining power. The large number of entrants in the profession make increase in their salaries costly. Gender imbalance, age factor, lack of commitment to teaching, low salaries and lack of professional culture are some of the factors that hinder acquisition of professional status in teaching.

Society expects teachers to be initiative, sympathetic, respectful, flexible, firm, honest, with foresight, and intellectual. Teachers on the other hand play various roles in society such as Human Resource Developer, Administrative/Leadership, Disciplinarians, Guidance, Participation in Curriculum Development, role model and political coordinators/facilitators. However the teachers' role in society is changing due to technological advancement. The complexity in technological advancement has resulted in teachers taking over the responsibility of handling learners and advising them on what to select and avoid in the rapidly changing world. Parents have abdicated their parental role to teachers and house helps. Teachers are expected to impart discipline and moral attitudes and behaviour in children. Religious organizations that were once regarded as centres of solace for the youth are now shunned by most youths. Avoidance of religious organizations means that the teacher has to instil the moral aspect learners fail to get from religious organizations. The fact that learners spent more time in school than at home implies that teachers might understand the students better than their own parents. This results in them playing the role of substitute parents.

In this lesson, other issues affecting schoolteachers such as retention, recruitment, motivation and Remuneration are discussed.

Conclusion

The teaching profession has not been clearly defined in many societies. This arises due to various reasons such as the size, complexity and diversity to be found among those who perform the teaching profession and their expected roles. It is difficult to unite and generalize members of a profession that is divided in terms of function, social origin, qualifications and experience. However, if teachers desire to be considered as professionals then they have to address issues related to their training, ethical code, control over entry in the profession and autonomy, issues that contribute to professional status.

Recommendations

- ❖ Teachers must develop a sense of professional responsibility so as to be trusted by the community and parents. Training programmes, provide constructive services for members of the teaching profession. Duties and responsibilities of teachers towards society should be enforced.
- ❖ The Government should recognize the vital role played by teachers in the society and improve pay. Teachers should also have a say in the selection of learning material and teaching programmes.

- ❖ As long as civil servants who are not teachers and who enjoy rights that teachers do not enjoy manage the teaching profession, teachers' interests may not be safeguarded.
- ❖ There should be an open forum for teachers annually, in which they can discuss educational needs and planning. **Questions**



1. Identify and discuss five characteristics of a profession.
2. Discuss factors that hinder the acquisition of professionalism in teaching and suggest how professionalism can be reinforced.
3. Discuss the changing roles of teachers in present day society

References 4. Identify and discuss the steps you would take to assist the teaching profession to revert to its old status.



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LESSON 12

SOCIAL CHANGE AND EDUCATION

Introduction

In this chapter, we would like to consider the issue of social change and learn how it may affect education. As our outline, we want to begin by examining the meaning and concept of social change; explain some theories about social change; talk about some facts and types of social change; development and finally show the sense in which social change influence or affect education and the role of education in development.

Learning objectives



At the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- (1) Discuss the meaning and concept of social change.
- (2) List and discuss some of the main theories that can explain social change.
- (3) Discuss some facts and types of social change.
- (4) Explain the aspect of development with regard to education
- (5) Discuss/show how social change factors have impact on education and vice versa.

Key words

- ☐ Social change and development
- ☐ Theories of social change
- ☐ Education
- ☐ Exogenous
- ☐ Endogenous
- ☐ Cultural, economic, technological, privatization, democratization, globalization, urbanization, gender, as factors affecting change in education.
- ☐ Development
- ☐ Homogenous
- ☐ Heterogenous

Names associated with social change understanding

Auguste Comte

Herbert Spencer

Karl Marx

Social change; A Historical Meaning

Auguste Comte, considered as the father of sociology, (1798-1857), had argued that change in human societies was a process of progression from one system of ideas to another. On examining his thinking he identified three stages of change which he thought the human beings had gone through, namely,

- (1) The oligical stage dominated by ideas and religion being provided by priests
- (2) The metaphysical stage dominated by ideas coming from sages, for example, philosophers, lawyers, politicians and other acknowledged authorities.
- (3) Scientific stage dominated by ideas being given by scientists and industrialists.

However, sociologists and philosophers opposing Comte's opinion of social change being a stage by stage progression of ideas, argued in favour of explaining/showing how social structures changed. Among those who led in this view of social change was Herbert Spencer, 1820-1903. We shall discuss the evolutionary views of social change later. (Ivor Morrish, Sociology of Education p.1).

Current Meaning/Concept of Social Change

What does social change mean in contemporary times and in what sense it conceptualized? In contemporary societies, there are many views that people have as indicators of change in society. Some examples are: (i) Fashions, that is clothes;

- (ii) Foodstuffs, ways of preparing, cultivating, utensils for cooking and eating from;
- (iii) Population movement, like when rural people flock into urban areas;
- (iv) Scientific and technological knowledges, methods and products.
- (v) Political thinking, persuasions and tolerance

All these phenomena suggest strongly that social change is occurring or has occurred.

Many thinkers, nowadays including sociologists conceptualize social change as any significant alterations in society that involve changes in the

- (a) Main social structures (institutions) such as the family, economy, religion, education, politics and health.
- (b) Civilization developmental features; for example, new inventions; new scientific and technological products, knowledge, communication systems, information systems, transport systems and many others.
- (c) Cultural elements: for example, art, products, drama, literature, new skills and knowledges,
- (d) Social relationships: the new web of social interactions and choices with who to associate, make friends and marry etc
- (e) Norms (standards of behaviour)
- (f) Values, interests expectations

Whenever we see or come across all or some of these elements, or they are introduced into society, inevitably society will experience changes in various ways especially in its life. This is what social change means. It is also the way by which we can conceptualize it sociologically.

Theories of social change

In our discussion of sociological theories, we learned that the main purposes of a theory is to explain social phenomena, events or occurrences. Theories of social change do explain or help us to understand how social change takes place in society. Whereas there are many theories concerning social change, some are beyond, the purpose of this text. Nevertheless, we shall briefly talk about the (a) evolutionary theory

(b) Marxist model/Theory

(c) System dysfunction theory

(a) The evolutionary theory of social change: This theory developed from a group of 19th century social philosophers. The most prominent individual of this group of theorists was Herbert Spencer (1820-1903). Their ideas were motivated by Charles Darwin's theory of biological evolution of animals. These theorists argued that if animals, evolved from one simple species to another, different or more complex species, then human societies could also evolve in a similar manner. They could change from the simple, homogenous, primitive, hunting and plants gathering societies to the complex, advanced, heterogenous, industrialized societies with differentiated structures and specializations. Such views saw the human societies as entities that has progressed from the primitive and simple communities to advanced modern collectivities. However, the rapidity or pace of change differed from one society to another. Thus one society may be said to be more advanced, highly evolved and more progressive compared highly to another depending on the degree of differentiation and complexity. (Coser et. Al., 1983).

(b) Marxist Theory of Social Change

Social change as theorized in the Marxist model is embodied in the social conflict tendencies that could occur in society. Social conflict refers to the forces of antagonisms or oppositions that may exist among and within social groups with each group having different interests, values or expectations. As a result, such groups can begin to oppose each others' views resulting in disagreement disharmony and even instability between the different groups in society.

The first person to observe, recognize and discuss such eventualities of social conflict in society was Karl Marx. His theory relied mostly on the use of economic and political components with regard to how denials could trigger social conflict in society. The idea of the "haves" and the "have nots" is well documented in many volumes. In particular, he showed the possibility that when the latter groups realize their being excluded from and denied participation in political power, economic wealth, and resources, social conflict would be inevitable. Through social conflict social change is bound to follow in society. In brief, Marxist model ends up by insinuating that the change will only come in society when means of economic production and political systems held by the few owners will revert to the majority ownership of property without class distinctions and conflicts.

(c) System Dysfunction Theory

This perspective views society as a functionally integrated system of interrelated parts. The various parts are intended to or should maintain the system in equilibrium. But if one part or more are not operating well, that is they are dysfunctional, the whole system is likely to be affected. In an effort to bring the system back to equilibrium, social change is introduced often through altering the social structure, either partially or totally. If the system fails to adjust because certain parts are resisting to abandon the status quo, or severe dysfunctions cannot be corrected in time, then what may occur is a revolution that could mean an overhaul of the social life system. In short, when a breakdown occurs in the system because of many serious uncorrected problems and the system is able to put in place the required adjustments, then social change in whatever form will eventually occur. All these three theories are therefore important in explaining how social change may come in society.

Some facts About Social Change

Social change is innundated by a number of facts that we need to understand. Some of these are:

- (1) All human societies and all their social structures or institutions, are subject to change. They constantly change in order to adapt to new/changing circumstances or conditions.
- (2) Peoples culture social institutions, ideas, attitudes, values, technologies, knowledge, communication etc., change significantly after or on contact with other cultures.
- (3) The most obvious and noticeable social as time passes, is in the 'organic' population. That is, the youth change to adults. The young generations change to older generations which ultimately become past generations.
- (4) Social change in simpler societies, is usually rare and slow. Unless disasters and contact with other cultures occur. However, social change in complex societies, for example in European, is usually rapid and drastic. Such rapid social change is indeed a major problem because many individuals cannot keep up with the speed of social change. Many diseases are known to afflict several citizens of these societies such as stress, because of fighting to keep up with the rapid changes in their social lives.
- (5) (i) Social change is perpetually occurring as a process. It is a process that continuously occurs in many different ways – a step by step phenomenon, a merging of one stage into another more developed or advanced, and a way of discerning how people adapt to the changing situations and circumstances.
(ii) Social change is also observed and perceived as a form of progress in which something such as an activity/action attains a pre-determined goal or destination.

Types of Social Change

Change in society is categorized in two ways namely:

- (i) Exogenous form: this type of social change is influenced by forces which are not in society. Spratt gives some examples like invasion of one country by another with the possibility of changing the original society. Other forces/agencies of exogenous factors include foreign diseases, cultures and colonization.
- (ii) Enogenous form: This type of social change is brought about by factors within society. Examples of this type are the Jua Kali artisanship, the matatu transport business, herbal medicine, atomic/nuclear energy and many other

forms of inventions. When such endogeneous factors occur within a society then it is their application which mainly brings about the social change. (W.J.H Sprott in Morrish, 1972, p.67).

Social Change Factors Influencing Education

Although when social change occurs it affects several elements and structures in society, one of the social structures that is touched greatly is education. One of the reasons for this is that education is rather a delicate institution which happens to depend on other institution which happens to depend on other institutions for its sustenance, security and provisions. For example, the economy, government and the family must maintain, protect and feed education. Consequently, if change occurs in the more stronger institutions such as the ones mentioned above, they also influence some changes in education. A second reason is that education is a conserving institution which tries to teach and thus conserve the cultural heritage of society. Considering that society is continuously undergoing many changes, education must ensure that it is not left behind; it does not suffer from cultural lag.

Specifically, however, there are important factors in a changing society that affect education, as discussed well by Ezewu (1983, pp.137-143). Let us briefly outline some of them namely the economic, technology, cultural, gender, urbanization, globalization ideational.

(a) Economic Factor

According to Karl Marx, the methods and instruments of economic production influence society extensively. With the methods and instruments changing economically, technology and socially all other important sectors of society are subject to change. This means that economic changes are therefore crucial and have a positive bearing on many social institutions. For example, think about the employment situation in Kenya. Presently, the economy has not been able to create jobs that can absorb many of our well educated and highly trained young men and women. As a result, many are languishing in the streets of urban areas. Others are resulting to anti-social activities such as crime. Still others are leaving the country.

Since education is an essential social institution, its expansion and what it provides to every member of society, are largely dependent on the well being, performance, power and provisions of a given country economy. In Kenya, we have declared that it is the right of everyone to be educated. The proclamation of universal education is a bold testimony to our willingness to wipe out illiteracy. But this policy, the planning, practice and provision of such an education is heavily dependent on our economy to support and maintain it. At present, our economy is weak and heavily burdened by other social needs like roads and housing and feeding the hungry citizens. These other needs take a sizeable part of the economic resources such that the education system is forced to share the meagre resources and therefore to operate on far less funds than otherwise. The outcome of this scenario is known; for example.

- (i) Self-support by students for attending school and all the way to university, has become a reality. In order words, learners are required to purchase, pay for dearly for the education goods and services. Families, benevolent individuals, are all

paying heavily to keep the learners in school and education performing its social function.

- (ii) Several people and students fail to realize their educational abilities and skills. They risk remaining semi-literate due to their failure to pay for education. This will affect the availability of highly trained manpower, the effort to obtain higher degrees, and also exacerbate the already existing underemployment and unemployment situations. Together with these, the rising inclinations towards committing social crimes, corruption, embezzlement of public funds and other socially undesirable behaviours, will continue to haunt our society. Most of this is because the economy has changed and affected education including other social institutions.

(b) Technological factor

In the past, traditional societies did not use advanced forms or technical knowledge, instructional methods and materials. At the same time the shelters in which instructions were conducted remained simple, usually under a tree, out in the wild wood or simply constructed family dwellings.

At the present, all these facilities have changed tremendously in many ways:

- (i) School buildings/classrooms are different from the simple traditional structures. For example, buildings are stone/concrete built, multi-storeyed.
- (ii) New types of instructional materials are used. There are computers, exercise books and textbooks calculators instead of the state of past days.
- (iii) There is demand and use of new types of clothing materials for making school uniforms. Students, especially in urban areas, wear socks and shoes; these items were far from being part of school uniforms in the past.
- (iv) Demand for localized industrial capacities emphasizing expert hands in production of locally assembled products. This demand is incorporated in the introduction of the 8-4-4 system of education which emphasizes theoretical as well as the practical approach to subjects teaching. As it is evident now this factor is rapidly pointing towards revolutionizing how we go about and what we use in educating the learners.

(c) The Cultural Interaction Factor

The cultural interaction factor in social change provides that if and when human beings from different cultures interact, that is, meet, act, react towards and relate with each other, there will occur cultural exchange. This idea continues to say that if one culture is more dominant over the other, the weaker one would be absorbed. An example of this, is how the British colonial culture absorbed our African traditional systems of tribal governments. The area of religion is also another example we changed from the indigenous religious practices to the christianity. But is the interacting cultures are equally strong, non is dominant over the other, the tendency is for each culture to

borrow parts of the other culture as necessary and incorporate them in it. The end result is that there would be no dominating culture and also more cultural items/products would become available to each culture. But how does the cultural integration factor, affect education? Earlier, we learned that education as a social institution is meant for preserving the culture of society by teaching the younger generations the various components of this culture. In the Kenyan situation, the British cultural processes were more dominant than the African culture. We yielded to this cultural domination during colonization.

The effect of this surrender was that;

- (i) our traditional indigenous education in which children learned their cultural roles within their families and communities, was changed to one in which children became separated from their parents and attended structures called schools with other storage children within unfamiliar surroundings.
- (ii) Children were to be instructed by other different people called teaches, unfamiliar to them.
- (iii) The new education ideals and methods became popular and highly demanded. Although separated from parental care and family life the new way of educating children became more popular with passing time. Today many of the children are eager to learn new knowledges, skills, mannerisms morals and behaviour through school/education. The limitation is now the funds to pay for education but not the total lack of their willingness and abilities. Such large participation of children/learners in education have affected schools in terms of space, facilities, equipment, materials and instructions.
- (iv) New methods of teaching and training teachers have replaced the traditional ways. We no longer put much emphasis on family, parental, community methods of teaching children. This has had some grave consequences. In terms childrens/learners' lacking desirable social behaviour, disrespect for authority, rules and regulation and observance of norms.
- (v) Another cultural element that has affected education is the desire by those who become so educated, say by the British missionaries, to emulate the ways of living and behaviour of their teachers, ways of doing things, types of food and clothes used. All these had a great deal infecting changes in education culturally.

(d) Gender Factor

The concern over the gender factor in social change is probably that some of us are still thinking seriously of the roles of male and female being distinct and separate. But the fact of the matter is that the roles are merging and soon there will be significantly observable gaps. Child nurturing, industrial and office work are just a few examples of how fast the gender role are becoming less and less distinct. Changes imposed by the need to make sexes equal as members of the human society are inevitable. How does this factor affect education?

- (i) Education is the probably the most suitable social institution in which changes can start being instituted so as to prepare the coming generations for gender equality, equalization and sensitization. This would mean the installation of the proper machinisms that would teach the learners how to think positively and practice the gender understanding.
- (ii) The curriculum must be changed to make it the most effective way of ensuring that adaptation to gender awareness is maintained. For example, text books which are intended to offer instructions and knowledge should strive to change their teaching approach so that they can show both male and female being able undertake similar mental, technological and even similar skills equally well.

- (iii) Families too have a responsibility; namely, to change their attitude so that they girlchild is not denied an educational opportunity, but are given the same rights as the male siblings.

(e) Democratization Factor

The work of a society can hardly be accomplished en mass. The dependence and delegation of its work to a number of social institutions is a clear testimony to the above fact. Each society has therefore many different institutions, which probably can be distributed to its simplicity or complexity. Nevertheless we have before that six institutions are basically observable. The free and wider participation of a majority of the members of a given society in the social institutions is crucial and essential. They must be involved, for example in decision making socially, politically, economically, in education and other matters of their lives. These ideas, practices and philosophy are valued as being DEMOCRATIC. It is a way of eliminating traditionalism and authoritarianism in society. How does this factor and its tenets affect education?

- (i) Education is viewed as a promoter of democratic ideals. It is heavily dependent on other social institutions in carrying out its work. If one or more of the social institutions change, education will change too. Therefore, as social institutions permit the democratic practice. Education too will move toward such ideals in an effort to facilitate the learners to internalize and promote such ideals.
- (ii) How does this factor play a role in education? As students in school learn their democratic right to participate in making decision that can affect their lives in schools, some have taken upon themselves the desire to be heard more. They sometimes result into strikes, school burning and other students unrest. Such mass action are rarely the democratic way of airing views or grievances. Often, these actions have resulted in closing the school, suspending all academic activities and even expelling the culprits.
- (iii) The move towards allowing students to select their areas of study is a way of letting them to exercise a free choice in making decision. This is feature of democracy in education.

(f) Prioritization Factor

There is a perception that if services are provided by the private sector, they are more superior and better than when the same services are provided by the public sector. This perception is promoting the mushrooming of more and more private institutions in Kenya. Private ventures now range from banks to schools. The Nairobi and Nakuru water supplies are now privatized. Telephone services are another example. Many other facilities are trying was of becoming private enterprises. If and when this happens we shall no longer make noise to the government. Hopefully by changing from public to private services, of services and choices. What does privatization have to do with education?

In keeping up with this trend, education is not being left behind as follows

- (i) Private schools from nursery to secondary schools have been established in many parts of Kenya.

- (ii) Higher education is no longer the domain of public/government sponsored universities. Many private universities are operating in Kenya.
- (iii) Private commercial colleges to train individuals for higher skills are also operating
- (iv) Private instructions and tuition are provided after school and during holidays to boost individual students academic performance in examinations and in school. All of those private ventures are helping to promote not only privatization but also augment the public provision of education.

(g) Urbanization Factor

For many years, people have always felt that living in urban areas is better than anywhere else. Such a feeling has prompted many to leave their rural homes in favour of urban dwelling. Why are such feelings attractive? One reason is search of employment opportunities. Second, they are trying to escape from the poor rural life in search for the supposedly 'good' life in cities. Third, they may be looking for better physical amenities, infrastructures and recreational facilities.

So, our urban centres have grown with high-rise buildings, automobiles, industries, pollution and overpopulation. At the same time people have tended to become more poorer, slum dwellers, street dweller, victims of crimes, overstretched facilities, higher costs and many other vices. How has this factor affected education?

- More and more people are demanding and searching for education in urban areas where it is though that better schools are available.
- Education good and service have become more expensive in urban areas

Children are dropping out of school when they fail to pay for the services. Such individuals perpetuate difficulties urban areas, for example, crime, street children, children labour, thuggery and idleness.

h) Globalization factor

With the world creeping towards seven billion, this world is becoming overpopulated. In other words, it's becoming too small- a global village. The village is characterized by faster means of global travel, and interconnected network of communication such as print media, radio, television, computer, video, internet, E-mail, mobile- telephone and others. It is also characterized by similar ideas, values, hair styles, fashions, technological inventions and products. Truly this is globalization. How does this factor affect education? Globalization is not sparing educating when it comes to social change.

- i)** The learner is being exposed to new instructional equipment, for example, the computer which is imported global equipment. The teacher will now be required to understand/ know how to use such a global equipment.
- (ii) Many of the university lecturers have been highly trained in other countries. They come back to teach and practice the ideals of where they were educated in that sense they are assisting to spread the global thinking.

In conclusion, change including social change, is often destabilizing, unwelcome and even painful to different people. It can be disorienting, unnerving to some of us who may have already established their own norms, standards and stability. When new technologies,

techniques, products, ideas values morals do come, they may require some adaptation by all of us and certainly accommodation by us in society.

The enemy is not social change but the personal perceptions and fear about social change. The fears rejection and ability to adapt to the novel and unfamiliar makes social change difficult if not impossible among people.

Development and Education

When an economist talks about development, generally he or she means a number of factors. It means,

- i) An improvement, a growth in the gross national product of a country.
- ii) All the goods and services that are produced and consumed in a country.
- iii) The foreign and domestic investments found in the country.

Further more, it implies the improvement in the standard of living for the general public or population and the high level of industrialization and urbanization found in a country. When we speak of a developed country the implication is that such a country is able to produce its own capital, machinery, technology as well- paying jobs and social services for its own citizens. However, sociologists are more interested in how the wealth possessed in a country is distributed to a majority of citizens.

Some Indicators of Development

Generally, it is assumed that if there is development in a country, it will be measurable through a number of important indicators such as

- 1) Better quality of life and living standards
- 2) Education will be more accessible to more people.
- 3) A majority of citizens would comparatively richer and be able to purchase more goods and services being produced in the country.
- 4) Fewer people will depend on agriculture since more citizens would be employed in the manufacturing industries.
- 5) People would move to urban centres and live there.
- 6) There would be greater emphasis on individual goal attainment rather than communal goals.
- 7) The size of individual families would be smaller and be able to live in urban areas.

Nevertheless, the main concern of a sociologist is to establish whether and to what extent the development has an impact on the citizens.

Role of An Education in Development

Since education is a key role player in national development, it is valued and supported in government policy making in turn, education is supposed to play its crucial role in a number of areas in a country such as,

- 1) equipping the citizens with useful mental skills and wiping out illiteracy.
- 2) Supplying the country with needed man power.

- 3) Modifying the behavior, attitudes of the learners as well as their personalities.
- 4) Teaching the desirable morals
- 5) Equipping someone with employable skills.
- 6) Bring about new knowledge that would enhance new inventions and technologies.
- 7) Build ones physical wellbeing and health
- 8) Encourage someone to realize his/her abilities, responsibility and the need to mind other peoples lives
- 9) Improve the general economy of a country.
- 10) Teach and preserve culture.
- 11) Teach people to become more gender sensitive and lesson all kinds of discriminatory practices.
- 12) Build a class less society in a country.

In the final analysis, education is intended to nurture a greater degree of cooperation, independent thinking, opinions, self-expression abilities as well as enhancing democratic practices among all of us.

Questions and learning Activities

- (1) Compare and contrast the views of Auguste Comte' and Herbert Spencer regarding social change.
- (2) What is the contemporary meaning/concept of social change, or how to do people nowadays see as indicators of social change
- (3) Discuss the three theories that explain how social change can come about.
- (4) Discuss the facts characterizing the social change
- (5) Outline the various factors in society that can influence education.
- (6) What does the term 'development' mean? Discuss its indicators.
- (7) What is the role of education in development of society?

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